

Independent English (B1 Intermediate)

The full teaching manual for a 13-week adult-education B1 class (26 classes × 90 minutes): lesson stages and timing, board plans, drilling and concept-check questions, pair-work, error correction, differentiation, and L1 watch-outs.

8 modules • 24 lessons

26 classes • 90 min • 13 weeks

Teacher copy • not for students

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Module 1 — Time, Experience & Past Habits

Three classes that open the B1 level. Learners already know the present perfect, the past simple and *used to* from A2. The B1 skill is choosing: present perfect or past simple? Present perfect simple or continuous? *used to* or *would*? Class 1 also welcomes a new group and gives you a quick A2 diagnostic. By the end of the module learners can open a topic with an experience, give the details, talk about what they have been doing lately, and discuss how life has changed.

3 lessons

Lessons 1.1–1.3

Classes C1–C3

Weeks 1–2

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, discussion) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-1-time-experience.html](#). Print [materials/module-1/classroom-materials.html](#) before C1. It holds the flashcards, the welcome question cards and the A2 diagnostic grid, the new identity cards, the timeline interview cards, the "Have you ever..." Find Someone Who, the "What have you been doing?" clue game, the "How life has changed" discussion cards and roles, and all the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home.
- **This is extension, not a first meeting.** A2 taught each form on its own (present perfect for experiences in A2 Module 4, *used to* in A2 Module 5). B1 puts the forms **side by side** and asks learners to choose. Spend less time on form and more on the choice, the reason, and fluent use.
- **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use some British forms (*film, flat, cinema, football, biscuits, neighbourhood, kilometres, practising, mobile phones, I've just got home*). Teach *movie, apartment, movie theater, soccer, cookies, neighborhood, kilometers / miles, practicing, cell phones, I've just gotten home*, and accept the British forms when learners use them. Americans also often use the past simple with *just / already / yet* ("Did you eat yet?"). Teach the present perfect version (it is correct everywhere) and accept both.

- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

What I've done → what I've been doing → how things used to be. Every lesson in this module links the past to *now*. In C1 learners open a topic with an experience or some news (*I've started a new job*) and move into the finished details (*I started two weeks ago*). In C2 they talk about activities that are still going on, or that explain what we can see now (*I've been painting. Look at my hands!*). In C3 they compare then and now (*People used to write letters. Every Sunday we would...*) and give an opinion: was it better before? Each class ends with a longer speaking task than the last: a pair interview, then a group game and a catch-up chat, then a group discussion with roles.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: THE PAST IS PERSONAL

This whole module is about the past, and for some adults the past holds hard things: a home they had to leave, a job they lost, people far away. **Never ask** "How was life in your country?", "Why did you come here?", "How long have you lived here?" or "What did you use to do before you came?" in a whole-class task. Keep personal questions to small, safe topics: food, hobbies, phones, work routines, free time. For every personal task offer three choices out loud: **your real life**, **a new identity card** (in the classroom materials), or **people in general / a place you know** ("People used to write letters"). In C3 the discussion is about **technology, work and daily life**, not about any one country. Anyone can say "Pass." Say it every time, so choosing a card is normal and not a sign that something is wrong.

B1 SPEAKING: FLUENCY FIRST, THEN ACCURACY

B1 learners need **long turns**: more than one sentence, with a reason or an example. In every freer task, **do not interrupt to correct**. Walk around, listen, and write down 4–6 sentences you hear (good ones and ones with errors, no names). Give feedback in two steps: **content first** ("Lina's story about her first job was great: who else heard a surprising story?"), **language second** (the sentences on the board; learners fix them together). Correct on the spot only when the meaning breaks down or during controlled practice and drills.

Dominant speakers. Mixed-level groups often have one or two confident learners who fill every silence. Use **talking tokens** (3 per person; put one down when you take a long turn; when yours are gone, wait until everyone has used theirs), **roles** (the confident learner is the *chair* whose job is to make others talk, or the *reporter* who must repeat what others said), and **think time** (1 minute of silent notes before any discussion). Say it kindly in private: "You have great ideas. Today your job is to help Maria and Kofi talk more."

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Placement.** Ideally, learners took the toolkit placement test ([.. / .. /instructor-toolkit/placement-test.html](https://www.instructor-toolkit.com/placement-test.html)) before C1. If not, the C1 welcome mingle doubles as a quick **A2 diagnostic** (see Lesson 1.1). It will

not replace a placement test, but it will show you who needs extra support and who is close to B2.

- Print the **welcome question cards** (Set B, one set per 12 learners) and **one copy of the A2 diagnostic grid** for you, on a clipboard. Print name tents (folded paper is fine).
- Print the **picture flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board), the **time-word sort cards** (one set per pair for C1) and the **new identity cards** (Set C). Keep the identity cards on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- For C1: one **timeline interview** card per learner (Set E). For C2: one **Find Someone Who** sheet per learner (Set H) and one **clue game** deck per group of 3–4 (Set F). For C3: one set of **discussion topic cards and role cards** per group of 4 (Set G) and **talking tokens** (3 per learner: paper clips, beans or small squares of paper).
- Bring a photo or an object for each lead-in: something new in your life for C1 (a place you've been, a new skill), a paintbrush or a flour-covered cloth for C2 (acting it out is fun), and an old object for C3 (a paper map, a phone book, an old phone, a cassette, a photo of a pay phone).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
1.1	C1 • wk 1	Welcome + A2 diagnostic; present perfect vs past simple (finished time vs connected to now); <i>for / since; just, already, yet, still</i> ; open with the present perfect, then give details in the past simple; <i>been vs gone</i>	tell a partner about an experience or some news: open with the present perfect and give 3+ details in the past simple
1.2	C2 • wk 1	Present perfect continuous (<i>have / has been + -ing</i>) for duration up to now and for a recent activity with a present result; simple (how many?) vs continuous (how long?); stative verbs	answer "What have you been doing lately?" with 3+ ongoing activities, how long, and one counted result
1.3	C3 • wk 2	<i>used to (+ / - / ?)</i> for past habits and states; <i>didn't use to / Did ... use to...?</i> ; <i>would</i> for repeated past actions only; <i>used to</i> vs past simple	take part in a group discussion about how life has changed (6+ sentences with <i>used to / would</i>) and give an opinion with a reason

1.1 · C1

Welcome to B1 · Present Perfect vs Past Simple

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ meet classmates and use A2 language fluently: past simple, present perfect for experiences, future forms
- ◆ choose the **past simple** for a finished action at a finished time (*yesterday, in 2019, two weeks ago*) and the **present perfect** for a past action connected to now (experience, news, result, unfinished time)
- ◆ use *for* + a period and *since* + a start point to say how long something has been true
- ◆ use *just, already, yet* and *still* in the right position
- ◆ open a topic with the present perfect and switch to the past simple for the details: *I've been to Japan. I went in 2019...*

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.1 (Welcome box, New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My timeline")
- ◆ Slides 1–9 · name tents · **Welcome question cards** (Set B) · **A2 diagnostic grid** (your copy) · experience flashcards + **time-word sort cards** (Set A, 1 set per pair) · **Timeline interview cards** (Set E) · New identity cards (Set C)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.1-A (Sam's news) and 1.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two boxes. **FINISHED TIME** (yesterday · last week · in 2019 · two days ago · when I was a child) → **past simple:** I **saw** it last Friday. · **CONNECTED TO NOW** (ever · never · today · this week · so far · no time word) → **present perfect:** I've **seen** it three times.

Center: a time line: past —————→ ● NOW. An arrow from 2021 to NOW: "I've worked here **since** 2021 / **for** five years." A single dot at "last Friday": "I **saw** it last Friday."

Right: the shape of a story: **OPEN** (present perfect, no time) "I've been to Japan." → **DETAILS** (past simple) "I went in 2019. We visited Kyoto. It was amazing." Below: I've **just** arrived. · She's **already** left. · Have you eaten **yet**? · I **still** haven't finished.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & name tents	7	T-S	Greet each person at the door. Learners write the name they want to be called on a name tent (a new-identity name is fine). Go around the room and learn to say every name correctly . Introduce yourself in three tenses: "I'm _____. I've

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			taught English for six years. Last summer I learned to make bread. This year I'm going to run a 5K."
Welcome mingle = A2 diagnostic	15	S-S (mingle)	Slide 3. Each learner takes three welcome question cards , one of each color (PAST · PERFECT · FUTURE). They stand, find a partner, ask one question and one follow-up , answer, then swap cards and find a new partner (4 rounds). You walk with the diagnostic grid and listen (see "Running the diagnostic" below). Last 3 minutes: 3–4 learners tell the class something interesting about a partner: "Nadia has cooked for fifty people! She did it at her cousin's wedding." ICQs first.
About this course	3	T-S	Slide 2. 26 classes, 2 a week, 13 weeks; the workbook; the online course is homework (show it on a phone and tap a  button). B1 = choosing the right form, longer answers , and discussion . Module 1 = the past, connected to now.
Lead-in: my news	5	T-S	Tell a short true story in the "open → details" shape (board, right): "I've been to the new market downtown. I went on Saturday with my neighbor. We bought fresh bread and it was cheap!" Ask: "Which sentence has no time? Which sentences have a time?" Write the first and second sentences on the board. No rules yet: let learners notice. Then slide 4: learners ask you "Have you ever...?" about two pictures.
Grammar: the choice	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 5–6. The key idea: finished time → past simple; connected to now → present perfect (board, left). CCQs (below). Then the time-word sort : pairs sort 14 cards into FINISHED and CONNECTED TO NOW (3 min); check with the class. Drill (below).
Listening: Sam's news	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.1-A once for gist ("What's Sam's news?"), then again: learners answer the questions. Check: "Which tense opens the news? Which tense gives the details?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
for / since + just, already, yet, still	9	T-S	Slide 7. <i>for</i> = a length, <i>since</i> = a start point: quick-fire (T: "2020" → S: "since 2020"; T: "three weeks" → S: "for three weeks"). Then the four adverbs and their positions, with one mime each (<i>just</i> = snap fingers; <i>still</i> = shake head, impatient). CCQs.
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start Ex 5.
Freer: Timeline interview	14	S → S-S → T-S	Slides 8–9. Read the model dialogue with a strong learner. (1) Each learner draws their own timeline on the card with 4–5 small events as pictures or one word (real, a new identity card, or imagined), and one thing that is still true now (3 min). (2) Swap timelines. The partner interviews: open with the present perfect ("Have you ever...? / How long have you...?"), then ask for details in the past simple ("When did you...? What happened? How was it?") (4 min each way). (3) 3–4 learners tell the class one story about their partner (3 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first: "Who heard a surprising story?" Then language: 4 sentences you heard (2 good, 2 with errors, no names), e.g. "I have seen him last week." · "I work here since three years." Learners fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 15 + 3 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 9 + 9 + 14 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The welcome mingle is the most important part of C1. Do not cut it: the group needs it, and you need the diagnostic. Cut instead: Ex 4 goes to homework, and the dictation (Script 1.1-B) moves to the C2 warmer. Keep at least 10 minutes for the timeline interview, because it is the first real B1 speaking task.

◆ RUNNING THE DIAGNOSTIC – WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

The mingle is a friendly first conversation, not a test. Learners must never feel watched. Hold the grid on a clipboard, stand near a pair for 30–60 seconds, and join in sometimes ("Oh, have you really cooked for fifty

people? I haven't!"). Mark each learner ✓ (easy and accurate) · ~ (understands, some errors) · ✗ (can't produce it yet) in four columns:

- ◆ **PAST SIMPLE:** irregular verbs (*went, bought, saw*), *Did you...?* and *didn't* + base verb. Listen for "I goed," "Did you went?" and "I no went."
- ◆ **PRESENT PERFECT:** *Have you ever...?* + past participle, *I've never...*, short answers. Listen for "Have you ever went?", "I have see," and present perfect with a finished time.
- ◆ **FUTURE FORMS:** *going to* for plans, *will / might* for guesses, present continuous for arrangements. Listen for "I going to," "I will to," and the present simple for a plan ("Tomorrow I visit...").
- ◆ **FLUENCY:** Does the learner give more than one sentence? Ask a question back? Keep going when they don't know a word? This column matters most at B1.

What to do with the results: Mostly ✓ and ~ = ready for B1. Many ~ in the PRESENT PERFECT column is normal: that is exactly what C1–C2 teach. ✗ in two or three columns = check the placement privately (the toolkit's oral placement interview takes 5 minutes); the learner may do better in the A2 course, or may need extra support from Day 1. Lots of ✓ and strong fluency = give stretch tasks and consider the B2 course later. **Never share the grid with learners.** Keep it; compare it with Progress Test 1 in C13.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WELCOME MINGLE

SAY: *How many cards do you take? (Three, one of each color.) · How many questions do you ask each person? (One, and one follow-up question.) · After you talk, what do you do with the cards? (Swap them.) · Then? (Find a new partner.) · Do you have to answer about your real life? (No. You can use a new identity card, or say "Pass.")*

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning. The choice is **not** about how long ago. It is about whether the time is **finished** (past simple) or the action is **connected to now** (present perfect: an experience in my life up to now, news with a result now, or a situation that is still true).

SAY: *"I've lost my keys." Do I have my keys now? (No.) Do we know when I lost them? (No.) Is that important? (No, the result is important: I can't open the door!)*

SAY: *"I lost my keys yesterday." When? (Yesterday.) Is yesterday finished? (Yes.) Can I say "I've lost my keys yesterday"? (No! A finished time word needs the past simple.)*

SAY: *"She has lived here for ten years." Does she live here now? (Yes.) · "She lived there for ten years." Does she live there now? (No.)*

SAY: *"I've been to Japan." Am I in Japan now? (No, I went and came back.) · "She's gone to Japan." Is she here now? (No, she's in Japan.)*

SAY: "I've just finished." A long time ago or a short time ago? (Very short.) · "I still haven't finished." Did I finish? (No.) Am I surprised or a bit unhappy? (Yes.)

Form. Learners know both forms. Put them side by side and focus on the time words:

Past simple	subject + past form (+ finished time)	I saw that movie last Friday. · Did you see it? — Yes, I did.
Present perfect	subject + have / has + past participle	I've seen it three times. · Have you ever been to Canada?
for / since	for + a period · since + a start point	for ten years, for a long time · since 2014, since Monday, since I was a child
just / already	between <i>have</i> and the participle	I've just finished lunch. · She's already left.
yet / still	yet at the end (? and –) · still before <i>haven't</i>	Have you eaten yet ? · I haven't eaten yet . · I still haven't packed.
Open → details	present perfect (no time) → past simple (time, place, how)	I've run a marathon. I ran it last year in Boston. It was really hard.

Pronunciation. Use the contractions: *I've* /aɪv/, *she's* /ʃɪz/, *haven't* /'hævənt/. The 've is small but it carries the meaning: "I've seen it" vs "I seen it" (non-standard). Have learners say /v/ with teeth on the lip. *for* is weak: /fər/ ("fer ten years"). *been* is usually weak: /bɪn/. *Have you ever...?* links: /həv jə 'evər/. Questions with *yet* rise at the end ("Have you eaten **yet**? ↗").

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Time-word switch:** T: "I've seen that movie." + "last Friday" → S: "I saw that movie last Friday." T: "She's called me." + "yesterday" → S: "She called me yesterday." T: "We visited Chicago." + "three times" → S: "We've visited Chicago three times." Choral, then individuals.
- 2 for or since?** T: "2021" → S: "since 2021." "six months" → "for six months." "last summer" → "since last summer." "ages" → "for ages." Then full sentences: "I've known her... (2014)" → "I've known her since 2014."
- 3 Open → details chain:** T: "I've been to a big concert." → S1: "When did you go?" → T: "I went in May." → S2: "Who did you go with?"... Then S1 opens with a new experience and the class asks.
- 4 just / already / yet / still** with mimes: T snaps fingers + "finish" → S: "I've just finished." T shakes head impatiently + "not / call me" → S: "She still hasn't called me." T: "you / eat?" + rising hand → S: "Have you eaten yet?"

◆ TIMELINE INTERVIEW – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Model first with **your** timeline on the board: 4 small pictures or words (🍞 bread class, 🚲 bike, 🎸 guitar, ✈️ Mexico) and one arrow to NOW (📅 "teach English"). Invite learners to interview you.
- ◆ Learners draw **pictures or one word** only, no sentences. Years are optional. Events can be small and happy: a first cake, a new phone, a concert, a good book, a new skill. **Nobody has to put their real life on paper.** A new identity card has a ready-made timeline.
- ◆ The interviewer opens with the present perfect: "I see a guitar. **Have you ever played** in a band?" / "**How long have you had** your bike?" Then asks for details in the past simple: "**When did you start? Who taught you? How was it?**"
- ◆ The speaker answers in **full, long turns**: 2–3 sentences for every question. Stronger pairs add *just* / *already* / *yet* / *still*.
- ◆ Report: "Kofi has played the guitar since 2020. He learned from videos, and he played at a wedding last year!"

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE TIMELINE INTERVIEW

SAY: *Do you write sentences on your timeline? (No, pictures or one word.) · Must it be your real life? (No. A new identity card or an imagined life is fine.) · What tense is the first question? (Present perfect: "Have you ever...?") · And the next questions? (Past simple: "When did you...?") · How long are your answers? (Two or three sentences.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Draw the timeline for the learner if needed, from what they say. Give a phrase strip: "Have you ever...?" / "Yes, I have. / No, I've never..." / "When did you...?" / "I... in / last / ago." In the sort, use the picture side of the time cards (📅 17) for finished, ➡️● for connected to now). Target: two experiences, each with one past-simple detail. Workbook: Ex 1 (listening) and Ex 2, items 1–5 only.

STRETCH

Use *still* and *so far* ("I've visited four states so far"). Explain **why** each tense fits, in their own words (the online journal task). In the interview, ask a surprise follow-up the speaker didn't plan. Early finishers write 3 pairs of sentences about the same thing: one present perfect, one past simple ("I've broken my phone!" / "I broke it this morning.").

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "**I have seen him yesterday.**" French (*passé composé*), German (*Perfekt*), Italian (*passato prossimo*), Dutch and Spanish (in Spain) use a "have" tense for finished past time. Point at the FINISHED box on the board every time.
- ◆ "**I live here since five years**" / "**I am here since Monday.**" Spanish *desde hace*, French *depuis*, German *seit*, Portuguese *há*, Russian and Polish all use the present. It's understood; recast: "Oh, you've lived here

for five years."

- ◆ **"since three years" / "for 2019."** The same languages use one word for both (*depuis, desde, seit*). Drill: length → **for**; start → **since**.
- ◆ **Past simple everywhere** ("Did you ever eat sushi?", "I already ate"): Chinese, Vietnamese, Arabic, Russian, Tagalog and Korean have no present perfect. Also normal in American English, so don't mark it wrong in speech; practice the present perfect as the safe choice.
- ◆ **Portuguese *tenho feito*** means "I've been doing (again and again)," so Brazilian learners may avoid "I've done." Give lots of "I've + participle" for single experiences.
- ◆ **Dropped endings:** Vietnamese, Cantonese and some Spanish speakers drop the final /v/ in I've and the /t/ or /d/ in *worked, lived*. Say it slowly: "I've — lived — here."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_01.html. Listen to the model sentences and the marathon dialogue with 🎧 and say them out loud. Do the exercises, the Quick Quiz and the 2-minute speaking project (record it on a phone if possible). Workbook 1.1: finish Ex 5, "My new words" and the journal (two sentences about the same event, one present perfect and one past simple, and why).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B I called him yesterday. · Q2 A for · Q3 (new) B gone (she's there now). Sam's news (Ex 1): 1 he's started a new job (at a hotel) · 2 two weeks ago · 3 no, never · 4 at a bank, for three years · 5 yes, on his first day · 6 learned everyone's name · 7 finished her exams.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ form the present perfect continuous: *I've / she's been + -ing, haven't been, Have you been...?, How long have you been...?*
- ◆ use it for an activity that started in the past and is **still going on**, with *for / since*: *I've been studying English for three years.*
- ◆ use it for a **recent activity with a result we can see now**: *His hands are dirty. He's been fixing the car.*
- ◆ choose the simple for a result or a number (how many?) and the continuous for the activity (how long?)
- ◆ keep stative verbs (*know, like, want, have* = own...) in the simple form

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "What have I been doing lately?" table)
- ◆ Slides 10–13 · **Find Someone Who: Have you ever...?** (Set H, 1 per learner) · clue-picture flashcards (Set A) · **"What have you been doing?" clue game** (Set F, 1 deck per group of 3–4) · New identity cards · a paintbrush, a dish towel with flour, or a gym bag for the lead-in
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.2-A (Catching up) and 1.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: subject + **have / has + been + -ing**. *I've been working.* · *She's been studying.* · *They haven't been sleeping well.* · **How long have you been waiting?**

Center: a time line with a wavy line from "9 a.m." to ● NOW: "It's been raining **all day**." Below: two uses. 🕒 **How long?** (still going) · 👁️ **Evidence now** (paint on hands → "I've been painting").

Right: two columns. **HOW MANY?** → simple: *I've written three emails.* · **HOW LONG?** → continuous: *I've been writing emails all morning.* Below, a red box: **know · like · want · need · believe · understand · have (= own)** → no -ing!

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Find Someone Who	8	S–S (mingle)	Review C1. Learners mingle with the "Have you ever...?" sheet. When someone says "Yes, I have," they ask one past-simple follow-up ("When did you...?"). 5 min of mingling, then 3 learners report: "Omar has met a famous person. He met a soccer player at the airport!"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Lead-in: "Sorry I'm late!"	5	T-S	Walk in (or turn around) out of breath, with flour on your hands or a paintbrush. "Look at me! What have I been doing?" Accept any guess, then say it: "I've been painting my kitchen! I've been painting since eight o'clock!" Write it on the board. "Did I stop painting? (Yes, just now.) Can you see it? (Yes, my hands!)"
Form + Use 1: how long?	12	T-S	Slide 11. Form (board, left), then the main use: an activity that is still going on, with <i>for</i> / <i>since</i> / <i>all day</i> . CCQs and drill (below). Pairs ask each other two real questions: "How long have you been learning English? / coming to this school?"
Use 2: evidence now	5	T-S	Slide 10. Show 4 clue-picture flashcards (mechanic, swim, garden, bus stop). "His hands are dirty. What has he been doing?" → "He's been fixing the car." CCQs. Keep it fast: the clue game later practices it.
Listening: Catching up	7	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.2-A twice (both voices, or ask a confident learner to read Marco). Learners complete the table: what, how long, and the result. Pairs compare.
Simple vs continuous + stative verbs	12	T-S	Slide 12. Two sentences from the listening: "I've been practicing every evening." / "I've learned about ten songs." "Which one answers how many ? Which one answers how long ?" Board, right. Then the stative-verb box: "I've been knowing her  → I've known her  . " CCQs. Quick-fire: T says a verb + time; learners choose ("know / ten years" → "I've known her for ten years").</td
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on (usually Ex 3). Early finishers: Ex 5 (stative trap).
Freer 1: clue game	13	S-S (groups)	Slide 13. Groups of 3-4 with a clue-card deck . Player A takes a card and acts it or reads the clue in the first person ("Look at my hands! There's paint everywhere!"). The others guess: " Have you been painting?" A: "Yes, I have! / No, I haven't." First correct guess wins the card; the winner asks one "How many / How much...?" question and A answers in the simple ("I've painted two rooms!"). ICQs first.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer 2: catching up	8	S-S	New partners, standing, like old friends in the street. Each person prepares 3 lines of the "lately" table (real, a new identity card, or imagined) (2 min). Then chat: "Hi! What have you been doing lately?" → 2-3 sentences → "How long have you been...?" → one result in the simple (5 min). Two pairs perform 30 seconds (1 min).
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first (the funniest clue, the most interesting "lately" news). Then 4 heard sentences: "I have working all day." · "I've been knowing him for years." · "I've been reading three books." · "He have been running." Learners fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 1.2; workbook "My new words" and the journal. Preview C3: bring or photograph something old (a photo, a map, an old phone) if you want.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 5 + 7 + 12 + 10 + 13 + 8 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Shorten the Find Someone Who to 5 minutes (no report) and set Ex 4 as homework. Keep both freer tasks, but you can make "catching up" a single round of 5 minutes. Don't cut the stative-verb box: it is the most common B1 error with this tense.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning 1: duration up to now. An activity started in the past and is still going on. We want the listener to *feel* the time.

SAY: "I've been studying English for three years." When did I start? (Three years ago.) Am I still studying? (Yes.) Is it finished? (No.) Which question does it answer: how long or how many? (How long.)

SAY: "It's been raining all day." Is it raining now? (Probably yes.) When did it start? (This morning.)

Meaning 2: a recent activity, a result now. The activity maybe stopped a moment ago, but we can see or feel the result.

SAY: "I'm tired. I've been running." Am I running now? (No, I just stopped.) How do you know I was running? (You're tired, red, out of breath.) · "Your eyes are red. Have you been swimming?" Is this a question about the eyes or the activity? (The activity.)

Meaning 3: simple or continuous?

SAY: "I've painted the kitchen." Is the job finished? (Yes.) · "I've been painting the kitchen." Is it finished? (Maybe not.) Why is the kitchen messy? (Because I've been painting.) · "I've written three emails." How many? (Three.) Simple or continuous? (Simple: we count it.)

SAY: "I've known her for ten years." Can I say "I've been knowing her"? (No.) Why? (Know is a state, not an activity.) · "I've been having problems with my laptop." Is this OK? (Yes: having problems = experiencing, an activity.)

Form. Three pieces that never change order: **have / has + been + verb-ing**. Only *have / has* changes.

Positive	subject + have / has been + -ing	I've been working. · She's been studying.
Negative	haven't / hasn't been + -ing	They haven't been sleeping well lately.
Question	Have / Has + subject + been + -ing?	Have you been waiting long? — Yes, I have. / No, I haven't.
How long?	How long have / has + subject + been + -ing?	How long have you been learning to drive?
Simple vs continuous	how many / result → simple · how long / activity → continuous	I've read 50 pages. · I've been reading for two hours.
Stative verbs	know, like, love, hate, want, need, believe, understand, be, have (= own), belong	simple only: I've had this car since 2019.

Pronunciation. *been* is weak and short, like "bin" /bɪn/: "I've been waiting" = /aɪv bɪn 'weɪtɪŋ/. Say 've been as one quick piece. The stress goes on the main verb and the time: "I've been **WORKing** here since **JUNE**." In *How long have you been...?* only **long** and the main verb are strong: "How **LONG** have you been **WAITing**?" Some learners over-pronounce the *-ing* as /ɪŋg/ (Spanish, Arabic, Cantonese): keep the /ŋ/ soft, no hard /g/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Back-chain:** "for three years" → "studying English for three years" → "been studying English for three years" → "I've been studying English for three years." Choral ×3, then individuals.
- 2 Person substitution:** T: "She... work here... since June" → S: "She's been working here since June." T: "They... wait... for an hour" → S: "They've been waiting for an hour." T: "It... rain... all day" → S: "It's been raining all day."
- 3 How long? question,** open pairs: S1: "How long have you been learning English?" S2: "For two years / Since 2023." S2 → S3 with a new verb (living in this apartment, working at..., driving, cooking...). Remind: a new identity answer is fine.

- 4 **Evidence prompts** (flashcards or mime): wet hair → "You've been swimming!" · black hands → "He's been fixing the car." · yawning → "You haven't been sleeping well." · flour on hands → "She's been baking."
- 5 **How many or how long?** T: "emails, three" → S: "I've written three emails." T: "emails, all morning" → S: "I've been writing emails all morning." T: "know her, ten years" → S: "I've known her for ten years." (the stative trap)

◆ CLUE GAME – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3–4, one deck face down. Player A takes a card, looks at the picture and the clue, and **acts it out or reads the clue in the first person**: "Oh, my back hurts, and I have mud on my knees!" A must **not** say the activity.
- ◆ The others guess with a full question: "**Have you been gardening?**" A answers "Yes, I have!" or "No, I haven't. Try again!" The small gray hint on the card is for A only.
- ◆ The first correct guesser wins the card and asks **one "how many / how much" question**: "How many flowers have you planted?" A answers in the **simple**: "I've planted twenty!" This is the simple vs continuous switch.
- ◆ Stronger groups: A answers "No, I haven't" to the first correct guess and gives a second clue, to make more questions. Most cards wins.
- ◆ Some cards have more than one good answer ("Your eyes are red": swimming, chopping onions, reading all night...). Any logical guess with the correct form wins.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CLUE GAME

SAY: *Do you say the activity on your card? (No! You act it or read the clue.) · What's the first word of the guess? ("Have.") · Is "Have you painting?" correct? (No. "Have you **been** painting?") · After a correct guess, what question does the winner ask? (How many / how much.) · And the answer is simple or continuous? (Simple: "I've painted two rooms.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on *I've been / you've been + -ing* and one use (evidence). In the clue game, the learner only guesses from the **picture** side; a partner reads the clue aloud. Phrase strip: "Have you been ...ing?" / "Yes, I have. / No, I haven't." / "I've been ...ing for" Target: 3 correct guesses and 2 true sentences about "lately." Workbook: Ex 1, Ex 2 and Ex 4 only.

STRETCH

Use *lately / recently / all week / for ages* naturally. In "catching up," give a reason and a feeling ("I've been getting up at five, so I've been really tired"). Explain the difference between "I've painted the kitchen" and "I've been painting the kitchen" to a partner. Early finishers write 3 clue cards for the game.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I am working here since 2020" / "I work here for two years."** Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, German, Russian and Polish use the present (simple or continuous) for duration up to now. Point at the wavy line on the board: it started in the past → **have been**.
- ◆ **Dropping *been*:** "I have working all day" (Arabic, Chinese, Vietnamese, Tagalog, where there is no helper verb chain). Clap three beats: have — been — working.
- ◆ **Stative verbs in -ing:** "I've been knowing him," "I'm having a car." Common for speakers of Hindi, Urdu, Bengali and other South Asian languages, and heard in Indian and Nigerian English. Accept that it is normal in those varieties, but teach the standard form for tests and work.
- ◆ **"He have been":** learners who drop the he/she -s (Chinese, Vietnamese, Haitian Creole speakers) also drop the *has*. Color **has** on the board.
- ◆ **Counted results with -ing:** "I've been reading three books." Common for everybody who has just learned the new form. Ask: "How many or how long?"

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_02.html. Listen to the model sentences and the "catching up" dialogue with 🗣️ and read them aloud. Do the three exercises, the Quick Quiz and the 2-minute project "What have you been up to?". Workbook 1.2: finish Ex 5, the "lately" table, "My new words" and the journal (one continuous + one simple sentence about the same activity, and one corrected stative-verb mistake).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** She has been working here since May. · Q2 **A** written · Q3 (new) **B** I've known her since we were at school.
Catching up (Ex 1): Lena: taking a driving class · since January · 8 lessons, drove on the highway twice. Marco: working at the new supermarket · three months · always tired (gets up at five). Marco: practicing the guitar · every evening · learned about ten songs. Marco: fixing his bike · just now · dirty hands, fixed the chain (not the light).

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use *used to* + base verb for past habits and past states that are not true now: *People used to write letters. There used to be a movie theater here.*
- ◆ make negatives and questions with *did* and the correct spelling: *didn't use to, Did you use to...?*
- ◆ use *would* + base verb for repeated past actions once the past setting is clear: *Every Sunday we would...*
- ◆ know that *would* does **not** work for states (*live, like, have, be, know*)
- ◆ discuss how technology, work and daily life have changed, and say whether life was better before, with a reason

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, discussion notes)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · "then and now" flashcards (Set A) · **How life has changed** topic cards + role cards (Set G, 1 set per group of 4) · talking tokens (3 per learner) · an old object or photo (a paper map, an old phone, a phone book, a photo of a pay phone) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.3-A (Then and now: three voices) and 1.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: THEN | NOW. "People **used to** write letters. | Now we send messages." "There **used to be** a video store here. | Now it's a phone store." Below: I **didn't use to** like coffee. · **Did you use to** have a bike? → Yes, I **did**. / No, I **didn't**.

Center: a red circle around the **d**: used to  → didn't used to · Did you used to...? Pronunciation: / 'ju:stə/ (an s sound, not a z).

Right: two columns. **ACTIONS** (visit, walk, cook, watch): used to  would . **STATES** (live, like, have, be, know): used to  would . Below: "Every summer we **would** drive to the lake." (the time frame first!)

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: catching up	8	S-S → T-S	Review C2. Pairs: "What have you been doing since our last class?" (2 sentences each + one "how long?" question). Then 3 fast clue cards with the whole class: you read the clue, learners guess "Have

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			you been...?" Two volunteers read their journal pair (continuous + simple).
Lead-in: then and now	8	T-S → S-S	Hold up your old object (a paper map). "What's this? Do we use it now?" Elicit: "People used to use paper maps. Now we use our phones." Slide 14: then-and-now pictures. Pairs make one "used to... now..." sentence for 3 pictures. Take 4–5 answers. Write two on the board.
Grammar: used to (+ – ?)	13	T-S	Slide 15. Meaning (not true now), form, and the spelling after did (board, center). CCQs and drill (below), including the /'justə/ pronunciation. Quick-fire negatives and questions: T: "like coffee" → S: "I didn't use to like coffee." / "Did you use to like coffee?"
Listening: Then and now	7	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.3-A (three short voices) twice. Learners write True or False, then in pairs: "Whose job has changed the most?"
would + the state rule	12	T-S	Slide 16. Read the grandmother's farm paragraph from the online lesson (or tell your own memory): "Every morning my grandmother would wake me at dawn..." "Is <i>would</i> about the future here? (No! Past habits.)" Then the key rule (board, right): actions → both; states → <i>used to</i> only. CCQs. Quick sort: T says a verb; learners show one finger (only <i>used to</i>) or two (both).
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 3 (used to or would?) together: this is the key B1 judgment. Early finishers start Ex 5.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer: How life has changed	20	S → S-S (groups of 4) → T-S	Slide 17. (1) Groups of 4 get the role cards (chair, timekeeper, questioner, reporter) and 3 talking tokens each; ICQs (2 min). (2) Each group chooses two topic cards (phones, shopping, work, getting around, free time, food, money, learning). Think time: 2 minutes of silent notes in Workbook Speaking (2 × <i>used to</i> , 1 × <i>would</i> , 1 opinion) (2 min). (3) Discussion: 5 minutes per topic (10 min). Everyone talks about people in general, a place they know, their own life, or a new identity card . (4) Reporters give the group's answer to "Was it better before, or is it better now?" with one reason; quick class vote (6 min).
Feedback + module check	5	T-S	Content first: the most interesting change, the best reason. Then 4 heard sentences: "I would live in a small town." · "Did you used to walk to work?" · "I used to went to the market." · "Before, I use to go by bus." Learners fix them. Then learners tick the Module 1 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 1.3; workbook Ex 5 and the journal; preview C4: "Next class: <i>If it rains, we'll...</i> What will you do if it rains this weekend?"
Total	90		8 + 8 + 13 + 7 + 12 + 12 + 20 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Never cut the discussion: it is the first real B1 group discussion and the goal of the whole module. Instead, do one topic card instead of two (5 minutes less), and set Ex 4 as homework. If the class is small (6 or fewer), do the discussion as one group with you as a quiet timekeeper.

Meaning: used to. A habit or a state in the past that is **not true now**. Everyone hears the unspoken "...but not anymore."

SAY: "I used to smoke." Did I smoke in the past? (Yes.) Once or many times? (Many times, a habit.) Do I smoke now? (No.) · "There used to be a movie theater here." Is it here now? (No, it's gone.)

SAY: "Did you use to have a bike?" Is this about now or the past? (The past.) What's the short answer? ("Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.")

Meaning: would. Repeated past actions in a story or a memory, after the past setting is clear.

SAY: "When I was a child, every Sunday my father would cook a big breakfast." Is this about the future? (No.) An imagined situation? (No.) One time or many times? (Many times, every Sunday.) · "I would live in Rome." Is this OK for a past state? (No. Live is a state: "I used to live in Rome.")

SAY: "I lived in Rome for two years." / "I used to live in Rome." Do I live in Rome now? (No, in both.) Which one feels like a general memory? (used to.) Which one gives the exact length? (The past simple.)

Form.

Positive	subject + used to + base verb	I used to walk to school. · There used to be a bakery here.
Negative	subject + didn't use to + base verb	I didn't use to like coffee.
Question	Did + subject + use to + base verb?	Did you use to play an instrument? — Yes, I did. / No, I didn't.
would	subject + would (+ always / often) + base verb	Every summer we would visit my grandparents. · He would always tell jokes.
The rule	actions: used to or would · states: used to only	We would go to the beach.  · We would have a dog.  → We used to have a dog. 
Not the same!	be used to + -ing = be comfortable with (a present feeling)	I'm used to getting up early. (Not today's lesson: just recognize it.)

Pronunciation. *used to* is one quick word: /'justə/ ("YOO-stuh"), with an **s** sound, not a **z**, and a weak *to*. *use to* (after *did*) sounds the same, so the spelling rule only matters in writing. *would* is usually 'd after a pronoun: "we'd go," "she'd always sing." Stress the contrast words: "We **USED** to write **LETTERS**. **NOW** we send **MESSAGES**."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Then → now** (flashcards): T shows the post office + phone: "letters / messages" → S: "People used to write letters. Now they send messages." Next: "cash / cards," "paper maps / GPS," "video store / streaming."
- 2 **Negative and question**: T: "I liked vegetables." (shake head) → S: "I didn't use to like vegetables." T: "you / have a nickname?" → S: "Did you use to have a nickname?" → another S: "Yes, I did. / No, I didn't."
- 3 **/ˈjuːstə/ chorally**: "used to — used to be — there used to be — there used to be a bakery here." Check nobody says "use-ed to."
- 4 **One finger or two?** T says: "live near the sea" (1: only used to) · "play soccer every Saturday" (2: both) · "have long hair" (1) · "visit my aunt every summer" (2) · "know everyone" (1) · "tell stories at night" (2). Then S says the sentence with *would* for every "2."
- 5 **Memory chain**: T: "When I was younger, every Saturday I would..." → S1 continues with *would* + an action → S2 adds another... (real or imagined).

◆ HOW LIFE HAS CHANGED — HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Topics, not biographies.** Every card is about the world: phones, shopping, work, getting around, free time, food, money, learning. Learners can talk about **people in general** ("People used to..."), **a place they know** (any place: this city, a TV show, their workplace), **their own life**, or **a new identity card**. Never ask a learner to say which country they are talking about.
- ◆ **Roles** (on the role cards): the **chair** asks each person in turn and invites quiet people ("Kofi, what do you think?"); the **timekeeper** says "One minute left!"; the **questioner** asks one follow-up per person ("Did people use to...?"); the **reporter** takes notes and gives the group's answer at the end. Give the chair role to a confident speaker, and the reporter role to someone who talks a lot but listens little.
- ◆ **Talking tokens**: 3 per person. Put one in the middle when you take a long turn. When your tokens are gone, you can ask questions but not give opinions, until everyone has used theirs.
- ◆ **Discussion shape** on each card: How did people use to...? → What would people do every day / week? → What's different now? → Was it better before, or is it better now? Why? Model an opinion phrase: "I think it was better before, because..." / "In my opinion, it's better now, because..."
- ◆ Listen and note 6 sentences for feedback. Don't correct during the discussion unless the meaning breaks down.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DISCUSSION

SAY: *How many topics does your group talk about? (Two.) · What do you do before you talk? (Two minutes of silent notes.) · Chair, what's your job? (Ask everyone. Help quiet people talk.) · What do you do with a token? (Put it down when I take a long turn.) · Do you have to talk about your own life? (No.*

People in general, a place, or a new identity card.) · Can we use *would* with "live" or "have"? (No! Only *used to*.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use only *used to* (positive) and "Now..." with the then-and-now picture cards. Sentence frame: "People used to _____. Now they _____." Give the learner the **timekeeper** role (it needs a clock, not reading) and let a partner read the topic card aloud. Target: 3 then-and-now sentences and one opinion ("It was better before / It's better now"). Workbook: Ex 1, Ex 2 items 1 and 4, and Ex 5 with pictures.

STRETCH

Use *would* for a whole memory of 4–5 sentences after one past-simple scene-setter. Add *anymore / any longer / these days / nowadays*. In the discussion, disagree politely with a reason ("I see your point, but..."). Early finishers: write the paragraph for Ex 5 with one negative and one question, and explain the difference between "I used to get up early" and "I'm used to getting up early."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "I use to go to the gym" for a present habit. Spanish *suelo*, Portuguese *costumo* and Italian *di solito* work in the present, so many learners say "I use to drink coffee every morning" (meaning *usually*). Very common! Teach: present habit → **usually**; past habit → **used to**.
- ◆ "Before, I live in a village" / "Before I am shy." Arabic, Chinese, Tagalog (*dati*), Vietnamese and Korean use a time word with no past form. It is understood; recast: "Oh, you **used to** live in a village."
- ◆ "I used to went" / "I didn't used to" / "Did you used to...?" Everyone. Point at the red circle on the board.
- ◆ "I would live in Rome" for a past state: learners who have just met *would* for past habits over-use it. Ask: "Action or state?"
- ◆ "I was used to walk to school" (Russian, Polish and French speakers mixing *used to* with *be used to*). Keep *be used to* for recognition only today.
- ◆ "use-ed to" with three syllables or a /z/ sound (Spanish, Portuguese, Japanese, Korean speakers read the spelling). Drill /'justə/.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_03.html. Listen to the model sentences and the "old neighborhood" conversation with 🎧 and say them. Do the exercises, the Quick Quiz and the project "How things used to be" (6+ sentences, spoken or recorded; any topic from class is fine). Workbook 1.3: finish Ex 5, "My new words" and the journal (one *used to* state, one *would* action, one negative or question, and why).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** Did you use to live here? · Q2 **A** used to · Q3 (new) **B** There used to be a movie theater on Main Street. Then and now (Ex 1): 1 T · 2 F (they didn't use to shop online) · 3 T · 4 F (she works on the phone and online now) · 5 T · 6 F (he liked it better before).

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C3: MODULE 1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, the "past to now" line: **I've been to...** / **I went...** (experience → details) → **I've been ...ing for...** (still going) → **I used to...** / **We would...** (not true now). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C4 warmer and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 2: conditionals bring back *would*, but with a different meaning (*If I had more time, I would...*). Learners who just learned *would* for past habits may be confused. Say it clearly in C5: "Same word, different job. Last week: past habits. Now: imagined situations." Keep a 2-minute "then and now" or "lately" warmer in C4–C6.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: present perfect vs past simple with time words, *for* / *since*, *just* / *already* / *yet* / *still*, *been* vs *gone*, the form of the present perfect continuous, simple vs continuous (how many / how long), stative verbs, *used to* / *didn't use to* / *Did ... use to...?*, and *used to* vs *would* for states and actions. The speaking task may ask learners to describe how something has changed.

Module 2 — If & Imagining (Conditionals)

Three classes that move from the real world to the imagined one. First, the **zero conditional** for facts, habits and life hacks and the **first conditional** for real, likely futures (with *when* and *unless*). Then the **second conditional** for dreams, dilemmas and advice (*If I were you, I'd...*). Last, **wish / if only** for small, everyday wishes about the present, and *wish + would* for mild annoyances.

3 lessons

Lessons 2.1–2.3

Classes C4–C6

Weeks 2–3

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-2-conditionals.html](#). Print [materials/module-2/classroom-materials.html](#) before C4. It holds the flashcards, the "imagine a person" identity cards, the listening scripts, the **Life Hacks & Superstitions card sort**, the conditional-plans role-play, the **dilemma cards**, the advice role-play, the **Small Wishes, Real Fixes** cards and the Wish Mingle (Find Someone Who).
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home.
- This is extension, not a first meeting.** A2 Lesson 6.1 taught the first conditional (*If it rains, I'll stay home*). Most B1 learners will recognize it, and many will still say "If it will rain." Check fast in the lead-in and spend your time on the new B1 work: zero vs first, *when* vs *if*, *unless*, the second conditional, *were*, and *wish*. Keep models inside B1: **no third or mixed conditionals** and no *wish + had done* (past regrets are B2). If a strong learner asks, give one example and say "That's for the next level."
- American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons sometimes use British forms (*flat*, *flatmate*, *holiday*, *football*, *films*, *grey*, *neighbour*, *practise*, *organised*, *apologise*, 100°C). Teach *apartment*, *roommate*, *vacation*, *soccer*, *movies*, *gray*, *neighbor*, *practice*, *organized*, *apologize*, and give temperatures in °F with °C in brackets. Accept the British forms when learners use them.
- Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Real → imagined → wished for. In C4 learners talk about what is *always* true (life hacks, habits, facts) and what will *really* happen (*If I finish early on Friday, I'll cook something nice*). In C5 they step out of reality: *If I found a wallet, I'd..., If I were you, I'd...* In C6 they use the same "unreal past" to say what they want to be different right now: *I wish it were sunny. I wish I could sing. I wish the bus would come on time.* The one big idea across the module: **the verb shows how real the situation is.** Present = real. Past = unreal (not past time!). Build the "reality line" on the board in C4 and add to it in C5 and C6.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: KEEP THE "WHAT IFS" AND WISHES SMALL

Conditionals and wishes can open painful doors for adult newcomers: "What would you do if you could go home?", "I wish my family were here," "If only I had stayed...". **Never ask** about home countries, family far away, migration, papers, war, illness or money worries, and never use them as examples. Every task in this module uses **light, everyday topics**: life hacks, superstitions, a found wallet, a lottery win, superpowers, the weather, skills, the commute, the phone, a noisy neighbor. For every personal task offer three choices out loud: **your real answer, an "imagine a person" card** (in the classroom materials), or **an invented answer**. Anyone can say "Pass" at any time. Say it every time, so choosing a card is normal and not a sign that something is wrong. If a learner shares something heavy anyway, thank them simply ("Thank you for telling us"), don't dig, and move the group on to the next card.

B1 SPEAKING: FLUENCY FIRST, AND ROOM FOR EVERYONE

Fluency before accuracy. In every freer stage, don't interrupt to correct. Walk around with a notepad, write down 4–6 sentences you hear (good ones and wrong ones), and use them in the Feedback stage with no names. First give feedback on **content** ("Which dilemma got the most different answers?"), then on language. Correct on the spot only in the drill and controlled stages. **Dominant speakers:** give each learner three **talking tokens** (paper clips, coins) per discussion; each turn costs one, and when yours are gone you listen and ask questions. Give roles: **asker** (reads the card), **timekeeper** (1 minute per person), **reporter** (tells the class). Always go around the circle once before open discussion, and say "Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet." Quiet learners can write their answer first and then read it.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **picture flashcards** (one set for the board): life hacks & superstitions, dreams & dilemmas, small wishes (weather, skills, commute). Card stock helps. Cut them before C4.
- For C4: one **Life Hacks & Superstitions card sort** set per group of 3 (32 half-cards + 3 column headers). Cut and put each set in an envelope. Bring sticky notes (or strips of paper and tape) for the class "Life Hack Wall."
- For C5: one set of **conditional-plans role-play** cards per pair (warmer), one set of **dilemma cards** per group of 3–4 + a reaction-phrase strip for each learner, and one set of **advice role-play** A/B cards per pair.

- For C6: one set of **Small Wishes, Real Fixes** cards per pair and one **Wish Mingle** (Find Someone Who) sheet per learner.
- Print the **"imagine a person"** cards and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- Talking tokens for the discussions: 3 paper clips or coins per learner. For the C4 lead-in, a wooden spoon (or a photo of a spoon across a pot) is a fun prop.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.1	C4 • wk 2	Zero conditional (<i>If / When</i> + present, present) for facts, habits, life hacks · first conditional (<i>If</i> + present, <i>will / won't</i>) for real futures · never will after if · the comma · <i>when</i> vs <i>if</i> · <i>unless</i> = <i>if ... not</i> · results with <i>can / might</i> / imperative	share life hacks and superstitions, say which are "always true" and which are predictions, and make 6+ real plans and warnings with <i>If I...</i> , <i>I'll...</i> , including <i>unless</i> and <i>when</i>
2.2	C5 • wk 3	Second conditional (<i>If</i> + past simple, <i>would / 'd</i> + base verb) for imaginary, unlikely and impossible situations · the past = unreal, not past time · first vs second (how likely?) · <i>were</i> for all persons · <i>If I were you, I'd...</i> for advice · <i>could / might</i> in the result	discuss everyday dilemmas and dreams ("What would you do if...?"), give a reason, agree or disagree politely, and give friendly advice with <i>If I were you, I'd...</i>
2.3	C6 • wk 3	<i>wish / if only</i> + past simple (present wishes) · the "flip" (wish = opposite of reality) · <i>wish</i> + <i>were</i> · <i>wish</i> + <i>could</i> (ability) · <i>wish</i> + <i>would</i> (someone else's annoying behavior, never yourself) · <i>hope</i> vs <i>wish</i>	say 6+ small, true or invented wishes about the weather, skills and the commute, complain kindly with <i>I wish ... would...</i> , and suggest a real fix with a conditional

2.1 • C4

Zero & First Conditional — Life Hacks, Superstitions & Real Plans

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use the **zero conditional** (*If / When* + present simple, present simple) for facts, habits and life hacks: *If you freeze grapes, they make great ice cubes.*
- ◆ use the **first conditional** (*If* + present simple, *will / won't* + base verb) for one real, likely future: *If it rains this afternoon, I'll take the bus.*
- ◆ keep *will* out of the *if*-clause and the *when*-clause (*when I **get** home*, not "when I will get home")
- ◆ choose *when* (sure) or *if* (possible), and use *unless* (= if ... not) with a positive verb
- ◆ put a comma after the *if*-clause when it comes first, and use *can / might* or an imperative in the result
- ◆ share and discuss life hacks and superstitions, and say 6+ real plans and warnings about their own week

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My six predictions")
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Picture flashcards (life hacks & superstitions) · **Life Hacks & Superstitions card sort** (1 envelope per group of 3) · sticky notes · talking tokens · "imagine a person" cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.1-A (*Tip Time* radio show) and 2.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the reality line (keep it all module). A long arrow: **ALWAYS TRUE** — **REAL, LIKELY** — **IMAGINED** (leave this end empty today). Under "always true": *If / When* + present, present. Under "real, likely": *If* + present, *will* + verb.

Center: 🔧 If you **freeze** grapes, they **make** great ice cubes. (every time) · 📅 If it **rains** this afternoon, I'll **take** the bus. (one future) · a big red ✗ over "If it ~~will~~ rain" · comma rule: **If** ..., ... / ... **if** ... (no comma)

Right: **when** = I'm sure (When I get home, I'll call you.) · **if** = maybe (If I get the job, I'll celebrate.) · **unless** = if ... not (I'll be late **unless** I leave now.) · Result can be: *will / can / might / an order (tell him!)*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: then and now	8	S-S → T-S	Review C3 (1.3, <i>used to / would</i>). Pairs tell each other 2 things they used to do on weekends as a teenager and 1 thing they

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			would always do (real, an "imagine a person" card, or invented). Two pairs report one surprising habit. Listen for "I use to" and "I would live" (state verb) for the feedback stage.
Lead-in: does it work?	6	T-S	Hold up a wooden spoon (or slide 3's life-hack picture). "My grandmother had a trick. If you put a wooden spoon across a pot of boiling water, the water doesn't boil over. Do you believe it?" Learners vote. Then: "Some people say, if you open an umbrella indoors, you'll have bad luck. Is that a fact or a belief?" Teach life hack and superstition . Ask: "Do you know the first conditional from A2?" Many will. No grammar talk yet.
Grammar: zero conditional	10	T-S	Slide 4. Meaning (always true: facts, habits, how things work), form (present + present; <i>if</i> ≈ <i>when</i>). CCQs and drill (below). Quick-fire: T says a half ("If you heat ice...") → learners finish ("...it melts.").
Grammar: first conditional + the one rule	12	T-S	Slide 5. Contrast on the board: "If you drop a glass, it breaks." (always) / "Careful! If you drop that glass, it'll break." (this glass, now). Form: <i>if</i> + present, <i>will</i> + base verb. Then the rule: no will after if . Put "If it will rain" on the board and cross it out dramatically. Results with <i>can</i> / <i>might</i> / imperative. CCQs and drill.
when / unless / the comma	7	T-S → S	Slide 6. <i>When</i> = sure, <i>if</i> = maybe (CCQs). <i>Unless</i> = if ... not, with a positive verb. The comma: learners copy two sentences from the board and add the comma only where the <i>if</i> -clause is first.
Listening: <i>Tip Time</i>	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.1-A twice. Learners complete the results and write H (life hack / fact), S (superstition) or F (a real

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			future plan). Pairs compare. Point out: the superstitions use <i>will</i> — they sound like predictions.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on (usually Ex 4, <i>when / if / unless</i>). Early finishers start Ex 5.
Freer: Life Hacks & Superstitions card sort	20	S-S (groups of 3) → T-S	Slide 8. (1) Match the 32 half-cards into 16 sentences (5 min). (2) Sort them under the three headers:  Always true ·  Superstition ·  One real future (3 min). Check with the class. (3) Discuss with talking tokens (8 min): "Do you believe it? Have you tried it? Do you know another life hack or superstition?" (4) Each group writes 2 real life hacks on sticky notes with a zero conditional and puts them on the Life Hack Wall ; the class reads the wall (4 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first: "Which life hack will you try this week?" Then delayed correction: 4 heard sentences on the board (no names), e.g. "If it will rain, I stay home." · "Unless you don't hurry, you'll miss it." · "When I will get home, I call you." · one good sentence. Learners fix them together.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 10 + 12 + 7 + 7 + 10 + 20 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning 1: zero conditional = always true. Facts, rules, how a machine works, a person's regular habit, a life hack. The result happens *every time*.

SAY: "If you heat ice, it melts." Is this about one day, or every time? (Every time.) Is it a fact? (Yes.) · "When I'm tired, I drink coffee." Is this a habit? (Yes.) Can I say "If I'm tired" here? (Yes, the same meaning.)

Meaning 2: first conditional = one real, likely future. The speaker thinks it can really happen.

SAY: "If it rains this afternoon, I'll take the bus." Is it raining now? (No.) Is rain possible this afternoon? (Yes, maybe.) Is this about every day or about this afternoon? (This afternoon.) Is it a plan with a condition? (Yes.)

SAY: "If it will rain, I'll take the bus." Is this correct? (No!) Where does will go? (In the result, the other half.) · "When I get home, I'll call you." Will I get home? (Yes, I'm sure.) "If I get the job, I'll celebrate." Will I get the job? (Maybe.)

SAY: "I'll be late unless I leave now." Am I leaving now? (We don't know yet.) What happens if I don't leave now? (I'll be late.) Is "unless I don't leave" OK? (No, the "not" is inside unless.)

Form. Color the *if*-clause in one color and the result in another. Show that the halves can swap.

Zero	If / When + present simple, present simple	If you mix blue and yellow, you get green. · When I drink coffee late, I can't sleep.
First	If + present simple, will / won't + base verb	If we leave now, we won't be late. · If she calls, I'll tell her.
Other results	can / might + base verb · imperative	If you finish early, you can go home. · If you see John, tell him hi.
when / unless	when = sure · if = maybe · unless = if ... not (+ positive verb)	When I get home, I'll call you. · You won't pass unless you study.
Comma	<i>If</i> -clause first → comma · <i>if</i> -clause second → no comma	If I see her, I'll tell her. · I'll tell her if I see her.

Pronunciation. Use the contraction: *I'll* /aɪl/, *it'll* /'ɪtəl/, *we'll*, *won't* /woʊnt/. The *if*-clause **ris**es and waits, the result **fall**s and finishes: "If it **RAINS** ↗ | I'll take the **BUS**. ↘". The pause at the comma is the "comma you can hear." *unless* is stressed on the second syllable: un**LESS** /ʌn'les/. Superstitions are often said with drama: "you'll have **SEVEN** years of **BAD** luck!" — have fun with it.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Rise-fall chant:** "If it rains ↗ | I'll take the bus ↘." Choral ×3 with a hand going up, then down. Half the room says the *if*-half, the other half the result. Swap. Then 4–5 individuals.

- 2 **Finish my sentence** (zero): T: "If you heat ice..." → S: "...it melts." T: "When I'm hungry..." → S: "...I eat a snack." T: "If you don't water plants..." → S: "...they die."
- 3 **Chain** (first): T: "If it's sunny on Saturday, I'll go to the park." S1: "If I go to the park, I'll play soccer." S2: "If I play soccer, I'll be tired." ... around the room. Stop anyone who says "if I will" with the red ✖ gesture; they self-correct.
- 4 **Transform with unless**: T: "I'll be late if I don't leave now." → S: "I'll be late unless I leave now." T: "You won't pass if you don't study." → S: "You won't pass unless you study."
- 5 **when or if?** T gives a situation; learners choose: "I'm sure I'll get home at six." → "When I get home, I'll call you." / "Maybe I'll see Anna." → "If I see Anna, I'll give her the book."

◆ LIFE HACKS & SUPERSTITIONS CARD SORT – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3, one envelope each. Step 1: **match** the *if*-halves (plain border) to the result halves (gray border) to make 16 sentences. The grammar is a clue: a present result or a *will* result.
- ◆ Step 2: **sort** the sentences under the three headers: 🔧 **Always true** (life hacks, facts, habits → zero) · 🍀 **Superstition** (a belief) · 📅 **One real future** (a plan or warning → first). Check with the class (answers in the answer key). Ask: "Look at the superstitions. Zero or first? Why?" (First: people say them like predictions: *you'll have bad luck.*) One superstition uses the zero form (*If your ears are burning, someone is talking about you*) — a nice discussion point.
- ◆ Step 3: **discuss** with talking tokens. Roles: the **asker** reads the questions on the header card, the **timekeeper** gives each person about a minute, the **reporter** remembers the best answer. Go around once before open discussion.
- ◆ Step 4: each group writes **2 life hacks** they really use (cooking, cleaning, phones, saving money, the bus) as zero conditionals on sticky notes and puts them on the **Life Hack Wall**. Leave the wall up for C5.
- ◆ **Superstitions are beliefs, and some are connected to religion or family.** Nobody has to say what they believe, and we never laugh at a belief. Say: "You can talk about a superstition you know, one from a movie, or say 'Pass.'" Keep the talk on everyday, playful superstitions (mirrors, umbrellas, black cats, salt). If someone mentions a serious religious practice, thank them and move on.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CARD SORT

SAY: *How many sentences do you make? (Sixteen.) · After matching, how many groups? (Three: always true, superstition, one real future.) · In the discussion, do you have to say what you believe? (No. You can say "Pass.") · What does a token do? (One token = one turn.) · What do you write on the sticky notes? (Two real life hacks, with "If... / When...")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give 8 of the 16 sentences only (the ones with picture flashcards: umbrella, mirror, salt, water, bread, phone, bus, coffee), and pair the learner with a partner who reads aloud. Focus on one pattern each: zero = "If..., it..." (present, present) and first = "If..., I'll...". Target: 3 spoken sentences with *If..., I'll...* about this week, using the picture cards as prompts, and one life hack said aloud (a partner writes the sticky note).

STRETCH

Use *as soon as* and *before / after* with the same rule ("As soon as I get home, I'll call you."). In the discussion, give a reason for belief or doubt ("I don't believe it, because..."). Write a life hack with *unless* ("Your bread goes hard unless you keep it in a bag."). Early finishers write three warnings for a new learner at the school ("If you're late, the door will be locked. Unless you bring your book, you won't...").

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"If it will rain" / "When I will get home"**: Russian, Polish, Ukrainian, French (*quand je serai*), Portuguese (*quando eu chegar* is subjunctive, but learners may translate as "will"), Tagalog (*kung uulan*, future aspect) and Korean speakers use a future form in the condition. This is the #1 error. Use the red ✗ gesture every time and praise self-correction.
- ◆ **"If it rains, I stay home"** (present in the result for one future): Spanish, German, Dutch and Chinese speakers (the present can mean the future in the L1). It is understood; recast with *I'll*.
- ◆ **"If it rain tomorrow, I go"** (no tense marking at all): Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Haitian Creole speakers. Focus on the -s in the *if*-clause and the 'll in the result. Vietnamese speakers may also drop final /l/ in *I'll*, so "I'll go" sounds like "I go": exaggerate the l.
- ◆ **"unless you don't..."** (double negative): many learners, especially Spanish (*a menos que*), French and Arabic speakers who translate "if not" word for word. Teach: *unless* already has the "not" in it.
- ◆ **when vs if**: German *wenn* means both "if" and "when," so German and Dutch speakers may say "When I win the lottery...". Also Chinese 如果 / 要是 and Arabic *Idj* cover both. CCQ: "Are you sure?"
- ◆ **No comma / comma everywhere**: learners from Arabic, Chinese and Japanese writing traditions punctuate differently. Teach the one rule, and don't mark it hard in speaking tasks.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_04.html. Listen to the model sentences and the "walk this afternoon" conversation with 🗣️ and say them out loud. Do the online exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 2.1: finish Ex 5 ("My six predictions": 6 real or invented plans with *If I..., I'll...*, including one *unless* and one *when*), "My new words" and the journal (one zero conditional about a daily habit + one first conditional plan for tomorrow).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** If it rains, I'll stay home. · Q2 **A** unless · Q3 (new) **B** When I get home tonight, I'll call you. *Tip Time* (Ex 1): 1 doesn't boil over (H) · 2 gets soft again (H) · 3 charges faster (H) · 4 you'll have bad luck (S) · 5 you'll get some money (S) · 6 will start at two (F) · 7 won't go out (F).

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ form the **second conditional**: *If* + past simple, *would* / *'d* / *wouldn't* + base verb: *If I won the lottery, I'd buy a little house by the sea.*
- ◆ understand that the past verb means **unreal**, not past time (*If I had a car...* = I don't have a car now)
- ◆ choose first (real, likely) or second (imaginary, unlikely) conditional for the same idea
- ◆ use *were* for all persons, and give friendly advice with *If I were you, I'd... / I wouldn't...*
- ◆ use *could* and *might* in the result: *If I had a car, I could drive you home.*
- ◆ discuss everyday dilemmas: say what they would do, give a reason, and agree or disagree politely

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "What would you do if...?")
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Flashcards (dreams & dilemmas) · **Conditional-plans role-play** A/B (warmer, 1 set per pair) · **Dilemma cards** (1 set per group of 3–4) + reaction-phrase strips · **Advice role-play** A/B cards (1 set per pair) · two cards per learner: "1st · REAL" and "2nd · DREAM" (or learners write 1 and 2 on scrap paper) · talking tokens · "imagine a person" cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.2-A (Sam and Rosa daydream) and 2.2-B (real or dream?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the reality line from C4. Now fill the **IMAGINED** end: *If* + **past simple**, **would** (*'d*) + base verb. Under it, a thought bubble  and the words "past verb = NOT REAL (not past time!)".

Center: *If I won the lottery, I'd buy a house by the sea.* · *If I had more time, I would learn the guitar.* · *I wouldn't tell anyone.* · **What would you do** if you **found** a wallet? · *If I were you, I'd...* (I / he / she / it + **were**)

Right: two columns.  **1st · REAL:** *If I have time, I'll call you.* (maybe I will) ·  **2nd · DREAM:** *If I had time, I'd call you.* (but I don't). Below: result can be **could** (= would be able to) / **might** (= would maybe).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: plans with conditions	8	S–S	Review C4. Pairs use the conditional-plans role-play A/B cards: A invites B to a weekend activity, B answers with conditions ("If it's sunny, I'll come.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Unless I have to work, I'll be there."). Swap once. Two learners read a life hack from the Life Hack Wall.
Lead-in: a million dollars	5	T-S → S-S	Slide 9. "Imagine: you open your phone and you won a million dollars. What would you do first?" Pairs brainstorm 3 ideas (1 min), and you write good answers on the board. Ask: "Is this real?" (No, just a dream.) "Did you win in the past?" (No!) Circle <i>won</i> : "Past form, but not past time. Interesting..."
Grammar: second conditional	12	T-S	Slide 10. Meaning (imaginary, unlikely, impossible; now or future), form, the "past = unreal" idea, <i>would</i> → 'd, questions (<i>What would you do if...?</i>), <i>could</i> / <i>might</i> in the result. CCQs and drill (below).
Pronunciation: 'd, wouldn't, were	5	T-S	Minimal pair game: T says "I go by bus." / "I'd go by bus." Learners show 🖐️ (real, now) or 💭 (dream, I'd). Then <i>wouldn't</i> /'wʊdənt/ (two syllables) and weak <i>were</i> /wə/ in "If I were you".
Real or dream? (first vs second)	8	T-S	Slide 11. Read Script 2.2-B : 8 sentences. Learners hold up "1st · REAL" or "2nd · DREAM". Then the key question: "Do I really think it might happen?" Do 3 pairs of sentences on the board (have / had time).
Listening: Sam and Rosa	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.2-A twice (be both voices, or a confident learner reads Rosa). Learners answer true / false and correct the false ones. Pairs compare, then find three "I'd" sentences.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 and 3 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check the first vs second items (Ex 3) only.
If I were you, I'd...	7	T-S → S-S	Slide 12. The advice formula, and why <i>were</i> . Model with a learner: "I'm always tired in the morning." — "If I were you, I'd go to bed earlier." Then pairs use the advice role-play A/B cards: A reads a small problem, B gives advice, A reacts ("Good idea!" / "Hmm, maybe."). Swap. Workbook Ex 4 for homework or early finishers.
Freer: "What would you do if...?" dilemma discussion	18	S-S (groups of 3-4) → T-S	Slide 13. Groups, dilemma cards face down, reaction-phrase strips, 3 talking tokens each. (1) The asker turns a card and reads it. Everyone answers in turn: "If I found a wallet, I'd... because..." (round-robin first). (2) Open discussion: agree / disagree / "That depends" (12 min, about 4 cards). (3) Each group chooses the card with the most different answers and the reporter tells the class: "Three of us would..., but Ana would..." (4 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first: "Which dilemma was the hardest?" Then 4 heard sentences on the board, e.g. "If I would have money, I'd travel." · "If I find a wallet, I would give it back." · "If I was you, I'll call her." · one good one. Learners fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 2.2; Workbook Ex 5 "What would you do if...?" (6 answers) and the journal.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 5 + 8 + 7 + 10 + 7 + 18 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This class has a lot of talk, which is good. Cut the advice role-play to 3 cards each (the workbook Ex 4 covers the rest at home) and do only 4 sentences of Script 2.2-B. **Never cut the dilemma discussion:** it is the real communicative task of the lesson and where *I'd...* becomes automatic.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: imaginary, unlikely or impossible — now or in the future. The speaker steps out of reality.

SAY: "If I won the lottery, I'd quit my job." Did I win the lottery? (No.) Is it likely? (No, very unlikely.) Is won about the past? (No! It's about an imagined now / future.) Am I going to quit my job? (No, it's a dream.)

SAY: "If I had a car, I'd drive you home." Do I have a car? (No.) Can I drive you home? (No.) • "If animals could talk, life would be strange." Can animals talk? (No, impossible.)

Meaning: first vs second = how likely do I think it is?

SAY: "If I have time, I'll call you." / "If I had time, I'd call you." Which one: maybe I'll have time? (The first.) Which one: I don't have time? (The second.) • "If it rains, I'll stay home." Is rain realistic? (Yes.) "If it rained gold, we'd all be rich." Realistic? (No, impossible.)

Meaning: advice.

SAY: "If I were you, I'd take the job." Am I you? (No, impossible.) Is it advice? (Yes.) Is it strong like an order? (No, soft and friendly.) Is it softer than "You should take the job"? (Yes.) • "If I were you, I wouldn't worry." Should you worry? (No.)

Form.

Positive	If + past simple, would ('d) + base verb	If I had more time, I'd learn to paint. • She'd be happier if she lived near the sea.
Negative	didn't + verb • wouldn't + base verb	If they didn't work so much, they wouldn't be so tired.
Question	What would + subject + do + if + past...?	What would you do if you found a wallet? • Would you tell anyone?
be	were for all persons (standard) • <i>was</i> = informal speech	If I were rich... • If it were warmer... • If I were you, I'd...
Other results	could (= would be able to) • might (= would maybe)	If I had a car, I could drive you. • If she asked me, I might say yes.

Don't mix	past + would ✓ · present + will ✓ · past + will ✗	If I had time, I witt call you. ✗
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Pronunciation. In speech *would* is almost always 'd: /d /aid/, *you'd* /jud/, *she'd*, *we'd*, *they'd*. If learners drop the /d/ ("I buy a house"), the sentence sounds real, not imagined, so this matters: exaggerate the /d/ at first. Before a /t/ or /d/ sound it almost disappears ("I'd take it") — accept that. *wouldn't* is /'wʊdənt/: the l is silent, and the middle is a small /ə/. *were* is weak in "If I were you" /ɪf aɪ wəɪ ju/, stressed only in short answers. The question *What would you do if...?* links: "what-wud-ya-DO". The *if*-clause rises ↗, the result falls ↘, as in C4.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Back-chain:** "by the sea" → "a house by the sea" → "I'd buy a house by the sea" → "If I won the lottery, I'd buy a house by the sea." Choral ×3, halves of the room, then 4–5 individuals.
- 2 Make it a dream** (first → second): T: "If I have time, I'll call you." → S: "If I had time, I'd call you." T: "If she knows, she'll tell us." → S: "If she knew, she'd tell us." T: "If it's warm, we'll swim." → S: "If it were warm, we'd swim."
- 3 Question and answer chain:** S1 to S2: "What would you do if you had a free day tomorrow?" S2: "I'd sleep late! What would you do if you could fly?" S2 → S3 ... (open pairs, then closed pairs for 1 minute).
- 4 were drill:** T: "I / rich" → S: "If I were rich..." T: "it / warmer" → S: "If it were warmer..." T: "he / here" → S: "If he were here..." Then finish each with *I'd / we'd / he'd*.
- 5 Advice:** T mimes a problem (yawning, shaking a slow phone, looking at a watch). Learners: "If I were you, I'd go to bed earlier." / "...I'd buy a new phone." / "...I'd leave earlier."

◆ DILEMMA DISCUSSION – HOW TO RUN IT

- Groups of 3–4. Dilemma cards face down, one reaction-phrase strip each, 3 talking tokens each. Roles: **asker** (turns and reads the card), **timekeeper** (about 1 minute per person), **reporter**. Change the asker with every card.
- Round-robin first:** everyone answers the card in turn with a full sentence and a reason: "If I found a wallet, I'd take it to the police station, because the owner might go there." The options A / B / C on the card help; "your own idea" is always allowed.
- Then open discussion** (tokens: one per turn): "I'd do the same." · "Really? I wouldn't. I'd..." · "That depends. If there was a phone number, I'd call." · "Why would you...?"
- All dilemmas are light and everyday on purpose** (a found wallet, too much change, a lottery win, a superpower, an ugly gift, a free vacation). Some touch on honesty; there is no one right answer, and nobody is judged. Remind the class: "These are imaginary. Answer as yourself, as your 'imagine a person' card, or invent an answer. You can say 'Pass' and take the next card."

- ◆ Walk around and note sentences for feedback. Don't correct during the discussion (fluency first). If one learner is doing all the talking, stop by and say, "Let's hear from someone who still has tokens."
- ◆ Fast groups: use the two blank cards to write their own light dilemma for another group.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE ADVICE ROLE-PLAY AND THE DILEMMA DISCUSSION

SAY: Advice cards: Who has the problem, A or B? (A.) What are B's first words? ("If I were you, I'd...") · "If I was you" or "If I were you"? (Were.)

SAY: Dilemmas: Who reads the card? (The asker.) · First, does everyone answer, or only one person? (Everyone, in turn.) · What do you add after your answer? (A reason, with "because".) · What does a token do? (One token, one turn.) · Don't like a card? (Say "Pass" and take the next one.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use the picture dilemma cards (the emoji + a partner reading aloud) and the phrase strip "If I..., I'd... because...". Give a ready answer frame on a card: "If I found a wallet, I'd ____." Target: the chunk /'d... + one verb, for 4 dilemmas, and one "If I were you, I'd..." piece of advice. Don't insist on *were* vs *was* at this stage.

STRETCH

Use *could* and *might* in answers ("I might keep a little for myself — no, I'm joking!"). Answer with a condition inside a condition ("If there was an address, I'd take it back myself, but if not, I'd..."). In the report stage, compare the group ("Most of us would..., but..."). Early finishers write their own light dilemma card for another group.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "If I would have money..." (*would* in both halves): German (*wenn ich ... hätte / würde*), Dutch, Swedish and Norwegian speakers, and many others by analogy. Teach: *would* lives in the result only. Use the same red ✗ gesture as for "if ... will" in C4.
- ◆ "If I have money, I would..." (present in the *if*-clause): Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian speakers (no past form to signal "unreal"), and Japanese / Korean speakers whose conditional is one suffix. Point at the board: "Dream → past."
- ◆ "If I had money, I bought a car" (past in both halves): Russian and Ukrainian (*если бы..., я бы купил*), Polish. Their L1 uses the past in both halves; the English result needs *would*.
- ◆ **Dropped 'd:** "If I won, I buy a house." Spanish, Portuguese, Vietnamese and Chinese speakers often drop final /d/. Use the 🖐️ / 🗣️ listening game and exaggerate the /d/.
- ◆ "If I am you" / "If I was you": Spanish (*si yo fuera tú*) and Portuguese speakers usually get *were* easily (subjunctive); Arabic, Chinese and Tagalog speakers may say "If I am you." Teach "If I were you, I'd..." as

one fixed chunk.

- ◆ **Strong "should" advice:** learners from cultures with direct advice (German, Dutch, Russian, Hebrew) may sound bossy with "You must...". Learners from indirect cultures (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Filipino) may find any advice uncomfortable. "If I were you..." is the polite English middle.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_05.html. Listen to the model sentences and the daydreaming conversation with 🎧 and read it aloud; do the exercises and the Quick Quiz.

Workbook 2.2: finish Ex 4 (advice) if not done, Ex 5 ("What would you do if...?": 6 answers with one *If I were...* and one *could / might*), "My new words" and the journal. Note: the online project list includes "could live anywhere"; learners may choose any other prompt.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** If I had money, I would travel. · Q2 **A** If it rains, I'll stay home. · Q3 (new) **B** If I were you, I'd buy a new one.
Sam and Rosa (Ex 1): 1 **F** (Rosa would travel for a year; Sam would buy a little house by the sea) · 2 **T** · 3 **T** · 4 **F**
("If I were you, I'd take it.") · 5 **T** · 6 **T**.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use *wish* / *if only* + past simple for a present wish: *I wish I had more free time. If only it were Friday!*
- ◆ understand the "flip": a wish is the opposite of reality (*I wish I lived near work* = I don't live near work)
- ◆ use *were* for all persons after *wish* (*I wish it were sunny*), and *wish* + *could* for ability (*I wish I could sing*)
- ◆ use *wish* + *would* to complain kindly about someone or something else (*I wish the bus would come on time*), never about themselves
- ◆ choose *hope* (possible) or *wish* (not real now)
- ◆ say 6+ small, everyday wishes (weather, skills, commute) and suggest a real fix with a conditional

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My six small wishes")
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Flashcards (small wishes: weather, skills, commute) · **Wish Mingle** sheet (1 per learner) · **Small Wishes, Real Fixes** cards (1 set per pair) · "imagine a person" cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.3-A (Maya and Leo on a gray day) and 2.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the reality line, complete. Add under IMAGINED: **I wish / If only + past**. Two columns: **REAL NOW** | **MY WISH:** It's raining. | I wish it **were** sunny. · I can't sing. | I wish I **could** sing. · I live far from work. | I wish I **lived** closer. · I have a lot of work. | I wish I **didn't have** so much work.

Center: 🙄 **wish + would** = other people / things, annoying: I wish the bus **would** come on time. · I wish my neighbor **would** turn the music down. A big **✗**: "I wish I **would** be taller." → I wish I **were** taller.

Right: 🙌 **hope** = possible: I hope it's sunny tomorrow. · 🌟 **wish** = not real now: I wish it were sunny (but it isn't). · **If only...!** = a stronger wish (!).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: quick dilemmas	7	T-S → S-S	Review C5. Quick-fire questions: "What would you do if you had a free day tomorrow? ... if you could speak every language? ... if you found \$20 on the bus?" Then pairs give each other one piece of advice: A says a small problem from homework Ex 4, B: "If I were you, I'd...".

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Lead-in: a gray day	5	T-S	Slide 14. Show the umbrella and sunny flashcards. Look out the window (or at the umbrella card): "It's raining. I want sun. I wish it were sunny!" Elicit more: "I'm tired. I wish..." (I had more time to sleep / it were Friday). Write two learner wishes on the board.
Grammar: wish + past / were	12	T-S	Slide 15. The link to C5: same "unreal past." The flip (REAL NOW MY WISH on the board). <i>were</i> for I / he / she / it; <i>was</i> is informal. <i>If only...!</i> = stronger. CCQs and drill (below).
wish + could · hope vs wish	7	T-S	<i>I can't sing</i> → <i>I wish I could sing</i> . Use the skill flashcards (sing, swim, dance, play the guitar, cook). Then <i>hope</i> vs <i>wish</i> : "The forecast says sun tomorrow: I hope it's sunny tomorrow. Today it's raining: I wish it were sunny."
wish + would	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. Mime an annoyance (a phone ringing again and again, a bus that never comes): "I wish the bus would come!" Other people / things only. CCQs. Pairs turn 4 complaints into wishes: "The printer never works." → "I wish the printer would work!"
Listening: Maya and Leo	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 2.3-A twice. Learners tick who wishes what and write the pattern (past / were / could / would). Quick check.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 5 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 3 (which pattern?) and Ex 5 (hope or wish?). Ex 4 for homework.
Wish Mingle (Find Someone Who)	12	S-S (mingle) → T-S	Slide 17. Drill the question first: " Do you wish you could sing?" — "Yes, I do! / No, I don't." Learners walk and ask; one name per box, then the extra question with <i>would</i> : "What song would you sing?" (8 min). Report with he / she: "Omar wishes he could cook rice like his grandmother." (4 min). ICQs first.
Freer: Small Wishes, Real Fixes	13	S-S	Slide 17. Pairs, one set of cards. (1) A takes a card, reads the situation and makes a wish ("I wish the bus would come on time!"). B answers with a dream ("If it came on time, what would you do with the extra time?") or a fix ("If I were you, I'd take the earlier

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			bus." / "If you leave ten minutes earlier, you'll get a seat."). Swap every card (7 min). (2) Each learner writes 3 small wishes of their own on the weather, a skill and the commute (or from a card), and shares them with a new partner, who suggests a fix (6 min). ICQs first.
Feedback + module check	5	T-S	Content: "Which fix will you try?" Delayed correction: "I wish I can swim." · "I wish I would be more organized." · "I wish it will stop raining." · "I wish you come to my party." (→ I hope you can come). Then learners tick the Module 2 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 2.3; "My six small wishes" and the journal; preview C7: "Next class: reported speech. She <i>said</i> she <i>was</i> tired. The past again!"
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 7 + 8 + 6 + 10 + 12 + 13 + 5 + 5

KEEP WISHES SMALL — SAY IT OUT LOUD

Before the mingle and before the Small Wishes task, say: "Today we make **small, everyday wishes**: the weather, a skill, the bus, your phone, a noisy neighbor. You don't need to share anything private. Choose a card, invent a wish, or say 'Pass!'" **Never** give or invite examples about family far away, home countries, migration, health or money problems, and don't ask "What do you wish about your life?" The online lesson's "Mindset" box and its "I wish I hadn't eaten so much last night" sentence (a past wish) are not used in class. If a learner offers a deep regret anyway, say "Thank you for sharing that," and gently move to the next card.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: wish + past = I want the present to be different. The past form is the same "unreal" signal as in the second conditional.

SAY: "I wish I lived closer to work." Do I live close to work? (No.) Do I want to? (Yes.) Is it about the past? (No, now.) · "I wish I didn't have so much homework." Do I have a lot of homework? (Yes!)

SAY: "I wish it were sunny." Is it sunny now? (No.) "If only it were Friday!" Is it Friday? (No.) Which is stronger, I wish or If only? (If only.)

Meaning: wish + could = ability.

SAY: "I wish I could swim." Can I swim? (No.) Would I like to? (Yes.) · "I wish I can swim" — OK? (No. can → could.)

Meaning: wish + would = someone / something else, and I'm annoyed.

SAY: "I wish the bus would come on time." Does the bus come on time? (No.) Am I happy about it? (No, annoyed.) Is it about me or about the bus? (The bus.) · "I wish I would be taller" — OK? (No. About me → "I wish I were taller.")

Meaning: hope vs wish.

SAY: "I hope it's sunny tomorrow." Is it possible? (Yes, maybe.) "I wish it were sunny." Is it sunny now? (No.) Your friend has a job interview tomorrow. Hope or wish? ("I hope you get it!")

Form.

Present wish	wish / If only + past simple	I wish I had more time. · She wishes she spoke Italian. · If only I knew the answer!
Negative	wish + didn't + verb · wish + weren't	I wish I didn't have so much work. · I wish my phone weren't so slow.
be	wish + were (all persons) · <i>was</i> = informal	I wish I were taller. · I wish it were the weekend.
Ability	wish + could + base verb	I wish I could sing. · He wishes he could drive.
Annoyance	wish + [someone / something else] + would / wouldn't + verb	I wish it would stop raining. · I wish he wouldn't interrupt me.
hope	hope + present / will (real, possible)	I hope it's sunny tomorrow. · I hope you can come.

Pronunciation. *wish* /wɪʃ/: a short /ɪ/ and a soft /ʃ/ ("sh"), not /wɪʃ/ or /wis/. Stress falls on the **wished-for word**, not on *wish*: "I wish it were **SUN**ny." · "I wish I could **SING**." *were* is weak /wər/. *If only* has strong stress and emotion: "If **ONLY** it were **FRI**day!" (a sigh helps). *could* /kʊd/: silent l. *wish + would* often has a slightly annoyed, falling tone: "I wish the bus would **COME**." ↘

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- The flip** (point at REAL NOW on the board): T: "It's raining." → S: "I wish it were sunny." T: "I can't swim." → S: "I wish I could swim." T: "I don't have a car." → S: "I wish I had a car." T: "I have a lot of work." → S: "I wish I didn't have so much work."
- Stress drill:** "I wish it were **SUN**ny." / "I wish I could **SING**." / "I wish I lived **CLOS**er." Choral, then individuals. Then **If only** with feeling: "If **ONLY** it were **FRI**day!"

- 3 **Annoyance chain:** T: "The bus is late again." → S1: "I wish the bus would come on time!" S1: "My neighbor's music is loud." → S2: "I wish my neighbor would turn it down!" ... around the room.
- 4 **hope or wish?** T: "Tomorrow's forecast: sunny." → S: "I hope it's sunny tomorrow." T: "Today: rain." → S: "I wish it were sunny today." T: "Your friend has a test tomorrow." → S: "I hope you pass!"
- 5 **Wish → fix** (preview of the freer task): S1: "I wish I could cook rice better." S2: "If I were you, I'd watch a video." / "If you use less water, it'll be perfect."

◆ SMALL WISHES, REAL FIXES – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Pairs, one set of 16 cards face down: ☀️ weather, 🛠️ skills, 🚗 commute, 🏠 home & phone. Each card has a small situation and a pattern hint (past / were / could / would).
- ◆ A takes a card, reads the situation and makes a wish with feeling: "It's so cold. I wish it were warmer!" B answers in one of two ways: 💬 **Dream:** a second-conditional question: "If it were warmer, what would you do?" or 🛠️ **Fix:** "If I were you, I'd..." / a first conditional: "If you wear gloves, your hands won't hurt." A answers or reacts ("Good idea!" / "I might try that."). Swap after every card.
- ◆ Round 2: each learner writes **3 small wishes of their own** (weather, a skill, the commute) in the workbook table, or copies wishes from a card or an "imagine a person" card. Share with a new partner, who suggests a fix.
- ◆ Keep it light, practical and a little funny. There are no deep regrets in this task — see the amber box above.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MINGLE AND SMALL WISHES

SAY: *Mingle: What is the question? ("Do you wish you could...?" / "Do you wish it were...?") · "Yes, I do" → what do you do? (Write the name and ask the extra question.) · How many names per box? (One.)*

SAY: *Small Wishes: A makes a wish. What does B do? (Asks a dream question or gives a fix.) · Can B say "If I were you, I'd..."? (Yes.) · Big wishes or small wishes? (Small, everyday.) · Do you have to share your real wishes? (No. Card, invented, or "Pass.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use two patterns only: *I wish I could...* (with the skill flashcards: sing, swim, dance, cook, play the guitar) and *I wish it were...* (with the weather flashcards: sunny, hot, cold). The partner reads the Small Wishes cards aloud. In the mingle, give a sheet with the questions fully written, and learners mark ✓ and the first letter of the name. Target: 4 spoken wishes and 1 "If I were you, I'd...".

STRETCH

Add a second-conditional result to each wish: "I wish I lived closer to work. If I did, I'd walk every day." Use *I wish there were...* for the neighborhood ("I wish there were more buses at night."). In the fix, give two options with *unless* or *might*. Early finishers write a short, friendly complaint message to a roommate with one *I wish you would...* and one *If you..., I'll...*

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **hope / wish mix-up:** Arabic *atamanna* (أتمنى), Tagalog *sana*, Chinese *xīwàng* (期望), Vietnamese *ước / hy vọng* overlap, and French *souhaiter* can mean both. Expect "I wish you come to my party" and "I wish I will pass the test." Use the hope / wish drill: possible → hope.
- ◆ **"I wish I have / I wish I can"** (present after *wish*): Chinese, Vietnamese, Korean, Japanese and Arabic speakers. Point at the flip on the board: "Wish → one step back."
- ◆ **"I wish that you would come" for a polite invitation:** Spanish speakers (*ojalá vengas* = I hope you come). Teach: invitation → "I hope you can come!"
- ◆ **"I wish I would..."** about oneself: German and Dutch speakers (*ich wünschte, ich würde*) and many others by analogy. *would* is for other people and things.
- ◆ **/ɪ/ vs /i/ and /j/:** Spanish, Portuguese, Arabic and Tagalog speakers may say "weesh" or "wis" (Spanish has no /j/ in many accents; Tagalog has /j/ only in loans). Model "wish, fish, dish."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_06.html. Listen to the model sentences and the Maya and Leo conversation with 🗣️ and read it aloud; do the exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 2.3: finish Ex 4 (complaint → wish), "My six small wishes" (weather, skills, commute: real, from a card, or invented), "My new words" and the journal (3 small wishes + one small action for each).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B I wish I were on vacation. · Q2 A I wish my neighbor would turn the music down. · Q3 (new) B I hope it's sunny tomorrow. Maya and Leo (Ex 1): 1 Maya · were · 2 Leo · would · 3 Maya · past (lived) · 4 Leo · could · 5 Maya · were · 6 Leo · would.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C6: MODULE 2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, the finished reality line: **If you heat ice, it melts.** (always true) → **If it rains, I'll take the bus.** (real, likely) → **If I won the lottery, I'd...** (imagined) → **I wish it were sunny.** (not real now, but I want it). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C7 warmer and in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 3: reported speech also "steps back" a tense ("*I'm tired*" → *She said she **was** tired*).

Learners who just learned "past = unreal" may be confused: in reported speech the past is about **time** (the words were said before). Say it clearly in C7. Keep a 2-minute conditional warmer in C7–C9 ("If it rains this weekend, I'll... / If I could fly, I'd... / I wish...").

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: zero vs first conditional, no *will* after *if* / *when*, *when* vs *if*, *unless*, the comma, the second conditional (+ / – / ?), first vs second choice, *were*, *If I were you*, *I'd...*, *wish* + past / *were* / *could* / *would*, and *hope* vs *wish*.

Module 3 — Reporting & Connecting Ideas

Three classes that let learners pass on other people's words and join their own ideas into longer sentences. First comes **reported statements**: the tense backshift, pronoun and time-word changes, and **say vs tell**. Then **reported questions** (statement word order, *if / whether*) and **reported requests and commands** (*told / asked me (not) to...*). Last, **relative clauses**: *who, which, that, where, when, whose*, defining vs non-defining clauses, and the commas that change the meaning.

3 lessons

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

Weeks 4–5

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-3-reporting.html`. Print `materials/module-3/classroom-materials.html` before C7. It holds the flashcards, the Gossip Chain news cards, the Survey Report cards, the Message Relay cards and "While you were out" notes, the "Who am I? / What is it?" definition cards and bingo, the sentence-combining strips, the new identity cards and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- **Extension, not a first meeting.** A2 Lesson 6.2 taught defining relative clauses with *who, which, that, where*. Many learners also met *said* and *told* as everyday past verbs. Check what they know in each lead-in and go faster where they are strong. The new B1 work is the **backshift system**, reported questions and commands, and in 3.3 **non-defining clauses, commas, *whose / when* and dropping the object pronoun**.
- **Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix a backshift. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. Praise the *message* first ("Great story! Everyone understood."), then the form. At B1 a report that is clear but has one un-shifted verb is a success.
- **Dominant speakers.** Reporting tasks are natural "turn" tasks, so use them: give every group a **talking-turn token** (a pen or a coin; you speak only when you hold it), give the strongest speaker a **job** (the checker, the timekeeper, the "last person in the chain"), and use **"report your partner, not yourself"** so quieter learners get the floor. Say it kindly: "Thanks, Omar. Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet."

- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons sometimes use British forms (*film, flat, mum, holiday, neighbour, maths, moved house, memorise, practise, Mr* with no period). Teach *movie, apartment, mom, vacation, neighbor, math, moved, memorize, practice, Mr*. Accept the British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

What they said → what they asked and wanted → who and what we mean. In C7 learners pass on news: *She said she was starting a new job.* In C8 they report the questions people asked them and the things people asked or told them to do: *She asked me whether I liked cooking. The doctor told me not to eat before the test.* In C9 they stop reporting and start *connecting*: they describe people, places and things exactly (*the woman who called you*) and add extra facts inside commas (*My brother, who lives in Chicago, is a nurse.*). Every class ends with the same kind of freer task: tell other people something real (or imagined) in longer, joined-up English.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: WHOSE WORDS, WHOSE QUESTIONS?

Reported speech can bring back hard conversations: an immigration or asylum interview, a police officer, a court, a difficult doctor's visit, a landlord who wants rent. The online lesson 3.2 project suggests "a police interview" as one option. **In class, keep every task everyday:** friends, neighbors, work, a routine clinic visit, the building manager fixing a sink. **Never ask** "What did the officer ask you?", "What did the interviewer ask you at immigration?" or "What did your family say when you left?" The **gossip** in C7 is always about **invented people** on the news cards, never about classmates. For every personal task (reporting real things people said, the survey, "the people and places in my life"), offer three choices out loud: **your real life, a new identity card** (in the classroom materials), or **something imagined**. Anyone can say "Pass!" to a survey question. Say it every time, so choosing a card is normal.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the backshift cards, the reporting verbs, the relative-pronoun cards and the picture cards. Card stock helps. Cut them before C7.
- ◆ For C7: one set of **Gossip Chain news cards** (12 cards) and a small piece of paper for each line of learners.
- ◆ For C8: one **Survey card** per learner (6 different topics, so neighbors have different questions) and one **report frame** per learner. Tape the 8 **Message Relay** cards on the walls around the room *before* class. Print 2 "**While you were out**" note sheets per pair.
- ◆ For C9: one set of "**Who am I? / What is it?**" definition cards per group of 3–4, one **bingo grid** per learner, and one set of **sentence-combining strips + comma cards** per pair. An envelope per pair keeps the strips together.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.

- Optional: a real phone to "play" the voicemail in C7 and C8 (read the script while holding the phone to your ear). Learners enjoy it and it makes the situation clear.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
3.1	C7 • wk 4	Direct vs reported speech; the tense backshift (present → past, present perfect / past → past perfect, will → would, can → could, may → might, must → had to); pronoun changes; time and place words (<i>tomorrow</i> → <i>the next day</i>); say vs tell + person	pass on six or more things that other people said, with the backshift, the right pronouns and <i>said / told me</i>
3.2	C8 • wk 4	Reported wh- questions and yes/no questions (<i>if / whether</i>) with statement word order, no <i>do/did</i> , no "?"; commands and requests : <i>tell / ask</i> + <i>person</i> + (<i>not</i>) <i>to</i> + <i>verb</i> ; <i>remind, warn, advise, order</i>	interview classmates and report the questions and answers; pass on a spoken message from a boss, doctor or building manager as a clear to-do list
3.3	C9 • wk 5	Relative pronouns <i>who, which, that, where, when, whose</i> ; defining (no commas) vs non-defining clauses (commas, no <i>that</i>); dropping the object pronoun (<i>the movie I saw</i>)	define people, places and things with relative clauses, join two short sentences into one, and describe six people, places and things in their life

3.1 · C7

Reported Speech — Statements

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ change direct speech into a reported statement: *"I'm tired."* → *She said (that) she was tired.*
- ◆ apply the **backshift** after *said / told*: present → past, present perfect and past simple → past perfect, *will* → *would*, *can* → *could*, *may* → *might*, *must* → *had to*; and know that *would*, *could*, *might*, *should* and the past perfect don't change
- ◆ change pronouns and possessives to their own point of view (*I* → *he / she*, *my* → *his / her*, *you* → *I*)
- ◆ change time and place words when the time or place has really changed (*tomorrow* → *the next day*, *here* → *there*)
- ◆ choose **said** (no person) or **told + person** and pass on six or more things people said

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "Things people said to me")
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Backshift flashcards (*am* → *was*, *will* → *would*...) · **say / tell** cards · **Gossip Chain news cards** (1 set) + paper slips · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.1-A (Lina's voicemail) and 3.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two speech bubbles. Bubble: *"I'm tired."* → arrow → *She said (that) she **was** tired.* Under it: the "rewind" line: *is / am* → **was** · *work* → **worked** · *have finished* → **had finished** · *saw* → **had seen** · *will* → **would** · *can* → **could** · *may* → **might** · *must* → **had to**.

Center: pronouns: *I* → *he / she* · *we* → *they* · *my* → *his / her* · *you (me)* → *I*. Time and place: *now* → *then* · *today* → *that day* · *tomorrow* → *the next day* · *yesterday* → *the day before* · *here* → *there* · *this* → *that* · *ago* → *before*.

Right: the key card: **SAY** + (that)... · **TELL** + person + (that)... · *She told **me**...* ✓ · *She said **me**...* ✗ · *She told **to** me...* ✗

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: I wish...	8	S-S	Review C6 (2.3, wish and if only). Pairs finish three sentence heads on the board: "I wish I could... · I wish my neighbor would... · If only I had..." (real or imagined; light topics). Then each learner tells the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			class what their partner wished: "Ana wishes she could drive." This is a secret preview of reporting. Note one or two good lines for later.
Lead-in: my neighbor's news	6	T-S	Tell a short invented story: "Yesterday I met my neighbor, Mrs. Lee. She said, 'I'm moving to Florida! I've sold my car.'" Write her words in a bubble. Ask: "What did Mrs. Lee say?" Elicit anything; then write the report next to the bubble: "She said she was moving to Florida. She said she had sold her car." "What's different?" Let learners notice: no quotation marks, / → <i>she</i> , the verbs "go back."
Grammar: the backshift	15	T-S	Slides 3–4. Meaning (passing on someone's words later), form (the rewind line), the "don't change" group (<i>would, could, might, should</i> , past perfect), and when backshift is optional (said today and still true). CCQs (below). Stick the backshift cards on the board as you go.
Drill	7	T-S → S	Rewind drill with the cards (see Drill script), then the chain: T says a direct line, learners report it in one breath.
Pronouns, time words, say / tell	10	T-S	Slides 5–6. Pronouns: "From where I'm standing now, who is this person?" Time words: a Monday-to-Wednesday calendar on the board ("On Monday Tom said, 'I'll call you tomorrow.' Today is Wednesday."). Then say vs tell with the key card and the three ✕ examples. CCQs.
Listening: Lina's voicemail	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Hold a phone to your ear and read Script 3.1-A twice (as Lina). Learners complete the reported sentences. Pairs compare, then read the report aloud as if telling a friend: "Guess what! Lina said she was starting a new job!"
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (backshift, say / tell, time words, find the mistake), then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start "Things people said to me."

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer: Gossip Chain	16	S-S (lines) → T-S	Slide 8. Lines of 5–6. Round 1 (6 min): the first learner reads a news card in silence, gives it back, and whispers a report to the next learner: "Mrs. Lee said she was moving to Florida..." Each learner passes on what they heard with <i>said / told me</i> . The last learner writes it on paper. Compare with the card: one point for every correct backshifted verb in the final version. Round 2 (6 min): new card, new first person; the last person reports it to the whole class . Then (4 min) pairs tell each other 3 things someone really said to them this week (or from a new identity card). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed error correction: write 4 sentences you heard (2 good, 2 with errors, no names): "She said me she was tired." · "He said he will call." · "She told that she had a new job." · "Maria said I was busy." (about herself). Learners fix them together. Praise one great "chain" and one clear report.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 15 + 7 + 10 + 8 + 10 + 16 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: reported speech. We pass on someone's words *later*, in our own sentence, not their exact words. Direct speech = the exact words in "quotation marks."

SAY: "Mrs. Lee said she was moving to Florida." Who is moving: me or Mrs. Lee? (Mrs. Lee.) Did she say "was"? (No, she said "I'm moving.") Is she moving now, in the past? (No, she's moving soon. "Was" is only because I'm reporting it later.) Are these her exact words? (No, my words.)

Meaning: the backshift. After a past reporting verb (*said, told*), we usually move the verb one step back, like pressing "rewind" once.

SAY: "He said he would help." What were his exact words? ("I will help.") · "She said she had seen the accident." Her exact words? ("I saw the accident." or "I've seen the accident.") · "He said he had to go." Exact words? ("I must go." or "I have to go.")

SAY: When is backshift optional? "She said she lives in Rome." Does she still live in Rome now? (Yes, so no change is OK.) · "He says he's tired." Is says past? (No, present: no backshift.) · Not sure? (Backshift. It's always safe after said.)

Meaning: time and place. Change them *only if* the time or place has really changed.

SAY: On Monday Tom said, "I'll call you tomorrow." Today is Wednesday. Is "tomorrow" still tomorrow? (No! It was Tuesday.) So: Tom said he would call me... (the next day). · Your friend said it this morning. Today → that day? (No, it's still today.)

Meaning: say vs tell.

SAY: "She told me she was busy." Who did she speak to? (Me.) · "She said she was busy." Do we know who she spoke to? (No, not in the sentence.) · Can I say "She said me..."? (No! "She told me...") · "She told to me"? (No to.)

Form.

Statement	subject + said + (that) + backshifted clause	He said (that) he was hungry.
With a person	subject + told + person + (that) + clause	She told me (that) she had lost her phone.
Present → past	am / is → was · are → were · work → worked · am working → was working	"We're watching TV." → They said they were watching TV.
→ past perfect	have / has + p.p. → had + p.p. · past simple → had + p.p.	"I saw it." → He said he had seen it.
Modals	will → would · can → could · may → might · must → had to · <i>would / could / might / should</i> stay	"You can borrow my car." → He told me I could borrow his car.
Also	is going to → was going to	"I'm going to buy a car." → She said she was going to buy a car.

Pronunciation. *that* is weak /ðət/ or dropped completely in speech: "She said she was tired" is the normal spoken form. *told* /toʊld/: say the final **d**; learners who drop it say "tol' me," which is fine in fast speech but *write* the **d**. The past perfect is usually contracted: "He said **he'd** finished" /hid/, and *would* too: "She said **she'd** call." Teach learners to hear "he'd" as either *he had* or *he would* (the next verb tells you: *he'd finished* = had · *he'd call* = would). Storytelling intonation: a high, excited start: "**Guess** what! She **told** me she was getting **married!**"

- 1 **Rewind drill** (point at a backshift card): T: "am" → S: "was." T: "will" → S: "would." T: "can" → S: "could." T: "have seen" → S: "had seen." T: "must" → S: "had to." T: "might" → S: "might! No change." Choral, then fast individuals.
- 2 **Report it:** T (as a character, with a gesture): "I'm hungry!" → S: "He said he was hungry." T: "I've lost my keys!" → S: "She said she'd lost her keys." T: "I'll pay you back." → S: "She said she would pay me back."
- 3 **Say or tell?** T gives a report without the verb and a person or no person: T: "... me she was busy" → S: "She **told** me she was busy." T: "... she was busy" → S: "She **said** she was busy."
- 4 **Time travel** (point at the Monday / Wednesday calendar): T: "tomorrow" → S: "the next day." T: "yesterday" → S: "the day before." T: "here" → S: "there." T: "two weeks ago" → S: "two weeks before."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 says a true or invented line ("I'm going to the dentist tomorrow."); S2 turns to S3: "Ana said she was going to the dentist the next day." Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ GOSSIP CHAIN – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Lines of 5–6 learners, standing or sitting in a row. The **first** learner reads a **news card** (about an invented person in the "Maple Street" apartment building) for 30 seconds, then gives the card back to you.
- ◆ The first learner whispers a **report**, not the exact words: "Mrs. Lee said she was moving to Florida the next month. She said she had sold her car..." Each learner passes on what they heard, starting "[Name] **said...**" or "[Name] **told me...**" (not "you said"). One whisper only; no "Can you say it again?"
- ◆ The **last** learner writes the report on a paper slip. Hold up the card and read the original. Score: 1 point for each correct backshifted verb in the written report, and 1 bonus point if the news is still basically true. The funniest changes get a laugh, not a penalty.
- ◆ Rotate: the first person moves to the end, so a new learner reads the next card. Give **the strongest speaker** the job of the last person (writer and checker) in round 1: it keeps them busy and gives the quieter learners the speaking turns.
- ◆ The gossip is **about the people on the cards only**, never about classmates or real neighbors. Say it before you start: "These people are not real. Please be kind."
- ◆ Last 4 minutes: pairs report 3 real things someone said to them this week ("My daughter told me she wanted a cat."), or 3 lines from a new identity card.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GOSSIP CHAIN

SAY: Do you say the exact words from the card? (No, you report: "She said she was...") · What are the first words? ("Mrs. Lee said..." / "Mrs. Lee told me...") · How many times can you whisper? (Once.) · Who writes? (The last person.) · Can we gossip about people in our class? (No! Only the card people.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on three changes only: *am / is* → *was*, *will* → *would*, *can* → *could*, plus *I* → *he / she*. Give a phrase strip: "He said he was... / She said she would... / She told me she could...". In the Gossip Chain, stand next to the learner and read the news card aloud once, quietly; give them the middle of the line (listen and repeat, not first or last). Target: 3 spoken reports with *was / would / could*.

STRETCH

Use a variety of reporting verbs beyond said / told: *explained, mentioned, promised, admitted* ("He admitted he had forgotten."). Notice when backshift is optional ("She said she lives in Rome," still true). In the chain, add a reaction: "...and I said I couldn't believe it!" Early finishers rewrite the Sam and Alex dialogue as a report from Sam's point of view.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"She said me..." / "She told to me..."**: Spanish *me dijo*, Portuguese *me disse*, French *elle m'a dit*, Italian *mi ha detto*, Arabic *qāl-li* all put the person right after "say." Point at the key card every time: **"tell** needs a person; **say** doesn't."
- ◆ **No backshift**: "He said he is tired." Russian, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Tagalog and Thai keep the original tense in reported speech (Russian *он сказал, что устал* literally "he said that he is tired"). It is understood. Recast and use the rewind gesture (a hand turning backward).
- ◆ **He / she mix-ups** in the pronoun change: Tagalog (*siya*), Chinese (spoken *tā*), Turkish (*o*), Persian, Finnish and Hungarian use one word for "he" and "she." "My sister said he was tired" is very common. Point at the person on the news card.
- ◆ **Missing *was / were***: "She said she tired." Arabic, Russian, Chinese, Vietnamese and Haitian Creole speakers may drop *be*, which also removes the backshift. Color the **be** verb on the board.
- ◆ **Over-changing time words**: learners who memorized the list change "today" even when it is still today. Keep asking: "Is it still tomorrow?"

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_07.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 3.1: finish "Things people said to me" (the 3 rows from class + 3 more on the back of the page, 6 in all: at least 2 with *said*, 2 with *told* + *person*, 1 *would*, 1 *could*), "My new words" and the journal (one real line as direct speech, then reported, with the changes listed).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** He said he had finished his homework. · Q2 **C** She told me that she was late. · Q3 (new) **B** Tom said he would call me the next day. Lina's voicemail (Ex 1): 1 was starting · 2 had found · 3 were · 4 could · 5 would finish · 6 had seen · 7 had to.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- report **wh- questions** with *asked (me) / wanted to know* + the wh- word + **statement word order**: *She asked where I lived.*
- report **yes/no questions** with *if* or *whether*: *He asked if I was ready.*
- remove *do / does / did* and the question mark, and apply the backshift from 3.1
- report **commands and requests** with *told / asked + person + (not) to + base verb*: *The doctor told me not to eat before the test.*
- choose *tell* (an order) or *ask* (a polite request), and use *remind, warn, advise* with the same pattern

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 3.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Survey Report frame)
- Slides 9–13 · Reporting-verb cards (*ask, want to know, tell, remind, warn, advise*) · **Survey cards** (1 per learner) · **Message Relay cards** (8, taped on the walls) · **"While you were out"** notes (2 per pair) · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 3.2-A (at the clinic front desk) and 3.2-B (a voicemail from the building manager)

BOARD PLAN

Left: "Where **do you live?**" → She asked where **I lived**. Cross out ~~do~~ and ? in red. Under it: **1** keep the wh- word · **2** subject + verb · **3** backshift · **4** no ?

Center: "Are you ready?" → He asked **if / whether** I was ready. · "Do you speak French?" → She asked **if** I spoke French.

Right: "Sit down!" → She **told** me **to** sit down. · "Please help me." → He **asked** me **to** help him. · "Don't worry." → She told me **not to** worry. Under it: remind / warn / advise + person + (not) to...

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: what did they say?	8	S-S → T-S	Review C7. Pairs report 2 things from their homework ("My brother told me he had a new job."). Then a fast "rewind" round with the backshift cards (T: "can" → S: "could"). Two volunteers retell the funniest Gossip Chain news from C7.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Lead-in: so many questions!	6	T-S	"Last week I went to a new clinic. The receptionist asked me so many questions!" Write two of them in bubbles: <i>"Do you have an appointment?" "What time is your appointment?"</i> Ask: "What did she ask me?" Let learners try; write the correct reports next to the bubbles. "What's missing?" (<i>do</i> , the question mark.)
Grammar: reported questions	14	T-S	Slides 9–10. Wh- questions: the two-step recipe (reshape, then backshift). Yes/no questions: <i>if / whether</i> . Cross out <i>do / did</i> and "?" on the board with a red pen every time. CCQs and drill (below). Then Script 3.2-A (clinic): learners complete Workbook Ex 3.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Question-to-report drill (see Drill script). Keep a fast pace; the goal is to <i>feel</i> statement word order after the wh-word.
Controlled practice 1	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (report the questions) and Ex 2 (fix the mistake) alone, then pairs check. Board-check Ex 2: learners come up and cross out the extra <i>did</i> or "?".
Freer 1: Survey Report	16	S-S (mingle) → S-S (groups)	Slide 12. (1) Each learner gets a survey card (5 questions on a light topic) (1 min). (2) Mingle: ask 3 people your questions, write short answers (7 min). (3) Sit in groups of 3–4 with new people. Each learner reports both sides: "I asked Omar what he usually ate for breakfast. He said he ate eggs." · "Lina asked me whether I liked spicy food. I told her I loved it." (6 min). (4) Two learners report one surprising answer to the class (2 min). ICQs first.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Grammar: requests & commands	10	T-S	Slide 11. "Sit down!" (point at a chair, firm voice) → "I told you to sit down." · "Could you open the window, please?" (polite) → "I asked Ana to open the window." Negative: <i>not to</i> . Then <i>remind / warn / advise</i> . CCQs. Then Script 3.2-B (voicemail from the building manager) as a live demo of a message: learners tell you what to do ("He asked us to be at home between nine and twelve.").
Freer 2: Message Relay	12	S-S (pairs)	Slide 13. The 8 message cards are on the walls. In pairs, A = runner , B = writer . A walks to a card, reads one line, walks back and reports it: "Your boss called. She asked you to come in at eight tomorrow." B writes it on the " While you were out " note as a to-do. After 2 cards, swap roles. Finally pairs check their notes against the cards. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board: 4 heard sentences, e.g. "She asked me where did I live." · "He asked was I ready." · "The doctor told me don't eat." · "She said me to wait." Learners fix them. Praise one clear report from each part of the room.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 3.2; workbook "My interview report" and the journal.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 14 + 6 + 8 + 16 + 10 + 12 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This is the busiest class of the module (three shapes in one lesson). Do only 2 Message Relay cards per learner, and move Workbook Ex 4–5 to homework. Never cut the Survey Report: it is where the word-order rule becomes real. If you have a very strong class, you can shorten the drill instead.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: a reported question is not a question any more. It is part of a statement, so it has statement word order and a period.

SAY: "She asked where I lived." Is this a question? (No, a sentence about a question.) Do we need a question mark? (No.) Do we need did? (No.) What were her exact words? ("Where do you live?")

SAY: "He asked if I was ready." What was the question? ("Are you ready?") Was there a *wh-* word? (No, it was a yes/no question.) So what joins the report? (if or whether.) Is *if* here about a condition? (No, it means "whether.")

Meaning: commands and requests.

SAY: "The doctor told me to rest." Did the doctor ask a question? (No, an instruction.) Who has to rest? (Me.) · "She asked me to close the door." Was it an order or a polite request? (A polite request.) · "He told me not to worry." Should I worry? (No.)

SAY: "She reminded me to call the bank." Did I forget? (Maybe, she helped me remember.) · "He warned us not to go there." Is it dangerous? (Yes, maybe.) · "She advised me to rest." Is it an order? (No, a recommendation.)

Form.

Wh-question	asked (+ person) / wanted to know + wh- word + subject + verb (backshifted)	"Where do you work?" → She asked where I worked. · "What time does it start?" → He asked what time it started.
Yes/No question	asked (+ person) + if / whether + subject + verb	"Can you drive?" → He asked if I could drive. · "Did you call?" → She asked whether I had called.
Command	told + person + to + base verb	"Open your books." → The teacher told us to open our books.
Request	asked + person + to + base verb	"Please wait for me." → My friend asked me to wait for her.
Negative	told / asked + person + not to + base verb	"Don't be late." → Mom asked me not to be late.
More verbs	remind, warn, advise, order + person + (not) to...	She reminded me to call the bank. · He warned us not to go there.

Pronunciation. A reported question **falls** at the end, like a statement: "She asked where I **lived**. ↘" (no rise). Learners often rise because their ear hears "a question": model the contrast. *whether* sounds like *weather* / 'wɛðər/: tell learners so; they are often surprised and pleased. *asked* is one syllable: /æskt/ ("askt"); the **-sk-t** cluster is hard, and many learners say "ask" or "as-ked." Drill it slowly: "ass – k – t → askt." In commands, *to* is weak /tə/ and *not to* is stressed on *not*: "She told me **NOT** to worry."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Question → report** (T asks, learners report what T asked, pointing at themselves): T: "Where do you live?" → S: "You asked where I lived." T: "What are you doing?" → S: "You asked what I was doing." T: "Why did you leave?" → S: "You asked why I had left."
- 2 **Yes/no → if**: T: "Are you hungry?" → S: "You asked if I was hungry." T: "Do you speak Spanish?" → S: "You asked whether I spoke Spanish." T: "Have you finished?" → S: "You asked if I had finished."
- 3 **Pronunciation**: choral *asked* /æskt/ ×3, *whether* = *weather* ×2, then the falling report: "She asked where I lived. ↘"
- 4 **Command or request?** T says it in two voices: firm "Sit down!" → S: "You told me to sit down." Polite "Could you sit down, please?" → S: "You asked me to sit down." T: "Don't touch it!" → S: "You told me not to touch it."
- 5 **Chain**: S1 asks S2 a real question ("Do you like coffee?"); S2 answers; S3 reports both: "Ana asked Omar if he liked coffee. He said he did."

◆ SURVEY REPORT – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Six survey topics (Food, Weekends, Phones & apps, Learning English, Music & movies, Work & dream jobs), 5 questions each. Give neighbors different topics so the reports are new to the group.
- ◆ Every card mixes **wh-** and **yes/no** questions, so learners must choose between the *wh-* word and *if/whether* in the report.
- ◆ The mingle is fast: ask 3 people, write 1–3 words per answer. The report is the main event. In groups, each learner reports **what they asked** and **what the person said**, and at least one **question someone asked them**: "Lina asked me whether I had a favorite app."
- ◆ Anyone can answer "Pass!" or answer as their new identity card. The questions are light on purpose; learners may not add personal questions about family, age or home country.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers**: in the group stage, each learner has **two turns** (use the talking-turn token). A learner who finishes early *listens and checks*: "Did she remove the *do*?" This gives the strong speaker a useful job.

◆ MESSAGE RELAY – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Before class, tape the 8 message cards on the walls, far from the desks: the **boss**, the **doctor's office**, the **building manager**, the **child's school**, the **pharmacist**, the **neighbor**, the **car mechanic**, the **dentist's office**. Each card has 3–4 lines of direct speech: a command, a negative command, a polite request and a question.
- ◆ Pairs: A = **runner**, B = **writer**. The runner may not carry the card or a pen. They read **one line**, walk back and report it: "The pharmacist told you to take one pill twice a day. She asked if you had any allergies." The writer writes a short to-do on the "While you were out" note ("take 1 pill ×2 a day").

- ◆ After 2 cards, swap roles. At the end, pairs walk to their cards and check their notes. A note that is correct in meaning is a success, even if the report had small errors.
- ◆ The messages are everyday and routine on purpose (a repair visit, a lab test, school pick-up time). Keep it that way; don't add eviction, debt or bad medical news.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SURVEY AND THE RELAY

SAY: Survey: *How many people do you ask? (Three.) · Do you write long answers? (No, 1–3 words.) · In your group, what do you report? (What I asked, what they said, and one question someone asked me.) · "Where do you live?" is OK on this card? (No! Only the card questions.)*

SAY: Relay: *Can the runner take the card? (No.) · How many lines at a time? (One.) · What does the writer write? (A short to-do.) · What words start the report? ("Your boss told you to... / asked if...") · When do you swap? (After 2 cards.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with two frames only: "She asked me if I..." and "He told me to...". Give a survey card with only 3 yes/no questions and picture cues. In the Relay, pair the learner as **runner** with a partner who writes, and let them use the picture on each message card (doctor, teacher, mechanic) as a memory hook. Target: 3 reported yes/no questions and 3 reported instructions.

STRETCH

Use *wanted to know, wondered, whether or not*, and the full set of verbs (*remind, warn, advise, order, beg, invite*). In the Relay, combine lines into one smooth report ("She reminded you to bring your card and asked whether you could come ten minutes early."). Early finishers write a 6-line job-interview dialogue and report it.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Question word order in the report:** "She asked where did I live?" / "I asked him why was he angry." Almost everyone does this, because the ear expects a question. Spanish, Portuguese, Russian, Arabic and Chinese learners may also keep the question intonation. Use the red pen on the board: cross out *do / did* and "?" every time.
- ◆ **"He asked was I ready"** (no *if*): Russian (*li* is placed after the verb), Chinese and Vietnamese (a question particle at the end) have no joining word like *if*. Drill "asked **if**..." as one chunk.
- ◆ **"She told me that I sit down" / "She said me to go":** Spanish and Portuguese use *decir que* + subjunctive (*me dijo que me sentara*), Italian *mi ha detto di*, French *elle m'a dit de*. Show the English chunk: **told me to** + verb.

- ◆ **"The doctor told me don't eat":** Chinese, Vietnamese and Tagalog speakers may keep the direct command. Also "told me to not worry." Teach **not to** as one piece: "told me **not to** eat."
- ◆ **"asked to me" / "asked for me to help"** (Spanish *le pidió a*, Arabic *ṭalab min* "asked from"). *ask* takes the person directly: "asked **me** to..."
- ◆ **/æskt/:** Spanish, Arabic, Vietnamese, Japanese and Korean speakers find the **-skt** cluster hard and may say "ask," "as-ked" or "ass-uh-ku-to." Accept "ask" in fast speech early on, but model "askt."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_08.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 3.2: finish "My interview report" (a short everyday conversation, 6 reports including one *if/whether* and one *not to*; the online project's "police interview" option is not needed), "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B She asked where I lived. · Q2 A He told me not to touch the paint. · Q3 (new) A He asked if I had a car. At the clinic (Ex 3): 1 if / whether he had · 2 his appointment was · 3 he had been · 4 to spell · 5 whether / if he had · 6 to fill out · 7 not to forget.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- choose the right relative pronoun: *who* (people), *which* (things), *that* (people or things, defining only), *where* (places), *when* (times), *whose* (possession)
- build **defining** clauses that say *which one*, with no commas: *The woman who called you is my aunt.*
- build **non-defining** clauses that add an extra fact, with **two commas**, no *that*: *My brother, who lives in Chicago, is a nurse.*
- drop the pronoun only when it is the **object** of a defining clause: *The movie (that) I watched was great.*
- define people, places and things in a game, join two short sentences into one, and describe six people, places and things in their life

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 3.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "People, places & things in my life")
- Slides 14–17 · Relative-pronoun cards · Picture flashcards (people, places, things) · "Who am I? / What is it?" cards (1 set per group) · **bingo grid** (1 per learner) · **sentence-combining strips + comma cards** (1 envelope per pair) · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 3.3-A (definitions bingo) and 3.3-B (comma dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the pronoun table: 👤 **who** · 📦 **which** · 👤📦 **that** (no commas only) · 📌 **where** · 🕒 **when** · 🔑 **whose** (= his / her / their).

Center: two sentences, one with a box and one with commas drawn big: **DEFINING** "My sister who lives in Rome is a lawyer." (I have 2+ sisters: which one?) · **NON-DEFINING** "My sister, who lives in Rome, is a lawyer." (I have one sister: extra fact.)

Right: ✂ The movie ~~(that)~~ I watched... ✓ (object: drop OK) · The man **who** called me... (subject: keep it!) · ❌ My car, ~~that~~ is red... ❌ The book which it changed my life.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: messages	8	S-S → T-S	Review C8. Pairs read one line from their homework interview report. Then a quick "What did they ask / tell you?" round: T reads 4 lines from the Relay cards; learners report them ("The mechanic told you not to

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			drive fast."). Two learners read their journal (only if they want to).
Lead-in: one sentence, not two	5	T-S	Board: "I have a friend. She lives in Canada." "Is this good English?" (Yes, but choppy.) "Make it one sentence." Elicit "I have a friend who lives in Canada." "Do you remember <i>who</i> and <i>which</i> from A2?" Let the class list the pronouns they know.
Relative pronouns	10	T-S	Slide 14. The six pronouns with a picture example each. New for most: <i>when</i> and <i>whose</i> (= his / her / their). CCQs. Then Workbook Ex 1 (choose the pronoun) together, fast.
Drill + bingo	5	T-S	Pronoun drill (see Drill script), then read Script 3.3-A : learners mark the picture on their bingo grid for each definition. First "Bingo!" reads back their three definitions.
Freer 1: Who am I? / What is it?	14	S-S (groups)	Slide 15. Groups of 3-4, cards face down. A player takes a card and defines it without saying the word: "It's a person who works in a hospital and who helps doctors." · "It's a place where you send letters." · "It's a thing which keeps food cold." The first to guess keeps the card. Stretch: the "Don't say" words on the card. ICQs first. Then Workbook Ex 2.
Defining vs non-defining	12	T-S	Slide 16. "Which one?" vs "extra fact." The sister example (one sister or two?), the "remove it" test, no <i>that</i> after a comma, and the pause at the commas when you speak. CCQs. Then slide 17: dropping the object pronoun. Then Script 3.3-B : a short dictation in which learners must hear the pauses and write the commas.
Controlled: sentence combining	12	S-S → S	Pairs take the envelope of sentence strips and comma cards . They join each pair of sentences on the desk with a pronoun card and place comma cards where needed (6 min). Monitor and ask "One sister or more?" Then Workbook Ex 3-5 alone (6 min); early finishers check with a partner.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer 2: my people, places & things	14	S → S-S (groups)	(1) Each learner chooses 6: two people, two places, two things or times (real, a new identity card, or imagined) and writes key words only (3 min). (2) In groups of 3, each learner talks for 1–2 minutes: "My best friend is someone who... · The town where I grew up... · My phone, which is very old, ..." Listeners ask one follow-up question each (9 min). (3) Each group shares the best sentence with a comma pause (2 min).
Feedback + module check	5	T-S	Delayed correction: "The man called me was angry." · "London, that is huge, ..." · "The book which it changed my life." · "I have a neighbor who's dog barks." Then learners tick the three Module 3 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 3.3; the "people, places & things" writing; preview C10: "Next class: <i>The bridge was built in 1890</i> . Who built it? We don't care! The passive."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 5 + 14 + 12 + 12 + 14 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: a relative clause describes the noun just before it. It joins two ideas into one sentence.

SAY: "That's the woman whose car was stolen." Whose car was stolen? (The woman's. Her car.) · "This is the café where we met." Is where a question here? (No, it means "in this café.") · "I remember the day when we moved." Is when about a time or a place? (A time.)

Meaning: defining vs non-defining.

SAY: "My sister who lives in Rome is a lawyer." (no commas) How many sisters do I have? (Two or more.) Why do I say "who lives in Rome"? (To say which sister.) · "My sister, who lives in Rome, is a lawyer." (commas) How many sisters? (One.) Is "who lives in Rome" needed? (No, it's extra.)

SAY: "Paris, which is the capital of France, is beautiful." Do we know which Paris? (Yes.) So: commas or no commas? (Commas: it's extra.) · Can I say "Paris, that is the capital..."? (No! No that after a comma.)

SAY: Dropping: "The movie I watched was great." Is a word missing? (Yes, that / which.) Is it OK? (Yes, I is the new subject.) · "The man called me was angry." OK? (No! who is the subject: "The man **who** called me.")

Form.

Pronouns	who people · which things · that people / things (defining) · where places · when times · whose possession	That's the man whose dog barks all night.
Defining	noun + pronoun + clause · no commas · <i>that</i> OK	The keys that open the garage are lost.
Non-defining	noun, + <i>who</i> / <i>which</i> + clause, · two commas · <i>no that</i> · never drop the pronoun	Our new house, which we bought last year, has a garden.
Drop the pronoun	defining + object only (a new subject follows)	The people (who) we met were lovely. · ❌ The woman lives here...
where = which ... in	where + subject + verb	The house where I live = the house which I live in.

Pronunciation. In speech, a **non-defining clause is a little "aside"**: a short pause at each comma and a slightly lower, faster voice inside: "My **brother** | who lives in Chicago | is a **nurse**." A defining clause has **no pause**: "The woman who called you is my **aunt**." Use your hands: push the extra fact to the side. *whose* and *who's* sound the same /huz/; only writing shows the difference. *that* in a defining clause is weak /ðət/. *which* and *witch* sound the same; the **wh** is /w/ in American English.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Which pronoun?** (hold up a flashcard) T: nurse → S: "a person **who**..." · fridge → "a thing **which**..." · post office → "a place **where**..." · summer → "a time **when**..."
- Join it:** T: "I have a friend. She speaks five languages." → S: "I have a friend who speaks five languages." T: "This is the book. It changed my life." → S: "This is the book that changed my life."
- Pause or no pause?** T reads; learners show 🖐️ (pause, commas) or 👉 (no pause, no commas): "My mother, who is a nurse, works nights." 🖐️ · "The bus that goes to town leaves at seven." 👉 · "Venice, which is full of canals, is sinking." 🖐️
- Drop it?** T: "The movie that I watched..." → S: "The movie I watched." ✂️ T: "The man who called me..." → S: "Keep it!"
- whose** substitution: T: "I know a boy. His father is a pilot." → S: "I know a boy whose father is a pilot." T: "That's the woman. Her car was stolen." → S: "That's the woman whose car was stolen."

◆ "WHO AM I? / WHAT IS IT?" – HOW TO RUN IT

- Groups of 3–4, a set of 24 cards face down: 8 **people** (jobs), 8 **places**, 8 **things**. Each card has a picture, the word and two "Don't say" words.

- ◆ A player takes a card and defines it **without saying the word**, using a relative clause: "It's a person who... / It's a place where... / It's a thing which (that)... / You use it when...". The first person to guess correctly keeps the card. Most cards wins.
- ◆ Level 1: the "Don't say" words are allowed. Level 2 (stretch): the player may not say the "Don't say" words either ("chef: don't say *cook* or *restaurant*").
- ◆ The guessers must answer with a full sentence: "Is it a nurse? A nurse is a person who helps doctors!"
- ◆ Dominant speakers: the guesser who wins a card must wait one turn before guessing again. This gives quieter learners time to think.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GAME AND THE SENTENCE STRIPS

SAY: *Game: Can you say the word on the card? (No!) · What words start your definition? ("It's a person who... / a place where... / a thing which...") · Who keeps the card? (The first person who guesses.)*

SAY: *Strips: How many sentences do you make from two strips? (One.) · When do you use the comma cards? (When the information is extra.) · Can you put that after a comma? (No.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on defining clauses with *who*, *which* and *where* only. In the game, use the picture side of the card and three frames on a strip: "a person who... / a thing which... / a place where...". Give only the first 5 sentence strips (all defining). Target: 4 spoken definitions and 3 joined sentences. The commas can wait.

STRETCH

Use *whose* and *when* in the game. In the strips, find the two sentences that can be **both** defining and non-defining and explain the difference in meaning. In "my people, places & things," use two non-defining clauses and one *which is why*.... Early finishers write 3 sentences that change meaning with commas.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **The extra pronoun:** "The book which I read it" / "The man who I saw **him**." Arabic, Hebrew, Persian, Turkish (in some forms), Irish and many Chinese speakers use a "resumptive" pronoun. The lesson's "double subject" warning ("The book which it changed my life") is the same error. Cross out the extra pronoun.
- ◆ **Clause in the wrong place or avoided:** Chinese, Japanese and Korean put the describing clause *before* the noun (like "the lives-in-Canada friend"), so learners may avoid relative clauses and use two sentences. Praise every attempt; accuracy comes later.
- ◆ **who / which mix-ups:** "the man which..." or "the car who...": Spanish *que*, French *qui* / *que*, Portuguese *que* and Tagalog *na* / *-ng* use one word for people and things. The board symbols (👤 / 📦) help.

- ◆ "My car, that is red, ...": Spanish, Portuguese and Italian allow *que / che* after a comma. Teach: comma → **who / which**.
- ◆ **Commas everywhere:** German (and Russian, Polish, Czech) put a comma before *every* relative clause, so learners write "The man, who lives next door, is a doctor" for a defining clause. Show that the commas change the meaning in English.
- ◆ **whose / who's:** same sound for everyone. Spelling only: *who's* = who is.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_09.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back, pausing at the commas; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 3.3: finish "People, places & things in my life" (6 sentences, at least one *whose* and one non-defining clause with commas), "My new words" and the journal (one sentence that changes meaning with commas, and why).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B *whose* · Q2 B My father, who is retired, plays golf. · Q3 (new) B "The man called me was angry." is NOT correct. Bingo (Script 3.3-A): nurse, chef, mechanic, waiter, airport, post office, bank, station, fridge, umbrella, passport, key.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C9: MODULE 3 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, the "three shapes and one join": **She said (that) she was...** (statements) → **She asked where / if I...** (questions) → **She told me (not) to...** (commands) → **the woman who... / my sister, who...**, (connecting ideas). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C10 warmer and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 4: the passive (*was built, is made*) uses **be + past participle**, and relative clauses combine with it naturally ("the bridge **which was built** in 1890"). Learners who just learned the backshift may mix *was* + participle with the past perfect ("He said it had built..."). Keep a 2-minute "report it" warmer (one statement, one question, one command) in C10–C12.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: the backshift (including *will* → *would, can* → *could, must* → *had to*), pronoun and time-word changes, *say* vs *tell* + *person*, reported wh- and yes/no questions (word order, *if / whether*), *told / asked* + *person* + (*not*) *to*, the relative pronouns, defining vs non-defining clauses with commas, and when the pronoun can be dropped.

Module 4 — Structures for Fluency

Three classes that finish the first half of B1. First comes the **passive** (present and past simple) for facts, products and processes: *Coffee is grown in Brazil. The bridge was built in 1932.* Then **modals of deduction** (*must / might / can't be*) to reason from clues, set against the **obligation and advice** modals learners met at A2. Last, a task-based review: learners hold a **mini debate** and tell a **short story** with the grammar of Modules 1–4, while you score a speaking checklist that feeds Progress Test 1 (C13).

3 lessons

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

Weeks 5–6

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. C10 and C11 follow the usual shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C12 is a **task-based review**: the task comes first and language work comes out of it.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-4-fluency-structures.html](#). Print [materials/module-4/classroom-materials.html](#) before C10. It holds the flashcards, the How It's Made quiz, the process strips, the fact-file information gap, the mystery close-ups, the detective cards, the "Whose bag?" case, the rules-or-advice cards, the mini-debate cards, the story cards, the **C12 speaking checklist**, the Module 1–4 Review Race board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** Learners met past participles with the present perfect (B1 Module 1, and A2), and *have to / must / mustn't / should* at A2. Build on this. The new B1 work is the **passive voice**, **must / can't / might** for **deduction**, and the **choice** between obligation, no obligation, prohibition and advice.
- Keep B1 honest.** Learners *produce* the present and past simple passive and *present* deductions only. They may meet other forms (*is being repaired, has been sent, must have left*) outside class: teach these for recognition ("You'll understand this; you don't need to make it yet"). Past perfect is Lesson 5.1: accept it in C12 stories, never require it.
- American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use some British forms (*city centre, parcel, postman, carriage, guard, half past nine, practise, travelling*). Teach *downtown, package, mail carrier, (train) car, conductor, nine-thirty, practice, traveling*. Accept British forms from learners. Note: Americans rarely say

mustn't. For rules they say *can't*, *aren't allowed to* or (in writing) *must not*. Teach *mustn't* so learners understand it, and give the American forms next to it.

- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Move the spotlight → measure how sure you are → say what you think. In C10 learners move the focus of a sentence from the doer to the thing (*This watch is made in Switzerland.*) and describe products and processes. In C11 they reason from clues and show how certain they are (*The lights are off, so they must be out.*), and keep that apart from rules and advice (*You have to... / You should...*). In C12 they use everything from Modules 1–4 in two real tasks: argue a point in a small group and tell a short story. Every class ends with a speaking task that is longer and freer than the one before.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: FACTS, GUESSES AND OPINIONS

C10: "facts about your country" is an *option*, never a requirement. Learners can describe any product, any place, or a process like making bread. Don't ask one learner to "represent" their country. **C11:** deductions are about **pictures, objects and card people**, never about people in the room ("She must be pregnant," "He must be poor"). Say this rule before every detective task. **C12:** debate topics are everyday (city life, phones, cooking, transportation), never politics, religion or immigration. Every learner argues from an **opinion card**, so no one has to share a real opinion. Stories can be **true, changed, or completely invented** (story cards). A light story is a good story. Say "Real or invented, both are great" every time.

TWO B1 HABITS FOR EVERY CLASS IN THIS MODULE

Fluency before accuracy. In freer tasks, don't stop speakers to correct. Listen, write down 4–6 sentences you hear (good ones and ones with errors), and give feedback in two steps: first **content** ("Which group had the most surprising fact? Who changed their mind?"), then **language** on the board with no names, and the class fixes it together. Correct on the spot only when a mistake blocks meaning.

Dominant and quiet speakers. B1 groups often have one confident speaker who fills the silence. Use structure, not criticism: **talking tokens** (3 each; you put one down every time you speak; when your tokens are gone, you listen), a **chair** role that rotates and invites others ("What do you think, Ana?"), **think time** (30 seconds silent before anyone speaks) and a **fixed speaking order** for the first round. Give the strongest speaker a job that needs listening: chair, timekeeper, or "question master." Quiet learners rehearse in pairs before they speak to a group.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **picture flashcards** (Set A: products, clue objects, debate topics). Card stock helps.

- For C10: one **How It's Made** quiz set per class (Set B), one set of **process strips** per pair (Set C, cut and mixed), one **fact-file A/B** page per pair (Set D). Bring 3–4 real things with labels: a coffee packet, a T-shirt ("Made in..."), a can or a bottle ("Recycle me"), a phone box.
- For C11: one **mystery close-up** set per group (Set E), one **detective card** set per group of 3–4 (Set F), one **"Whose bag?"** case per group (Set G), one **rules-or-advice** set per pair (Set H). For the lead-in, a real bag with 5–6 objects in it (see the C11 plan).
- For C12: **mini-debate** topic cards, opinion cards, chair cards and talking tokens (Set I; coins or paper clips work as tokens), **story cards** (Set J), one **speaking checklist** class grid for you and one score slip per learner (Set K), and one **Review Race** board per group of 3–4 with a die and counters (Set L).
- Optional: learners' phones for recording stories in C12. Ask the class in C11 who is happy to use a phone.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.1	C10 • wk 5	Present and past simple passive (<i>am / is / are / was / were</i> + past participle); + / – / ?; why we use it (doer unknown, unimportant, obvious, general; processes); <i>by</i> + agent only when useful; active → passive in 3 steps; <i>made of / from / in / by</i>	describe a product, a place or a process in 6+ passive sentences, and ask passive questions (<i>When was it built?</i>)
4.2	C11 • wk 6	<i>must / can't / might / may / could</i> + base verb for present deduction; the certainty scale; <i>can't</i> , not <i>mustn't</i> , for "sure it's not true"; obligation review: <i>have to / must</i> , <i>don't have to</i> , <i>mustn't</i> , and <i>should</i> for advice	make 6+ deductions linked to clues ("...", so it must be..."), and tell a rule from advice and from "not necessary"
4.3	C12 • wk 6	Review project. Opinion language (give, support, agree, disagree politely, <i>So do I / Neither do I</i>); a small-group mini debate ; a short personal or fictional story with Module 1–4 grammar; the C12 speaking checklist (feeds C13)	give and support an opinion, disagree politely in a group discussion, and tell a connected 2–3 minute story using at least four B1 structures

4.1 · C10

The Passive Voice — How It's Made

90 min

OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- form the present simple passive (*am / is / are* + past participle) and the past simple passive (*was / were* + past participle), with negatives and questions
- explain when the passive is the better choice: the doer is unknown, unimportant, obvious or "people in general," or the focus is a process or result
- add *by* + agent only when the doer is interesting or important (never "by someone / by people")
- change active sentences into passive with the 3-step method, and use *made of / made from / made in / made by*
- describe a product, a place or a process in 6+ passive sentences

MATERIALS

- Workbook 4.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My 6 facts" plan)
- Slides 3–7 · Product flashcards (Set A) · 3–4 real labeled objects · **How It's Made quiz** (Set B) · **Process strips** (Set C, 1 set per pair) · **Fact-file information gap A/B** (Set D, 1 page per pair)
- Listening scripts 4.1-A (How coffee is made) and 4.1-B (News in brief)

BOARD PLAN

Left: ACTIVE: *Farmers grow coffee in Brazil.* (the doer is the star) → PASSIVE: *Coffee **is grown** in Brazil.* (the thing is the star). Under it: **be + past participle.**

Center: two columns. PRESENT: It **is made** · They **are grown** · It **isn't recycled** · Is it **made** with milk? | PAST: It **was built** · They **were sent** · It **wasn't delivered** · **When was it built?**

Right: Why passive?  unknown ·  not important ·  obvious ·  people in general ·  a process. Below: **by** + agent only if interesting: *Hamlet was written **by** Shakespeare.*  · *My bike was stolen ~~by someone~~.*

STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: define it	8	S-S (pairs)	Review C9 (3.3, relative clauses). A picks a flashcard and defines it without saying the word: "It's a thing which you use when it rains." "It's a person who works in a restaurant." B guesses. Swap after 4 cards. Listen for <i>which / who / where</i> . Keep two definitions

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			for the lead-in: "It's a thing which is used for..." is a passive!
Lead-in: where was it made?	6	T-S → S-S	Hold up your real objects. "Look at the label. What does it say?" Elicit <i>Made in...</i> Learners check a label near them (a pen, a bag, a phone) and tell a partner. Write two on the board: "This T-shirt was made in Bangladesh." "This coffee is grown in Colombia." Ask: "Who made it? Do we know? Do we care?" (No.) That's the passive.
Grammar: be + past participle	15	T-S	Slides 3–4. Meaning (focus on the thing, not the doer), form (only be changes for tense and person; the participle is the same one learners know from the present perfect), negatives, questions. CCQs and drill (see notes). Quick participle check: T says a verb, learners say the participle (<i>grow</i> → <i>grown</i> , <i>build</i> → <i>built</i> , <i>steal</i> → <i>stolen</i> , <i>write</i> → <i>written</i> , <i>sell</i> → <i>sold</i>).
Listening: How coffee is made	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.1-A twice. First listen: "Where is coffee grown?" Second listen: learners number the six steps. Pairs check by saying the steps: "First, the coffee cherries are picked..." Point out: we never hear who does it.
Why passive? + the agent	7	T-S	Slide 5. The five reasons with an example each. Read Script 4.1-B (News in brief): learners write the passive verbs they hear, then say why the doer is missing in each. Then <i>by</i> + agent: " <i>The Mona Lisa was painted by Leonardo da Vinci</i> . Is <i>by Leonardo</i> useful? (Yes! It's famous.) <i>My phone was stolen by someone</i> : useful? (No.)"
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Slide 6 (active → passive in 3 steps), then Workbook Ex 2, 3 and 4 alone. Pairs check. Board-check only items pairs disagree on (usually the tense of be in Ex 2 and when to keep <i>by</i> in Ex 3). Early finishers do the process strips (chocolate) and say the steps.
Freer 1: How It's Made quiz	14	S-S (teams) → T-S	Slide 7. Teams of 3–4. You read a quiz card (Set B) with three options. Teams talk (30 seconds), then one speaker gives the answer as a full passive sentence : "Paper was invented in China." 1 point for

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			the right fact, +1 for a correct passive sentence. Rotate the speaker every question. 12–14 questions. ICQs first.
Freer 2: fact-file information gap	10	S–S	Set D. A has the full file on the Riverside Bridge; B has the full file on Sunrise Chocolate. Each asks passive questions to fill the gaps in the other file: "When was the bridge built ?" "Where are the beans grown ?" Don't show the cards. Pairs who finish choose one file and present it to another pair in 5 sentences.
Feedback	5	T–S	Content first: "Which quiz answer surprised you?" Then 4 sentences you heard (no names), e.g. "Coffee grown in Brazil." · "The bridge is built in 1932." · "Paper was invent in China." · "An accident was happened." Learners fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T–S	Show online lesson 4.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below): the "My 6 facts" plan is the online project. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 15 + 8 + 7 + 12 + 14 + 10 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Cut the quiz to 8 questions and move the fact-file information gap to the C11 warmer (it recycles the passive before deduction). Never cut the **be** check in the grammar stage: a missing **be** ("English spoken here") is the top error, and it is easy to fix today and hard to fix later.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the passive moves the spotlight. The thing that receives the action becomes the subject. The doer is not important, not known, obvious, or "people in general." It is not a new tense; it is a new **voice**.

SAY: "This watch is made in Switzerland." Do we know who makes it? (No.) Is that important? (No.) What is the sentence about: the workers or the watch? (The watch.) · "My car was stolen last night." Who stole it? (We don't know.) Present or past? (Past: was.)

SAY: "He was arrested on Friday." Who arrested him? (The police: it's obvious.) · "Rice is eaten all over Asia." Who eats it? (People: everybody.) Do we need to say "by people"? (No.)

SAY: "Hamlet was written by Shakespeare." Why do we say by Shakespeare here? (It's famous, interesting information.) · "The office is cleaned every evening." Can I say by them? (You can, but it adds nothing. Leave it out.)

Form. Color the **be** verb in one color and the past participle in another. **be** shows the tense and agrees with the subject; the participle never changes.

Present	subject + am / is / are + past participle	English is spoken here. · These cars are made in Japan.
Past	subject + was / were + past participle	The bridge was built in 1890. · The letters were sent yesterday.
Negative	isn't / aren't / wasn't / weren't + participle	Plastic isn't recycled here. · The package wasn't delivered.
Question	(Wh-) + is / are / was / were + subject + participle?	Is this dish made with milk? · When was it built? · Where are they grown?
Agent	... + by + doer (only if useful)	The Mona Lisa was painted by Leonardo da Vinci.
made...	made of (material you can see) · made from (changed) · made in (place) · made by (maker)	made of wood · made from milk · made in Italy · made by hand

Pronunciation. In speech, **be** is weak and linked: "It's **MADE** in **JAPan**" (/ɪts/), "They're **GROWN**...", "It was **BUILT**" /wəz/. The stress falls on the participle and the new information, not on *was*. **-ed** endings matter here: *invented, painted, designed* /ɪd/ adds a beat only after /t/ or /d/; *used, opened, delivered* end in /d/; *picked, packed, cooked* in /t/. *used* in "It is used for..." is /juzd/ (z), not /just/ as in "used to." *ground* (from *grind*) rhymes with *found*.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Back-chain:** "in Brazil" → "is grown in Brazil" → "Coffee is grown in Brazil." Choral ×3, half the room, then 4–5 individuals. Then "was built in 1890" → "The bridge was built in 1890."
- 2 Tense switch** (hold up a card: NOW or a year): T: "coffee / grow / Brazil" + NOW → S: "Coffee is grown in Brazil." T: "the bridge / build" + 1890 → S: "The bridge was built in 1890." T: "these shoes / make / Italy" + NOW → S: "These shoes are made in Italy."
- 3 Subject switch** (is / are): T: "English / speak" → "English is spoken..." T: "Spanish and Portuguese / speak" → "...are spoken." Point at the subject every time.
- 4 Question chain:** S1: "When was the Eiffel Tower built?" S2: "It was built in 1889. Where are bananas grown?" S3: "They're grown in... (Ecuador / India / the Philippines)."

- 5 **Cut the agent:** T says an active sentence; learners say the passive and decide on *by*: "Someone stole my phone." → "My phone was stolen." "Shakespeare wrote Hamlet." → "Hamlet was written by Shakespeare."

◆ HOW IT'S MADE QUIZ – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Teams of 3–4 with a team name. One sheet of paper per team for the score. Read each card and its three options twice.
- ◆ 30 seconds to talk (in English!). Then the team's speaker for that round says the answer as a **full passive sentence**. The speaker changes every round, so everyone speaks. This is also your fix for a dominant speaker.
- ◆ Scoring: 1 point for the right fact, +1 for a correct passive sentence (right **be** + participle). A wrong fact in a perfect sentence still gets 1 point. Say this: good English matters as much as knowing the fact.
- ◆ After the answer, give one extra fact from the card's note (in the passive) and let a learner repeat it.
- ◆ Last round: each team writes **one question for the other teams** about their own town, a product they know, or any country ("Where is ___ grown?", "When was ___ built?"). Nobody has to ask about their home country.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE QUIZ AND THE INFORMATION GAP

SAY: Quiz: Who talks first: the team or the speaker? (The team, 30 seconds.) · How do you give the answer? (A full passive sentence.) · How many points for a correct sentence? (One more.) · Is the speaker always the same person? (No, it changes.)

SAY: Fact files: Can you show your card? (No.) · What kind of questions do you ask? (Passive questions: "When was it built?") · When you finish, what do you do? (Present one file to another pair.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with four fixed chunks: *It is made in...* · *It is grown in...* · *It was built in...* · *It was made by...* Use the product flashcards and labels as prompts. In the quiz, the learner can answer by pointing to the option and then saying the chunk with a partner. In the fact files, give a question strip with the questions already written; the learner reads a question and writes only the answer (a year, a place, a number). Target: 4 spoken passive sentences about real objects.

STRETCH

Use sequence words in a process (*First... Then... After that... Finally...*) and a relative clause (*The beans are roasted, which gives them their color.*). Recognize other tenses of the passive when you meet them (*is being repaired, has been sent*) and say what they mean. Rewrite a short news article from a free news site for learners in the active, then back in the passive, and decide which version sounds better.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **No be: "English spoken here" / "Coffee grown in Brazil":** Chinese, Vietnamese, Arabic, Russian and Haitian Creole speakers (no *be* in many present sentences). Point at the **be** color every time: "No **be**, no passive."
- ◆ **"Here speaks English" / "It sells in the market":** Spanish *se habla*, Portuguese *fala-se*, Italian *si parla*, French *on parle* build the passive idea with *se / on*. Show the English pattern: "English **is spoken** here." "It **is sold** at the market."
- ◆ **"An accident was happened" / "He was died":** common for Arabic, Chinese, Japanese, Korean and Turkish speakers, and for anyone who has just learned the passive. *happen, die, arrive, go, sleep* have no object, so no passive.
- ◆ **Passive only for bad news:** Chinese *bèi* and the Japanese / Korean "suffering" passive are mostly used for unpleasant events. Learners may avoid neutral passives ("Rice is eaten..."). Give many neutral examples.
- ◆ **"The house becomes built" / "The bridge will built":** German and Dutch *werden / worden* (= become) make the passive. Drill "is / was + participle."
- ◆ **Base verb or regular -ed instead of the participle:** "are make," "was builded," "was stealed." Everyone. Keep the irregular list from Module 1 on the wall.
- ◆ **"made of" for everything** (Spanish and Portuguese *hecho de / feito de*, French *fait de*). Teach the four: made **of** wood · made **from** milk · made **in** Italy · made **by** hand.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_10.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 4.1: finish Ex 5 ("My 6 facts": a

product, a place or a process, with one *by* + agent), "My new words" and the journal (one active sentence about your life, rewritten in the passive, and which version you like better and why).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** were sent · Q2 **A** The school was built in 1985. · Q3 (new) **B** My bag was stolen. Coffee (Ex 1, Script 4.1-A), in order: picked → skins removed → dried in the sun → roasted → ground → packed and sold. News in brief (Script 4.1-B): was opened · was designed · were given · was stolen · was found · was hurt.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use *must* (sure it's true) and *can't* (sure it's not true) + base verb to make present deductions from clues
- ◆ use *might* / *may* / *could* (+ *not*) when they are not sure, and place a guess on the certainty scale
- ◆ link a deduction to its clue with *so*: *The lights are off, so they must be out.*
- ◆ use *can't*, not *mustn't*, for a negative deduction, and tell deduction-*must* from obligation-*must*
- ◆ tell apart *have to* / *must* (necessary), *don't have to* (not necessary), *mustn't* (not allowed) and *should* (advice)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My 3 deductions")
- ◆ Slides 8–13 · Clue-object flashcards (Set A) · **Mystery close-ups** (Set E) · **Detective cards** (Set F) · **"Whose bag?"** case (Set G) · **Rules or advice?** cards (Set H)
- ◆ A real bag with 5–6 objects (see the lead-in) · Listening scripts 4.2-A (Where's Sam?) and 4.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the certainty scale, top to bottom:  **must** (sure YES, ~95%) →  **might** / **may** / **could** (maybe, ~50%) →  **can't** (sure NO, ~95%). Beside it: CLUE, **so** + DEDUCTION: *The ground is wet, so it must be raining.*

Center: modal + **base verb**: She **must be** tired. · He **can't be** hungry. · They **might know**. (no *to*, no *-s*). A box: *can't*  / *mustn't*  for "sure it's not true."

Right: RULES & ADVICE: **have to** / **must** = necessary · **don't have to** = not necessary (your choice) · **mustn't** (US: *can't* / not allowed) = forbidden · **should** = a good idea. Below: *must* has 2 jobs:  "You must sign here." (rule) ·  "You must be tired." (deduction)

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: What is it?	8	S-S (pairs) → T-S	Review C10. A thinks of an object; B asks only passive yes/no questions: "Is it made of glass?" "Is it used in the kitchen?" "Was it invented a long time ago?" A answers "Yes, it is. / No, it wasn't." Swap. Two volunteers read a "My 6 facts" sentence from homework.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Lead-in: the mystery bag	7	T-S	Put your bag on the desk. "I found this bag on the bus. Whose is it?" Take out one object at a time (e.g. a bus ticket, reading glasses, a baby's sock, a library book, keys with a soccer key ring). After each one, elicit guesses. Recast them: "Maybe she has a baby." → " She might have a baby." "It's not a child's bag." → " It can't be a child's bag." "She has a baby, sure!" → " She must have a baby." No grammar talk yet.
Grammar: must / might / can't	15	T-S	Slide 9. The certainty scale, the form (modal + base verb), and <i>so</i> between clue and deduction. CCQs and drill (see notes). Highlight the trap: the opposite of deduction- <i>must</i> is <i>can't</i> , not <i>mustn't</i> .
Mystery close-ups	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 8, then Set E. Show a very close-up picture: "What is it?" Learners guess with all three levels: "It might be a lamp. It can't be food, it's metal. It must be a key!" Reveal. Then groups of 3 do Set E: one learner holds the close-up; the others deduce; the holder answers "Warmer! / Colder!" and reveals.
Listening: Where's Sam?	7	T-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.2-A twice. Learners write the clue and the deduction for each idea (stuck in traffic → can't; still asleep / sick → might, may; on his way → must). Check: "What's the clue? So...?"
Obligation vs advice	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 10–11. "One word, two jobs": <i>You must sign here</i> vs <i>You must be tired</i> . Then the rules family: <i>have to</i> / <i>must</i> vs <i>don't have to</i> vs <i>mustn't</i> vs <i>should</i> . CCQs. Pairs sort the Rules or advice? cards (Set H) into four columns and say each one: "At the pool, you mustn't run." Check the two traps: <i>mustn't</i> ≠ <i>don't have to</i> , and <i>have to</i> (a rule) vs <i>should</i> (my advice).
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone, then pairs check. Board-check only disagreements (usually Ex 5, obligation or deduction?).
Freer: the detective agency	13	S-S (groups)	Slides 12–13. Read the lost-bag model dialogue (slide 12) in two halves of the room. Then groups of 3–4: (1) the " Whose bag? " case (Set G): turn over one clue at a time and move up and down the scale until the group

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			is sure (6 min); (2) detective cards (Set F): take a card, read the situation, make 3 deductions (must / might / can't) with the clue, and one "should" advice sentence (7 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first: "Whose bag was it? What was the best clue?" Then board, no names: "He mustn't be at home." · "She must to be tired." · "It can be the mail carrier." · "You mustn't pay, it's free." Learners fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 4.2; "My 3 deductions" and the journal. Preview C12: "Next class you'll tell a short story and have a mini debate. Think of a small story: true or invented."
Total	90		8 + 7 + 15 + 10 + 7 + 10 + 10 + 13 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This class has two jobs. If time is short, keep the deduction work whole (it is new) and shorten the obligation review to slide 11 + half the Rules or advice cards: learners met these modals at A2. In the freer stage, do the "Whose bag?" case and only 3–4 detective cards.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: deduction. A guess with a reason. The speaker looks at a clue and says how sure they are. Nobody told them the answer.

SAY: "The light's on, so she must be home." Did she tell me she's home? (No.) What's my clue? (The light.) How sure am I? (Very sure, about 95%.) Is it a rule? (No, it's a guess.)

SAY: "He can't be hungry. He just ate." Is he hungry? (No.) Am I sure? (Yes, very.) Can I say "He mustn't be hungry"? (No! mustn't means "not allowed.")

SAY: "She's not answering. She might be busy." Is she busy? (Maybe.) Can I say "may be busy" or "could be busy"? (Yes, the same.) Can I say "She can be busy" for this? (Not for one situation now; use might / could.)

Meaning: obligation and advice.

SAY: "You have to show ID at the bank." Is it my choice? (No, it's a rule.) · "You don't have to come on Saturday." Can I come? (Yes.) Do I need to? (No, it's my choice.) · "You mustn't park here." Is it OK? (No, it's

against the rules.) · "You should rest." Is it a rule? (No, it's advice: a good idea.)

SAY: "You must be tired after that trip." A rule or a guess? (A guess: deduction.) · "You must sign here." A rule or a guess? (A rule.) How do you know? (The situation. *be tired* is a state; *sign* is an action someone asks you to do.)

Form. Modals never change: no **-s**, no **to**, no **do**. The verb after them is the base form, very often **be**. For "happening now," use **be + -ing**: *It must be raining. They might be sleeping.*

Sure YES	subject + must + base verb	She must be home. · It must be raining.
Maybe	subject + might / may / could (+ not) + base verb	He might be busy. · It could be a mistake. · She may not know.
Sure NO	subject + can't + base verb	That can't be right. · They can't be asleep. It's noon!
Necessary	have to / has to · must	I have to work tomorrow. · You must show ID.
Not necessary	don't / doesn't have to	You don't have to pay. It's free.
Not allowed	mustn't · (US) can't / aren't allowed to	You mustn't smoke here. · You can't park here.
Advice	should / shouldn't	You should rest. · You shouldn't worry.

Pronunciation. The big one in American English: **can't** /kænt/ vs **can** /kən/. In a positive sentence *can* is weak and unstressed; *can't* is strong and stressed, and the final **t** is often not released. Learners must *stress CAN'T* or the listener hears the opposite. **must** is weak in deductions ("She /məs/ be **TIRED**"); stress the new information. **mustn't** /'mʌsənt/: the first **t** is silent. *have to* = /'hæftə/ ("hafta"), *has to* = /'hæstə/. Deductions often have a thinking, falling tone: "Hmm... it **MIGHT** be..." with a pause before the guess, which is natural and gives thinking time.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Scale drill** (point at the scale on the board): T: "be home" +  → S: "She must be home." +  → "She might be home." +  → "She can't be home." Choral, individuals, then faster.
- 2 Clue → deduction** (T gives a clue, learners finish with so): T: "He's yawning..." → S: "...so he must be tired." T: "She doesn't have a brother..." → S: "...so that can't be her brother." T: "I don't know who's at the door..." → S: "...so it might be the mail carrier."
- 3 can / can't listening:** T says "You can park here. / You can't park here. / It can be cold here in winter. / It can't be cold, it's July." Learners show  (can) or  (can't). Then learners test each other with a stressed CAN'T.

- 4 **Fix the mustn't:** T: "He mustn't be at home. His car's gone." → S: "He can't be at home." T: "The shop mustn't be open." → S: "The shop can't be open."
- 5 **Rule, not necessary, or advice?** T: "Seatbelt, car." → S: "You have to wear a seatbelt." T: "Free museum, pay." → "You don't have to pay." T: "Library, phone calls." → "You mustn't / can't make phone calls." T: "Cold, sleep." → "You should go to bed early."

◆ THE DETECTIVE AGENCY – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **The rule first:** "Detectives make deductions about **pictures, objects and card people**. Never about people in this room." Say it before every round.
- ◆ **"Whose bag?"** (Set G): the four owner profiles go face up; the clue cards go face down in order (1–5). Turn over one clue. Every learner makes one deduction about one person with the clue: "It can't be Grace's, because the ticket is to Toronto." Then the next clue. After clue 5 the group writes its answer ("It must be ____'s bag, because..."). The group with the best reasons, not the fastest, wins.
- ◆ **Detective cards** (Set F): a player reads the situation aloud. Each other player adds one deduction at a different level (must / might / can't), always with the clue: "There are three newspapers at the door, so they can't be at home." The reader adds one piece of **advice** with *should*: "We should call them." Next player reads.
- ◆ **Talking tokens** work well here: 3 each. When your tokens are gone, you listen until everyone has spoken.
- ◆ Early finishers turn two detective cards into a short dialogue like the lost-bag model and read it to another group.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DETECTIVE AGENCY

SAY: *Do we make deductions about people in this room? (No! Only pictures, objects and card people.) · In "Whose bag?", do you turn over all the clues at once? (No, one at a time.) · What word goes between the clue and the deduction? ("So.") · With the detective cards, how many deductions? (Three: must, might, can't.) · And the reader? (One piece of advice with "should.")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use the three picture symbols    in place of the words, and three fixed frames: *It must be...* · *It might be...* · *It can't be...* The close-ups are ideal: no reading needed. In the detective agency, a partner reads the situation card aloud and the learner chooses a symbol and finishes the frame. Target: 4 spoken deductions, at least one of each level, and one "You should...".

STRETCH

Use *be* + *-ing* for deductions about now (*They must be sleeping.*) and give two competing deductions for one clue (*She might be at work, or she could be at the gym.*). Recognize past deduction (*She must have left*) in the online lesson and say what it means, but keep your own deductions in the present. Write a short "mystery" (3 clues, one answer) for a classmate to solve.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **German "muss nicht" = don't have to.** German speakers say "You mustn't come" when they mean "You don't have to come." The meaning reverses. Show the pair side by side and drill it.
- ◆ **"He mustn't be at home"** for a negative deduction: everyone, but especially Spanish and Portuguese speakers (*no debe de estar / não deve estar* = probably isn't). Fix it every time: "sure NO → **can't**."
- ◆ **"It can be the mail carrier"** for a possibility now: Spanish *puede ser*, Portuguese *pode ser*, French *ça peut être*, Italian *può essere*. In English, *can* is for general possibility ("It can be cold here in winter"); for one situation now, use *might* / *could*.
- ◆ **"She must to be tired" / "It must is broken":** learners whose L1 uses a full verb for *must* (Spanish *debe*, Arabic *yajib an*). Chant: "modal + plain verb."
- ◆ **"He should be at home"** as a deduction (Chinese 应该 *yīnggāi* = should / probably). It is possible English ("I expect so"), but it is not *must*. Accept it and offer *must* for "I'm sure."
- ◆ **can / can't** in sound: Vietnamese, Cantonese and Spanish speakers often drop the final **t**, so *can't* sounds like *can*. Stress and a longer vowel save the meaning: "I **CAN'T** /kæ:nt/."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_11.html. Listen to the model sentences with  and say them; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 4.2: finish "My 3 deductions" (look around your room: one *must*, one *might*, one *can't*, each with the clue), "My new words" and the journal. Think of a short story for C12 (true, changed, or invented).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A *must* · Q2 A You don't have to pay. · Q3 (new) B *can't*. Where's Sam? (Ex 1, Script 4.2-A): stuck in traffic → *can't* (he rides a bike) · still asleep → *might* (his alarm didn't ring?) · sick → *may* / *might* (he looked pale) · on

his way → must (his coat isn't on his chair). "Whose bag?": it must be **Mei's**. Slide 8 close-ups: 1 a key · 2 an umbrella · 3 an egg · 4 a remote.

A TASK-BASED REVIEW, NOT A NEW-GRAMMAR CLASS

There is no new grammar today. The only new language is **functional**: phrases to give, support, agree and disagree. The class is built around two real tasks: a **mini debate** in groups of four and a **short story** (true or invented) told to a small group. Learners plan, rehearse, then perform while you listen with the **speaking checklist** (Set K). Language work comes *from* the tasks: short focus-on-form moments when you hear a gap, not presentations. The checklist results feed C13 (Progress Test 1): they are your spoken evidence for Modules 1–4, and they tell you who goes to which catch-up station.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ give an opinion with a range of openers (*In my opinion...* · *If you ask me...* · *As far as I'm concerned...*) and support it with a reason and an example
- ◆ agree (*That's a good point.* · *I couldn't agree more.* · *So do I.* / *Neither do I.*) and disagree politely by acknowledging first (*I see what you mean, but...*)
- ◆ take part in a 10-minute group mini debate, with a chair who manages turns
- ◆ tell a connected 2–3 minute story, true or invented, using at least four structures from Modules 1–4

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.3 (opinion phrases, Exercises 1–5, the debate planner, the **story frame**, the Module 4 "I can" checklist)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · **Review Race** board game (Set L) + dice + counters · **Mini-debate** topic cards, opinion cards, chair cards, talking tokens (Set I) · **Story cards** (Set J) · **Speaking checklist**: one class grid + score slips (Set K)
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.3-A (the discussion) and 4.3-B (the model story: The bag on the train) · optional: phones for recording

BOARD PLAN

Left: an opinion = CLAIM + REASON + EXAMPLE. Openers: *In my opinion...* · *If you ask me...* · *As far as I'm concerned...* · *It seems to me that...* Support: *The main reason is...* · *For example...* · *On the one hand...* · *on the other hand...*

Center: 👍 *That's a good point.* · *I couldn't agree more.* · *So do I.* / *Neither do I.* 🙏 *I see what you mean, but...* · *That may be true, but...* · *I'm not sure I agree.* Rule: **acknowledge → then disagree.**

Right: the story road: ① **THEN** (used to / was) → ② **WHAT HAPPENED** (past simple + a relative clause)
 → ③ **WHAT PEOPLE SAID** (reported speech) → ④ **A GUESS / A FACT** (must / might / can't · the passive)
 → ⑤ **NOW & IF** (present perfect · second conditional / wish)

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Review Race	10	S-S (groups of 3-4)	Review C1-C11 with the Review Race board game (Set L). Roll, move, answer the square in a full sentence. The group says "Good!" or helps. Stop after 10 minutes; the player nearest the finish wins. Walk around and note which squares (which modules) are hard: this is early evidence for C13.
Opinion language	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 14-15. Elicit ways to say "I think." Present the openers, the support phrases, and agree / disagree. CCQs. Drill with intonation (see notes). Then quick pairs: T says a statement ("Summer is the best season."); A gives an opinion + reason; B agrees or disagrees politely. Swap. Workbook Ex 1 and 4 (<i>So do I / Neither do I</i>) fast.
Model discussion: listen	8	T-S	Read Script 4.3-A twice (be both voices, or ask a confident learner to read B). First listen: "Does A think social media is good or bad? Does B agree?" Second listen: Workbook Ex 2, learners tick the phrases they hear. Ask: "How did B disagree? Was it rude?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Mini-debate prep	7	S (then S-S)	Slide 16. Groups of 4. Each group takes one topic card (Set I). Each learner takes an opinion card (strongly agree / agree a little / disagree a little / strongly disagree), so nobody has to give their real opinion. One learner is the chair (they also speak). Everyone fills the debate planner in the workbook: opinion + 2 reasons + 1 example + 1 "If..." sentence. Notes only.
Mini debate + checklist	15	S-S (groups) • T-S	Round 1 (fixed order): each speaker gives their opinion for 1 minute. Round 2 (open, 5–6 min): the chair invites responses; everyone uses talking tokens. Round 3 (1 min): the chair sums up: "Most of us think..." Then groups swap topics and chairs if time allows. You sit with one group at a time and score criteria 1, 4 and 5 of the speaking checklist .
Model story: listen	6	T-S	Read Script 4.3-B (The bag on the train) twice. First listen: "What happened? How did it end?" Second listen: Workbook Ex 3, learners write one example of each structure they hear (used to, a relative clause, reported speech, a deduction, a passive, present perfect, second conditional or wish).
Plan the story	8	S	Slide 17. Learners fill the story frame (Workbook 4.3): notes, not full sentences . A true story, a changed story, or a story card (Set J). Walk around and help; check that each step has one target structure. Quick pair rehearsal if time: tell it once to a partner, fast.
Story circles + checklist	14	S-S (groups of 3-4) • T-S	New groups of 3–4. Each learner tells the story (2–3 min) with notes turned over (a quick look is OK). Each listener asks one question and makes one comment with an opinion phrase ("If you ask me, you did the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			right thing!"). You sit with one group at a time and score criteria 1, 2 and 3 (and finish 4–5 for learners you didn't hear in the debate).
Feedback + module wrap	5	T–S	Content first: "Which story had the best ending? Did anyone change their mind in the debate?" Then 3–4 sentences from your checklist notes, no names. Learners tick the Module 4 "I can..." lists. Celebrate: halfway through B1.
Homework set-up	5	T–S	Online lesson 4.3; the opinion paragraph and story in the journal. Tell learners plainly about C13: "Next class is a friendly check of Modules 1–4. It helps me help you." Hand out score slips in C13, not today.
Total	90		10 + 12 + 8 + 7 + 15 + 6 + 8 + 14 + 5 + 5

HEARING EVERYONE

In 29 minutes of tasks you can score about 8–10 learners well. Choose one of these for the rest, and tell the class which one before the debate: **(a)** learners record their story on a phone during the story circles and play it for you in the C13 catch-up time; **(b)** the rest tell their story to you in the C13 catch-up stations; **(c)** in a large class, score the debate in C12 and the stories in C13. Anyone who prefers to tell the story only to you (not a group) may do so. That is a normal choice, not a problem.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW FOCUS)

Meaning: an opinion is a claim plus support.

SAY: "In my opinion, cities are better for young people." Is this a fact or an opinion? (An opinion.) Is it enough? (No, we need a reason.) • "The main reason is that there are more jobs." What does this add? (The reason.) • "For example, my cousin found work in a month." And this? (An example.)

SAY: "I see what you mean, but I think exams are useful." Does the speaker agree? (No.) Is it polite? (Yes.) Why? (They show they listened first.) • "You're wrong." Polite? (No, it sounds rude in English.)

SAY: "I don't like crowds." — "Neither do I." Does the second person like crowds? (No.) • "I've been there." — "So have I." Why have, not do? (We copy the helper verb.)

Meaning: each structure has a job in the story. Show the story road on slide 17.

SAY: "I used to take the train every day." Do I still take it? (No, or not always.) Which step? (① Then.) · "She told me that she was on her way to an interview." What did she say? ("I'm on my way to an interview.") Which step? (③.) · "If I found a bag again, I'd do the same." Did I find a bag again? (No, it's imaginary.) Which conditional? (The second.)

Form: the review table.

Opinion	In my opinion, ... · If you ask me, ... · As far as I'm concerned, ... · It seems to me that ... · Personally, I'd say ...	If you ask me, public transportation should be free.
Support	The main reason is (that) ... · For example, ... · On the one hand ... on the other hand ... · What's more, ...	The main reason is that it's cheaper for everyone.
Agree	That's a good point. · Exactly! · I couldn't agree more. · So do I. / Neither do I. / So have I.	"I love cooking." — "So do I."
Disagree	I see what you mean, but ... · That may be true, but ... · I'm not sure I agree. · I'd look at it differently.	That may be true, but it costs a lot of money.
Module 1	present perfect (simple / continuous) · past simple · <i>used to / would</i>	I've always wanted to... · I've been learning... · I used to...
Module 2	first and second conditional · <i>wish</i>	If we banned cars, the air would be cleaner. · I wish I had more time.
Module 3	reported speech · relative clauses	She told me that she was late. · the friend who helped me, which surprised everyone
Module 4	the passive · modals of deduction · obligation / advice	It is often said that... · That can't be true. · You should...

Pronunciation. Opinion openers are said as one chunk, with a small pause after: "If you ask me | ...", "As far as I'm conCERNED | ...". Polite disagreement has a friendly rise on the first part and a fall on the new idea: "I SEE what you mean ↗ | but I think it's too exPENSive ↘." A flat, low "No." sounds rude even with polite words: model the warm version. *So do I / Neither do I*: stress the last word, I. *Neither* is /niðər/ or /naɪðər/; both are correct.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Opener chain:** T: "public transportation / free" → S1: "In my opinion, public transportation should be free." → S2 (new opener, same idea): "If you ask me, ..." → S3: "As far as I'm concerned, ..." Round the room; no one repeats the previous opener.
- 2 **Add the support:** T: "Cooking should be taught at school." → S: "...The main reason is that... For example, ..."
- 3 **Acknowledge, then disagree:** T gives an opinion; learners answer only with the polite frame: "I see what you mean, but..." / "That may be true, but..." Say the rise-fall together.
- 4 **So / Neither:** T: "I love coffee." → "So do I." "I can't swim." → "Neither can I." "I've been to Canada." → "So have I." "I didn't sleep well." → "Neither did I."
- 5 **Story upgrade:** T says a plain sentence; learners upgrade it with one B1 structure: "I took the train." → "I used to take the train every day." "A woman left her bag." → "A woman who was sitting across from me left her bag."

◆ THE MINI DEBATE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Opinion cards make it safe.** Deal the four cards face down. Learners argue the card's view, not their own. Say: "Good debaters can argue any side." Learners may swap cards within the group if a topic feels personal.
- ◆ **The chair** keeps time (a phone timer), opens ("Today's question is... Let's start with you, Omar."), invites quiet speakers ("What do you think, Ana?"), stops long turns kindly ("Thanks, let's hear from someone else"), and sums up at the end. Give the chair card to a dominant speaker: the job needs listening.
- ◆ **Talking tokens** in round 2: 3 each; put one in the middle every time you speak. No tokens left? Listen until everyone has used theirs, then everyone gets 3 more.
- ◆ Every turn in round 2 starts with a response to the last speaker: agree or acknowledge first, then add a point. This keeps it a discussion, not four speeches.
- ◆ Topics avoid politics, religion and immigration. If a group gets heated, the chair (or you) says: "Great ideas. Let's hear one reason from each side and sum up."

◆ THE SPEAKING CHECKLIST – HOW TO SCORE IT (FEEDS C13)

Five criteria, 0–3 points each, /15: 0 = no response · 1 = not yet B1 · 2 = B1 · 3 = strong B1. Score the **whole performance** across the debate and the story. Tick the **module boxes** (M1–M4) when you hear a structure used correctly. The full grid and descriptors are in the classroom materials (Set K).

Criterion	What 3 points sounds like
1 · Task	Debate: a clear opinion with 2 reasons and an example. Story: connected, with a beginning, a middle and an end; the listener can follow it.

2 • Range (Modules 1–4)	Uses structures from at least 3 of the 4 modules (e.g. <i>used to</i> , a second conditional, reported speech, a passive or a deduction), without being prompted.
3 • Accuracy	Errors are few and don't block meaning; tenses are controlled (past simple for the events, present perfect for life experience).
4 • Interaction & opinion language	Varied openers; acknowledges before disagreeing; responds to the last speaker; asks or invites others.
5 • Fluency & pronunciation	Keeps going with natural pauses; chunks and stress make it easy to follow; little translating in the head.

Feeding C13. Record each learner's scores and module ticks on the class grid. In C13, send learners to a **catch-up station** for any module with no tick and to the station for their lowest criterion: **no M1 tick** → tenses station (present perfect vs past simple, *used to*); **no M2 tick** → conditionals and *wish* station; **no M3 tick** → reported speech and relative clauses station; **no M4 tick** → passive and modals station (Sets B, E, F); **criterion 4 ≤ 1** → opinion language (Workbook 4.3 Ex 1, 4, 5). If Progress Test 1 has its own speaking task, keep this grid anyway: it is your evidence of extended speaking for Modules 1–4, and it lets you give each learner one kind, specific next step.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MINI DEBATE AND THE STORY CIRCLES

SAY: *Debate: Do you have to give your real opinion? (No, you use your opinion card.) • What does the chair do? (Keeps time, invites everyone, sums up.) • What do you do with a token? (Put one down every time you speak.) • Before you disagree, what do you say? ("I see what you mean, but...")*

SAY: *Stories: Does it have to be true? (No: true, changed, or invented.) • Can you read your notes? (Only a quick look.) • What do the listeners do? (Ask one question and give one opinion.) • Do you have to tell it to the group? (No, you can tell it only to the teacher.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **phrase strip** with 3 lines: "In my opinion, ... because ..." · "I agree. / I see what you mean, but..." · "For example, ...". In the debate, the learner speaks third in round 1 (after hearing two models) and uses the strip. For the story, use the **picture version** of the frame: draw a small picture in each step. Target: a 5–6 sentence story with *used to*, the past simple, one "She said..." and one "It must be...". Score on the same checklist: a clear, short story can earn full marks on criteria 1, 3 and 5.

STRETCH

Be the chair and sum up both sides fairly. Use *On the one hand... on the other hand...* and a "hedge" (*It seems to me that...*). In the story, use all five steps plus a passive (*I was given...*) and a *wish*. Tell the story in 2 minutes with no notes. Listeners ask two follow-up questions, not one. Write the story (8–10 sentences) for homework and underline one structure from each module.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I am agree" / "Are you agree?"**: Spanish *estoy de acuerdo*, French *je suis d'accord*, Portuguese *estou de acordo*, Italian *sono d'accordo*. Very common. Drill "I **agree**. · Do you agree?"
- ◆ **"According to me..."** (French *selon moi*, Spanish *según yo*, and common in Indian English): *according to* is for other people ("according to the news"). Offer "In my opinion..."
- ◆ **"I think no" / "I think not"** (Spanish *creo que no*, Portuguese *acho que não*): "I don't think so."
- ◆ **"In my opinion, I think..."** (double opener, many L1s). Accept in speech; point out in writing.
- ◆ **"We discussed about..."** (Spanish *discutir sobre*, Arabic): *discuss* has no preposition. Also note *discutir* can mean *argue*.
- ◆ **Directness differs**. Dutch, German, Russian and Hebrew speakers may disagree very directly ("No, that's wrong."); Japanese, Korean, Chinese and Filipino speakers may avoid disagreeing at all. Teach the English middle: acknowledge, then disagree. Both styles are normal; English just has its own.
- ◆ **Tense drift in stories** (Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai have no past endings): prompt with the step: "① Then: used to or use to?" Past perfect ("I had never done that") may appear; accept it, it's coming in 5.1.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_12.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Record the two-part review project on your phone if you like (a story + an opinion). Workbook 4.3: write the opinion paragraph (5–6 sentences) and your story (6–8 sentences) in the journal, and underline one structure from each module. Review the Module 1–4 "I can..." lists before C13.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I see what you mean, but I think they do measure some skills. · Q2 **B** If we banned cars, the air would be cleaner. · Q3 (new) **B** Neither do I. Discussion (Ex 2, Script 4.3-A): heard: If you ask me · the main reason is · for example · I'm not sure I agree · I see what you mean, but · on the other hand · That's a good point · Exactly · It seems to me that · I take your point. Not heard: In my opinion · I couldn't agree more.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C12: MODULE 4 WRAP-UP AND THE HALFWAY POINT

Recap on slide 18: **It is made in...** / **It was built in...** · **It must be...** / **It might be...** / **It can't be...** · **You have to...** / **You don't have to...** / **You should...** · **In my opinion...** / **I see what you mean, but...** Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Use those notes, the Review Race observations and your speaking checklist to plan the C13 catch-up stations.

Celebrate the halfway point. Learners have finished half of B1. Ask each person to say one thing they can do now that they couldn't do in Week 1, with an opinion phrase if they like ("If you ask me, my stories are much better now!"). Keep it short and warm.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it can test: present and past simple passive (+ / – / ?), when to use *by* + agent, active → passive, *made of / from / in / by*, *must / might / may / could / can't* for present deduction, *can't* vs *mustn't*, *have to / don't have to / mustn't / should*, and opinion, agreeing and disagreeing phrases. The C12 speaking checklist gives you the spoken evidence.

Watch for in Module 5: the past perfect (5.1) brings *had* + past participle, the same participle as the passive. Learners may mix them ("The bridge had built in 1932"). Narrative tenses (5.2) reuse today's story road, so keep the story frames. Keep a 2-minute deduction warmer ("It must be... / It can't be...") in C14–C16: it is quick and learners enjoy it.

Module 5 — Narrating Past & Future

Three classes that turn learners into storytellers and planners. First the **past perfect** lets them rewind to "the past before the past" (*When I got to the station, the train had already left*). Then the three **narrative tenses** work as one team to tell a real story with a scene, a problem and an ending. Last, learners sort out **will / going to / the present continuous** and add the **future continuous** and **time clauses** (*This time tomorrow I'll be flying. I'll call you when I land.*). The module starts right after Progress Test 1, so C14 opens by handing the tests back in a warm, low-stress way.

3 lessons

Lessons 5.1-5.3

Classes C14-C16

Weeks 7-8

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, discussion) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-5-narrating.html](#). Print [materials/module-5/classroom-materials.html](#) before C14. It holds the flashcards, the story & future identity cards, the listening scripts, the **What Had Happened?** picture-clue game, the **Worst Day Ever** story-chain kit and the **Life in 2040** discussion cards.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** Learners met the past continuous + past simple ("I was cooking when the phone rang") and *going to / will / might / present continuous* for arrangements at A2. Only the **past perfect**, the **future continuous** and **time clauses** are really new. Check what they know in each lead-in and move fast where they are strong. Spend the saved time on speaking.
- Fluency first, accuracy after.** In the freer stages, don't stop a story to fix a tense. Listen, write down 4–6 sentences you hear (good ones too), and correct them together at the end, with no names. During the controlled stages, correct on the spot and briefly.
- American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use some British forms (*film, cinema, holiday, lift* = a free ride, *cancelled, labelled, organised, practise, round the table*). Teach *movie, movie theater,*

vacation, ride, canceled, labeled, organized, practice, around the table. Accept the British forms when learners use them.

- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Rewind → tell → fast-forward. In C14 learners learn to *rewind*: to explain what had already happened before a past moment (the cause behind a surprise). In C15 they put the whole camera together: background (*was raining*), main events (*the bus stopped*) and flashback (*I'd forgotten my umbrella*), with connectors, to *tell* a real story. In C16 they *fast-forward*: they choose the best future form, picture themselves in the middle of a future moment (*This time next week I'll be...*), and discuss how life might look in 2040. Every class ends with a longer speaking turn than the class before: a 6-sentence story → a 2-minute group story → a 15-minute discussion.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: STORIES AND FUTURES ARE PERSONAL

Past stories. "Tell me about your worst day" can open painful memories (war, migration, loss, accidents, illness). This module keeps stories **light and fictional by default**: the picture-clue game and the story chain use invented characters. When learners tell their own story, the choice is always theirs: a **small, light real story** (a missed bus, lost keys, a cooking disaster, a funny mistake), a **story identity card**, or an **invented story**. Say the "light" rule out loud: "Choose a small problem with a happy or funny ending." Never ask a follow-up about *why* someone chose a card.

Futures. For some adults the future is uncertain: a visa or asylum decision, a job search, family far away. **Never ask** "Where will you be living next year?", "Will you stay here?" or "When will you see your family?" In C16 the main discussion is about **society** (transport, work, shopping, schools in 2040). The personal part is optional and short: **this time next week** (safe and small), a **future identity card**, or an **imagined person in 2040**. Anyone can say "Pass." Offer these choices every time, so choosing a card is normal and not a sign that something is wrong.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Mark Progress Test 1** before C14. Write a short, positive comment on every paper: one thing they did well + one thing to practice. Collect **4–5 common errors** from different papers for the C14 board (no names). Note which learners scored below about 60% so you can offer a quiet 1:1 chat at the break.
- ◆ Print the **picture flashcards** (one set for the board). Card stock helps.
- ◆ For C14: one **What Had Happened?** picture-clue deck per group of 3–4 (16 cards). Fold or cover the answer strip at the bottom of each card before class, or cut it off and keep the answers yourself.
- ◆ For C15: one **Worst Day Ever** kit per group of 4: the story map (A4), 1 starter card, 12 event cards, 1 reaction strip. Cut the cards.

- ◆ For C16: one set of **Life in 2040** topic cards and one set of **role cards** per group of 4, plus 3 talking chips per learner (paper clips, coins or the printed chips).
- ◆ Print the **story & future identity cards** (6 people). Keep them on a side table for all three classes: anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional: a timer on screen (phone or free online timer) for the story retells in C15 and the discussion in C16.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
5.1	C14 · wk 7	Progress Test 1 return · past perfect: <i>had</i> / 'd / <i>hadn't</i> + past participle, <i>Had you...?</i> ; earlier vs later action; <i>before, after, by the time, already, just, never ... before; because ... had ...</i>	explain what had happened before a past moment, and tell a 6-sentence "when I arrived..." story (real, light, or invented)
5.2	C15 · wk 8	Narrative tenses: past simple (main events) + past continuous (background, <i>while</i>) + past perfect (flashback); connectors <i>first, then, after that, while, suddenly, by the time, a few minutes later, in the end</i> ; story shape; listener reactions	tell a 1–2 minute story with a scene, a problem and an ending, using all three tenses and 4+ connectors, and react as a good listener
5.3	C16 · wk 8	Which future: <i>will</i> / <i>going to</i> / <i>present continuous</i> ; future continuous <i>will be</i> + <i>-ing</i> (in progress at a future time; polite questions); time clauses <i>when, as soon as, before, after, until</i> + present simple	choose the best future form, say what they'll be doing at a future moment, and discuss life in 2040 with reasons, using 3+ future forms

5.1 · C14

Past Perfect — The Earlier Past

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ reflect on their Progress Test 1 results and set one personal goal
- ◆ form the past perfect for every person: *had* / 'd + past participle, *hadn't*, *Had you...?* and short answers *Yes, I had.* / *No, I hadn't.*
- ◆ put the **earlier** of two past actions in the past perfect and the **later** one in the past simple: *When I arrived, the train had already left.*
- ◆ use *before*, *after*, *by the time*, *already*, *just*, *never ... before*, with *already* / *just* / *never* between *had* and the participle
- ◆ explain a cause with *because ... had ...* and know when two past simples are enough (a plain sequence)
- ◆ tell a 6-sentence "when I arrived, ... had already ..." story (light real, a story identity card, or invented)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Marked Progress Test 1 papers (in folders or face-down) · sticky notes · Workbook "My goal after Progress Test 1" box
- ◆ Workbook 5.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My story" plan)
- ◆ Slides 2–8 · Picture flashcards (5.1 "what had happened" events) · **What Had Happened?** picture-clue decks (1 per group of 3–4) · Story identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.1-A (Why was Sam late?) and 5.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left (C14 only): "We can..." + three class strengths from the test (e.g. *talk about experiences* · *imagine with "if"* · *report what people said*).

Center: a time line with three points: ① **the train left** (had left) → ② **I arrived** (arrived) → ③ **NOW**.
Under it: When I **arrived**, the train **had already left**. = The train **had already left** when I **arrived**.

Right: **had** ('d) + past participle (all persons) · **hadn't** + pp · **Had you** + pp...? → Yes, I **had**. / No, I **hadn't**.
Signal words: **by the time** · **before** · **after** · **because** · **had already** / **just** / **never** + pp.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & Progress Test 1	12	T-S · S-S · S	Slide 2. See "Returning Progress Test 1" below: strengths on the board, papers back privately,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
return			pairs fix 4 anonymous errors, each learner writes one goal in the workbook box.
Lead-in: what had happened?	6	T-S	Slide 3 (station picture). Tell it with feeling: "Last week I ran to the station. I got to the platform at 8:05... and the platform was empty." Elicit guesses: "The train left!" Accept, then ask: "Which happened first: the train leaving, or me arriving?" Draw the time line (board center). Say the model: "When I arrived, the train had already left ." Don't explain yet: get 3-4 learners to repeat it.
Grammar: past perfect	15	T-S	Slides 4-6. Meaning (the earlier past; order, not calendar time), form (<i>had</i> + participle, same for everyone; 'd; <i>hadn't</i> ; <i>Had...?</i>), signal words and their position. CCQs and drill (see notes). Quick participle check: T says "go, see, eat, write, take, lose, forget, leave"; learners say the participle (the same list as the present perfect in Module 1).
Listening: Why was Sam late?	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.1-A twice. First listen: "Was Sam late? Was his manager angry?" Second listen: learners number the six events in the order they happened (not the order Sam says them). Pairs compare, then say two sentences: "When he got to the bus stop, the bus had already left."
Pronunciation: 'd & hadn't	5	T-S	"I'd finished" vs "I finished": say pairs; learners show 1 finger (past simple) or 2 fingers (past perfect). Then Script 5.1-B dictation (4 sentences, each read 3 times). Learners check against the slide.
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-5 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on (usually Ex 3 item 4 and Ex 5, "Do we need the past perfect?"). Early finishers start the "My story" plan.
Freer: What Had Happened?	20	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slides 7-8. Groups of 3-4 with one picture-clue deck. (1) Demo one card with the class (3 min).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
game			(2) Play: the reader shows the scene and clues; the others ask Had...? questions and make guesses until someone finds the reason (12 min). (3) Each group chooses its funniest <i>wrong</i> guess and tells the class (3 min). (4) Early finishers: "My story" plan in the workbook. ICQs first.
Feedback	7	T-S	Delayed error correction: write 5 sentences you heard (2 good, 3 with errors, no names), e.g. "When I arrived, the train already left." · "She had forget her keys." · "Had you did it?" Pairs fix them. Praise one good question and one creative guess.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 5.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		12 + 6 + 15 + 8 + 5 + 12 + 20 + 7 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The test return must stay at 12 minutes. Cut the dictation (Script 5.1-B) and set Ex 5 as homework. If the game is short on time, stop after 10 minutes of play and skip the "funniest wrong guess" round. Never cut the game: it is where *Had...?* questions and 'd + participle become real.

RETURNING PROGRESS TEST 1 (12 MIN) — KEEP IT WARM

1. Celebrate first (3 min). Before any paper comes out, write "**We can...**" on the board and list three things the whole class did well (for example: *talk about experiences with the present perfect* · *imagine with "If I had..., I would..."* · *report what people said*). Say it out loud.

SAY: *Four modules of B1! You can talk about your experiences, imagine, report what people said, and use the passive. That's a lot of English. Give yourselves a hand.*

2. Return privately (2 min). Hand papers back face-down or in folders. **Never read scores aloud** and never compare learners. Everyone gets a written comment: one strength + one thing to practice.

3. "Let's fix it!" (5 min). Show 4 anonymous errors from the tests. Use your own learners' errors if you can; typical ones at this point: *I have seen that movie last week.* · *If I will see her, I'll tell her.* · *She said me that she was tired.* · *The bridge was build in 1990.* (Also common: *I wish I have more time.* · *The woman which lives next door...* · *He must to be at work.*) Pairs fix them. Take answers. Praise the fixing, not the mistake-free papers.

4. One goal (2 min). Each learner writes one goal in the workbook box ("My goal after Progress Test 1") or on a sticky note: *"I want to practice _____. Every week I will _____."* Give two examples: "I want to practice reported speech. I will report one conversation a day in my journal." / "I want to speak more. I will tell a friend one story in English every weekend."

SAY: *A test is a map. It tells us where we are. It doesn't tell us who we are.*

Some adults carry hard memories of school and tests. Keep your voice light and move on quickly. Offer a **1:1 chat at the break** to anyone who struggled (below about 60%), and plan catch-up with the Module 1–4 online lessons. Don't let the test return grow past 12 minutes. The best encouragement is a good, successful lesson straight after it, and today's grammar is kind: learners already know the past participles from the present perfect (Lesson 1.1).

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the past before the past. Two past actions; the past perfect marks the one that happened *first*. It is about **order**, not about "a long time ago."

SAY: *"When I arrived, the train had already left." Two actions: what are they? (I arrived; the train left.) Which happened first? (The train left.) Did I see the train? (No.) Which verb is in the past perfect? (had left: the earlier one.)*

SAY: *"When I arrived, the train left." Did I see the train? (Yes, it was leaving as I arrived.) So is it the same meaning? (No!)*

SAY: *"I was hungry because I hadn't eaten all day." Which came first: not eating, or being hungry? (Not eating.) Is "hadn't eaten" the cause or the result? (The cause.)*

Meaning: when you don't need it. A plain sequence in order: *I got home, cooked dinner and watched TV.* The order is already clear, so use past simples. Save the past perfect for when you jump *back*.

SAY: "I got up, had breakfast and left." Do I need "had had breakfast"? (No. The order is clear: one, two, three.) · "After I'd finished, I rested." Is "after I finished" also OK? (Yes. "After" already shows the order.)

Contrast with the present perfect (stretch, 1 minute): *I've eaten, so I'm not hungry now.* / *I'd eaten, so I wasn't hungry then.*

Form.

Positive	subject + had ('d) + past participle	She had gone. · They'd left. · I'd finished my work.
Negative	subject + hadn't + past participle	We hadn't met before that day.
Question	Had + subject + past participle...?	Had you seen the email? — Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
Wh-question	Wh- + had + subject + pp...?	Why had he already gone? · What had they done?
Position	had + already / just / never + pp	The bus had already gone. · I had just sat down. · I'd never flown before.
Signal words	by the time · before · after · because · when	By the time we arrived, it had closed.

Pronunciation. In speech *had* is almost always 'd, and it is very small: *I'd* /aɪd/, *she'd* /ʃɪd/, *they'd* /ðeɪd/, *it'd* /ɪtəd/. Learners must learn to *hear* it: "I'd finished" and "I finished" sound almost the same, so the participle and the context carry the meaning. Stress falls on the participle and the time word: "the train had **alREAdy LEFT**." *hadn't* /'hædənt/ is stressed and clear (two syllables). In short answers use the full, stressed form: "Yes, I **HAD**." (never "Yes, I'd.") Remind learners that 'd + participle = *had*; 'd + base verb = *would* (*I'd gone / I'd go*).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Back-chain:** "left" → "already left" → "the train had already left" → "When I arrived, the train had already left." Choral ×3, half the room, then 4–5 individuals. Then a personal version with 'd: "When I got there, I realized I'd forgotten my phone."
- 2 Two actions → one sentence** (T gives two past actions in the real order; learners join them): T: "The movie started. Then we arrived." → S: "When we arrived, the movie had started." T: "The shop closed. Then I got there." → S: "By the time I got there, the shop had closed."
- 3 'd substitution:** T: "I had forgotten my keys." → S: "I'd forgotten my keys." T: "She... lose her phone" → S: "She'd lost her phone." T: "They... never see snow" → S: "They'd never seen snow."

- 4 **Question and short answer**, open pairs: S1: "Had you eaten when you came to class?" S2: "Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't." S2 → S3: "Had you used English at work before this course?" S3 answers... (Keep questions small and everyday.)
- 5 **Because chain**: T: "Omar was tired." → S1: "...because he hadn't slept well." → T: "Ana was happy." → S2: "...because she'd passed her test."

◆ WHAT HAD HAPPENED? – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3–4, one deck face down. Player 1 is the **reader**: takes a card, reads the scene aloud ("When Ana got to the platform, she was very upset.") and shows the picture clues. The answer strip is hidden (folded under).
- ◆ The others are **detectives**. They ask yes/no questions with **Had...?** ("Had the train left?" "Had she lost her ticket?") and the reader answers "Yes, she had." / "No, she hadn't." They can also guess with a statement: "I think she'd missed the train."
- ◆ The first detective to find the answer on the strip keeps the card. After **8 questions** with no answer, the reader reads the strip aloud ("The train had already left.") and keeps the card. Then the next player is the reader. The most cards wins.
- ◆ Stretch rule: before a detective can guess, they must say the earlier and the later action ("First the train left, then she arrived").
- ◆ Round 2 (if time): groups use the two blank cards to invent a scene for another group.
- ◆ Walk around and listen. Note sentences for feedback; don't stop the game to correct.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GAME

SAY: *Can the detectives see the answer? (No!) · What's the first word of your question? ("Had.") · "Had she lost her ticket?" What does the reader say? ("Yes, she had." or "No, she hadn't.") · How many questions before the reader tells the answer? (Eight.) · Who keeps the card? (The person who finds the answer.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with a small bank of 8 participles (*left, gone, lost, forgotten, eaten, closed, started, finished*) on a strip, and the frame "When she arrived, ___ had ___." In the game, the teacher or a partner reads the scene aloud; the learner uses the picture clues and one question frame: "Had he/she ___?" Target: 4 spoken past perfect sentences and 3 questions. In Ex 1, number only 4 events (the first four).

STRETCH

Use all six signal words in the "My story" plan. Add a *because ... had ...* cause and a *never ... before* first-time experience. Contrast the present perfect ("I've lost my keys" = now I can't get in) with the past perfect ("I'd lost my keys" = back then). In the game, give the reason in two ways: "When she arrived, the train had left." / "The train had left by the time she arrived."

◆ HANDLING DOMINANT SPEAKERS (ALL MODULE)

In group games one confident learner often answers every card. Use turn rules, not personality: the reader changes every card; each detective may ask only **one question per turn** (clockwise); the person who just won a card asks **last** next time. Say it as a game rule for everyone, so no one feels singled out. If one learner still leads, give them a job: "You're the judge. Check that every question starts with *Had*." Quiet learners can read the card aloud first, which gives them a safe, prepared turn.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "When I arrived, the train already left." (past simple + *already*): Chinese (已经), Vietnamese (*đã*), Thai, Indonesian, Tagalog and Russian (*uzhe*) show order with a time word, not a tense. It is understood. Recast and point at the time line: "Which came first? → **had** left."
- ◆ "She **had** forget / **had** went": Arabic, Spanish and many others. Same participle list as the present perfect: go → **gone**, forget → **forgotten**, leave → **left**.
- ◆ "Had you did it?" / "Did you **had** seen...?": learners who have just drilled *did* questions. "One helper only: **had**."
- ◆ **Overusing the past perfect for any "long ago" past**: "I had been born in 1985." "When I was a child, I had lived in a village." Spanish, Portuguese, French and Italian speakers sometimes use their pluperfect this way. Ask "Earlier than what?" If there is no later past moment, use the past simple.
- ◆ **Not hearing 'd**: Vietnamese, Chinese and Korean speakers (final consonants) may drop the /d/ in *I'd* and the /t/ in *hadn't*. Use the 1-finger / 2-finger listening game and the dictation.
- ◆ **'d = had or would?** Learners from any L1 mix these in reading. Teach the test: look at the next verb (participle → **had**; base verb → **would**).

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_13.html. Listen to the model sentences and the airport conversation with  and say them out loud. Do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook

5.1: finish "My story" (6 past perfect sentences: light real, a story identity card, or invented), "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** had cooked · Q2 **C** The bus had already left when we arrived. · Q3 (new) **B** had never flown. Sam (Ex 1): 1 forgot to charge his phone · 2 woke up at 7:30 · 3 left his ID card at home · 4 got to the bus stop · 5 waited twenty minutes · 6 arrived at the office.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use the **past simple** for the main events, the **past continuous** for the background and actions in progress, and the **past perfect** for a flashback to something earlier
- ◆ combine a long background action and a short event with *while* (+ past continuous) and *when* (+ past simple): *While I was walking home, it started to rain.*
- ◆ order a story with connectors: *first, then, after that, while, suddenly, a few minutes later, by the time, in the end*
- ◆ build a story in five steps: **scene** → **flashback** → **problem** → **what happened next** → **ending**
- ◆ react as a listener: *No way! · Oh no! · Then what happened? · How did it end?*
- ◆ tell a 1–2 minute story (fictional, a story identity card, or a light real one)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My story map")
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Flashcards (5.2 mishaps + connector cards) · **Worst Day Ever** story-chain kit (1 per group of 4) · Story identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.2-A (Dev's worst day) and 5.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: 📹 the camera: **BACKGROUND** = was / were + -ing (*it was raining*) · **ACTION** = past simple (*the bus stopped*) · **FLASHBACK** = had + pp (*I'd forgotten my umbrella*).

Center: the story map: ① SCENE → ② FLASHBACK → ③ SUDDENLY... → ④ THEN / WHILE... → ⑤ BY THE TIME... → ⑥ IN THE END...

Right: **while** + was -ing (long) · **when** + past simple (short) · Listener: *No way! · Oh no! · Then what happened? · How did it end?*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: why?	8	T-S → S-S	Review C14. Quick-fire "why" prompts from the What Had Happened? deck ("Ana was upset at the station. Why?") → "Because the train had left." Then pairs read one sentence from their "My story"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			homework and the partner asks one <i>Had...?</i> question.
Lead-in: Dev's worst day	8	T-S → S-S	"You'll never believe what happened to my friend Dev." Read Script 5.2-A once for gist, like a real story (pause, use your face). Gist questions: "Was it a good day or a bad day? Did it end well?" Second listen: Workbook Ex 1 (six questions). Pairs compare.
Clarify: three tenses, one story	14	T-S	Slides 9–10. The camera: background / action / flashback. Take 3 sentences from Dev's story and put them on the board time line. <i>While</i> vs <i>when</i> . CCQs and drill (below). Then Workbook Ex 4 together, quickly: label S / C / P in the Maria story.
Connectors & story shape	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Stick the connector flashcards on the board in story order. Show the 6-step story map. Pairs retell Dev's story in 6 steps, one step each, using the map (2 min).
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (choose the tense), Ex 3 (connectors) and Ex 5 (order the events, then write the story) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only disagreements.
Listener reactions	5	T-S → S-S	Slide 12. Read the model dialogue in two halves of the room, then swap. Drill 6 reactions with feeling: "No WAY! " "Oh NO! " "Then what HAP pened?" Say: "A story needs a good listener too."
Freer: Worst Day Ever	22	S-S (groups) → S-S (new pairs)	Slide 13. (1) Groups of 4 build a story with a starter card, event

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
story chain			cards and the story map: one step each, round the table, twice (10 min). (2) Each learner retells the group's story to a partner from another group, 2 minutes; the partner reacts and asks one question (4 min). (3) Change partners; retell faster, in 90 seconds (3 min). (4) Option: learners who want to may tell a light real story or a story identity card story instead in step 3. Two volunteers tell the class (3 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	8	T-S	Delayed error correction: 5 sentences heard (2 good, 3 with errors), e.g. "Suddenly the phone was ringing." · "While I walked home, it started to rain." · "At the end, everything was fine." Pairs fix. Praise one great scene-setting sentence and one great reaction.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 5.2; workbook journal (a 4–6 sentence story from this week, verbs labeled S / C / P). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 8 + 14 + 8 + 12 + 5 + 22 + 8 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Set Ex 5 as homework, and do only one retell round (step 2) in the story chain. Never cut the retell: telling the *same* story again to a new listener is where fluency grows (the second telling is always smoother). Keep the listener reactions: they make the retell a real conversation.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the camera. The past simple is the **action shots** that move the story forward. The past continuous is the **wide background shot** (weather, place, what was going on). The past perfect is a quick **flashback**.

SAY: "It was raining when Dev left the house." Which started first: the rain, or Dev leaving? (The rain.) Did the rain stop when he left? (No, it continued.) Which is the background? (It was raining.)

SAY: "While Dev was drinking his coffee, the bus stopped." Which is long? (Drinking coffee.) Which is short and sudden? (The bus stopped.) Can I say "the bus was stopping" here? (Not for a sudden event: "stopped.")

SAY: "He'd left his umbrella at home." Did this happen in the middle of the story or before it? (Before.) Why does the listener need it? (To understand why he got wet.)

Balance. The past simple is the most common tense in a story. The past perfect appears only a few times, for the moments you step back. Tell learners: "Most of the story: past simple. A little background. One or two flashbacks."

Form.

Past simple	verb + -ed / irregular	main events, in order	She opened the door and walked in.
Past continuous	was / were + -ing	background · action in progress	It was raining and the wind was blowing.
Past perfect	had + past participle	what had happened earlier	She had left her umbrella at home.
while / when	while + was -ing · when + past simple	long action + short interruption	While we were eating, the lights went out. · I was walking home when I saw an old friend.
Connectors	first · then · after that · while · suddenly · a few minutes later · by the time (+ had) · in the end		

Pronunciation. Storytelling is performance. *was* and *were* are weak in the middle of a sentence: /wəz/, /wər/ ("it wəz RAINing"). Pause before *suddenly* and stress it: "...and **SUD**dently...". *In the end* falls to finish the story. Past simple **-ed**: remind learners of /t/ /d/ /ɪd/ (*walked, arrived, started*); it carries the whole story. Listener reactions need big intonation: "No **WAY!** ↗↘" A flat "no way" sounds bored.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Background + event** (T gives two prompts; learners join them with *when*): T: "I / walk home · it / start to rain" → S: "I was walking home when it started to rain." T: "we / have dinner · the lights / go out" → S: "We were having dinner when the lights went out."
- 2 Now with while:** same prompts → "While I was walking home, it started to rain." Choral, then individuals.
- 3 Add a flashback:** T: "I got wet." → S: "I got wet because I'd forgotten my umbrella." T: "She was nervous." → S: "She was nervous because she'd never given a speech before."

- 4 **Connector chain:** T holds up a connector card; the next learner adds a sentence to a class story: "First..." → "Then..." → "While..." → "Suddenly..." → "By the time..." → "In the end..."
- 5 **Reaction ping-pong:** T says a story line ("...and the bus broke down!"); learners react with the right phrase and intonation ("Oh no!" / "No way!" / "Then what happened?").

◆ WORST DAY EVER STORY CHAIN – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 4 with the story map (A4) in the middle, a **starter card** (a fictional character and a big day: a wedding photographer, a first day at a new job, an anniversary dinner...) and 12 **event cards** face down.
- ◆ Player 1 reads the starter card and says step ① (the scene) with the past continuous: "It was a hot Saturday morning, and the birds were singing." Player 2 takes an event card and uses it in step ② or ③, and so on round the table. The map shows which tense each step needs. Go round the table twice (steps 1–6, then a better second version).
- ◆ Anyone can change an event card for a new one. The story should end well or funny: "In the end, ... and everyone laughed."
- ◆ Retell: every learner can tell the group story alone, so everyone practices the whole thing. Partners from other groups listen, react ("No way!") and ask one question ("How did it end?").
- ◆ **Real stories are optional.** In the second retell, learners may tell their own **light** story (a small problem with a happy or funny ending) or a story identity card story. Never ask anyone to tell a real "worst day."
- ◆ **Third and mixed conditionals.** Stories invite "If I had left earlier, I would have...". This is B2. Accept it if a learner says it, and don't teach it. Offer the B1 way: "I should leave earlier next time!" or "Next time I'll check the time."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE STORY CHAIN

SAY: *Is this a true story or an invented story? (Invented.) · Step 1: which tense? (was / were + -ing: the background.) · Step 5 starts with...? ("By the time" + had.) · How many times do you go round the table? (Twice.) · Must the story end badly? (No, happy or funny.) · When your partner tells a story, what do you do? (React and ask one question.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use the story map with picture icons only (👥 scene, ⏮️ flashback, ⚡ suddenly, ➡️ then, ⌚ by the time, 🏁 in the end) and a sentence strip for each step ("It was ___ and ___ was ___-ing." / "Suddenly, ___." / "In the end, ___."). In the chain, the learner takes steps 1, 3 or 6 (the easiest frames). Target: tell 3 steps of the story with 3 connectors. In Ex 1, answer questions 1, 3 and 6 only.

STRETCH

Add a second flashback with *just or never ... before*. Use *a few minutes later* and *it turned out that...* In the retell, change the point of view (tell it as a different character) or add direct speech ("She said, 'Don't worry!'"). Early finishers write the group story (8–10 sentences) and label every verb S / C / P.

◆ FLUENCY BEFORE ACCURACY – THE RETELL

In the retell rounds, **your job is to listen, not to correct**. Walk around with a notebook and write sentences down exactly as you hear them. Correct only if the listener can't understand. The time limit is part of the task: telling the same story again, faster, to a new person builds fluency. Afterwards, do the delayed correction with anonymous sentences, and always include one or two excellent sentences to praise.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Continuous for sudden events:** "Suddenly the phone was ringing." Russian and Polish (aspect), Hindi/Urdu and Turkish speakers may choose by "how it feels," not by "short or long." Ask: "Long background or one short moment?"
- ◆ **Continuous with state verbs:** "I was knowing him." "The house was having a garden." Spanish, Portuguese and French speakers map their imperfect (which covers states) onto *was -ing*. Teach: *know, have (own), like, want, believe* stay simple.
- ◆ **Dropping was / were:** "I walking home when..." Arabic, Chinese, Vietnamese, Haitian Creole. Point at the board: **was + -ing**.
- ◆ **he / she in a story about a character:** Tagalog, Chinese, Finnish, Turkish, Persian, Yoruba and Hungarian speakers (one word for he/she). Stories with named characters make this very visible. Recast gently: "Dev? He got wet."
- ◆ **"At the end" / "At the final" / "Finally" for "in the end":** Spanish *al final*, Portuguese *no final*, French *à la fin*. *In the end* = the result of the story; *at the end of* + noun (*at the end of the day*).
- ◆ **"Actually" for "now / at the moment":** Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, Portuguese *atualmente*. In English *actually* = "in fact" (a surprise), which is great in stories: "It was actually my old teacher!"

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_14.html. Listen to "A Story in Action" with 🎧 and read it aloud; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 5.2: "My story map" (plan one story: the group story, a story identity card, or a light real one), "My new words" and the journal (4–6 sentences, label each verb S / C / P). Ready for next class: tell your story in 1 minute.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** was walking ... heard · Q2 **C** had baked · Q3 (new) **C** went. Dev (Ex 1): 1 at ten o'clock · 2 sunny (the sun was shining) · 3 it broke down (it stopped suddenly) · 4 his umbrella · 5 soaked / completely wet, with coffee on his shirt · 6 he got the job.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- choose the best future form: *will* (decision now, prediction, offer, promise), *going to* (plan / intention, evidence), present continuous (fixed arrangement)
- form and use the **future continuous** (*will be* + -ing) for an action in progress at a future time: *This time tomorrow I'll be flying to Chicago.*
- ask polite, no-pressure questions: *Will you be using the car tonight?*
- use the **present simple** (not *will*) after *when*, *as soon as*, *before*, *after*, *until*, *by the time*: *I'll call you when I arrive.*
- discuss life in 2040 with reasons and at least three future forms, and agree / disagree politely

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 5.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My future sentences," Module 5 look-back)
- Slides 14–18 · Flashcards (5.3 future topics) · **Life in 2040** topic cards + role cards (1 set per group of 4) · talking chips (3 per learner) · Future identity cards
- Listening scripts 5.3-A (Nora and Sam plan the week) and 5.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: "Which future?" three boxes: ⚡ decide now / I think → **will** · 🧠 plan / 👁 evidence → **going to** · 📅^{July 17} in the diary → **present continuous**.

Center: a time line: NOW → ★ **this time tomorrow** with a long arrow across the star: **I'll be flying**. · won't be + -ing · **Will you be using** the car tonight?

Right: I'll call you **when I arrive**. (❌ when I will arrive) · as soon as · before · after · until · by the time + **present simple**.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: 1-minute story	8	S-S	Review C15. Pairs: A tells the story from their homework story map in 1 minute (timer on screen); B reacts and asks one question. Swap. Then two quick checks from the board:

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			"Background? Flashback? Sudden event?"
Lead-in: which future?	6	T-S	Slide 14. Three quick situations: (1) your phone rings → "I'll get it!" (2) show a diary page: "Dentist, Thursday 3 pm" → "I'm seeing the dentist on Thursday." (3) dark clouds → "It's going to rain." Learners say the sentence; you ask "Decision now, arrangement or evidence?" This is A2 review: move fast.
Clarify: which future when	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 14 table. CCQs for <i>will vs going to</i> , and <i>going to vs present continuous</i> . Make it clear that several forms are often possible: "Choose by meaning; don't panic." Pairs do Workbook Ex 2 items 1-3 at once.
Future continuous	12	T-S	Slide 15. "Tomorrow at 10 a.m. I'll be teaching you. At 10 p.m. I'll be sleeping!" Draw the arrow across the point. Meaning, form, the polite question. CCQs and drill (below). Then Workbook Ex 4 (Priya's day) together.
Time clauses	8	T-S → S	Slide 16. Write the  sentence first: "I'll call you when I will arrive." "What's wrong?" Link to the first conditional (Module 2.1): <i>if</i> and <i>when</i> work the same way. Drill "I'll...when I..." chains. Workbook Ex 3 alone.
Listening: Nora and Sam	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.3-A twice (be both voices, or ask a confident learner to read Sam). First listen: 5 questions. Second listen: find one example of each future form. Pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (4–6) and Ex 5 (make it polite) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only disagreements (Ex 2 often has two good answers: accept both if the meaning fits).
Freer: Life in 2040 discussion	20	S (prep) → S-S (groups) → T-S	Slide 17. (1) Warm-up in pairs, choose one: "This time next week, I'll be..." (real, a future identity card, or an imagined person) (3 min). (2) Groups of 4 with topic cards, role cards and 3 talking chips each. Each learner chooses a topic; the group discusses 3–4 topics: predictions with <i>will / might / won't / will probably</i> , one <i>will be -ing</i> sentence, one time clause, reasons, agree / disagree (12 min). (3) Reporters give the group's most surprising prediction (5 min). ICQs first.
Feedback + module check	6	T-S	Delayed correction: "I'll call you when I will arrive." · "In 2040 people will working from home." · "After ten years, cars will fly." (→ in ten years) · plus 2 good sentences. Then learners tick the Module 5 "I can..." lists and look back at their Progress Test goal (private).
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 5.3; "My future sentences" and the journal. Preview C17: "Next class: <i>a, an, the...</i> or nothing!"
Total	90		8 + 6 + 8 + 12 + 8 + 7 + 10 + 20 + 6 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Cut the listening's second task (find the forms) and set Ex 5 as homework. The lead-in and the "which future" stage are A2 review: if the class is strong, join them into 8 minutes and give the time to the discussion. Never cut the discussion: it is the first long, free B1 discussion of the course, and it prepares Module 7.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: which future? (review, fast)

SAY: (Phone rings.) "I'll get it!" Did I plan this? (No.) When did I decide? (Now.) · "I'm going to call her tonight." Plan or decision now? (A plan I already had.) · "I'm meeting Sara at six." Is it in my diary? (Yes: a fixed arrangement.) · "Look at those clouds: it's going to rain." Can I see something? (Yes: evidence.)

Meaning: future continuous. An action in **progress** at a point in the future: already started, not finished. It is the future version of the past continuous.

SAY: "This time tomorrow, I'll be flying to Chicago." At this time tomorrow, is the flight starting or already happening? (Already happening: I'm in the middle of it.) · "At 8 p.m. I'll watch the game." / "At 8 p.m. I'll be watching the game." Which one starts at 8? (The first.) In which one am I already watching at 8? (The second.)

SAY: "Will you be using the car tonight?" Am I asking you to do something? (No.) Am I asking about your plans? (Yes, politely.) Why is it polite? (It doesn't push. Maybe I want the car, but I don't say it directly.)

Meaning: time clauses. After *when, as soon as, before, after, until, by the time*, the meaning is future but the verb is **present**.

SAY: "I'll call you when I arrive." Have I arrived? (No: future.) Which verb is future? ("I'll call.") Why not "when I will arrive"? (After *when*, we use the present.) · "as soon as" = slow or fast? (Immediately.) · "We'll wait until she comes." Do we wait after she comes? (No, we stop waiting.)

Form.

will	will ('ll) + base verb	decision now · prediction · offer · promise	It's cold. I'll close the window.
going to	am / is / are going to + base verb	plan / intention · evidence	We're going to paint the kitchen.

Present continuous	am / is / are + -ing + time	fixed arrangement	We're flying to Madrid on Saturday.
Future continuous	will be + -ing · won't be + -ing · Will you be + -ing?	in progress at a future time · polite question	At 8 p.m. I'll be watching the game. · Will you be joining us?
Time clause	main clause (will) + when / as soon as / before / after / until + present simple	future meaning	I'll text you as soon as I land.

Pronunciation. *I'll be* links into one beat: /aɪl bi/ ("ail-bee"); stress the main verb: "I'll be **FLY**ing to Chi**CA**go." *won't be* /wɒnt bi/: keep the **t** (it carries the negative). In time clauses the stress is on both verbs: "I'll **CALL** you when I **arRIVE**." Polite questions rise gently at the end: "Will you be using the **CAR** tonight? ↗". In the discussion, softeners make predictions sound natural and open: "I think... · Probably... · I don't think... will...".

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 This time tomorrow** (T shows a clock time and an activity): T: "9 a.m. · work" → S: "At 9 a.m. tomorrow, I'll be working." T: "8 p.m. · cook dinner" → S: "At 8 p.m., I'll be cooking dinner." Change the person: "she / they."
- 2 Negative + reason:** T: "Don't call me at 7." → S: "I won't be answering. I'll be driving."
- 3 Make it polite:** T: "Will you use the printer later?" → S: "Will you be using the printer later?" T: "Will you come to the meeting?" → S: "Will you be coming to the meeting?"
- 4 Time-clause chain:** S1: "I'll relax when I get home." → S2: "When I get home, I'll..." → S3: "As soon as I..., I'll..." Around the room.
- 5 Which future? — fast:** T gives a situation; learners answer at once: "Someone knocks at the door." (I'll get it.) · "Your flight is booked for Friday." (I'm flying on Friday.) · "You decided to learn to cook." (I'm going to take a class.) · "Your friend is about to drop a glass." (You're going to drop that!)

◆ LIFE IN 2040 DISCUSSION – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Warm-up (pairs, optional personal):** "This time next week, I'll be..." Learners choose: their real next week (small and safe), a **future identity card**, or an imagined person in 2040 ("In 2040, Maya will be working on a farm in the city."). Nobody talks about visas, family plans or where they will live.
- ◆ **Groups of 4 with roles** (role cards): the **Chair** reads the topic and makes sure everyone speaks; the **Question-asker** asks "Why do you think so?" and "What about...?"; the **Timekeeper** moves on after 3 minutes; the **Reporter** notes the most surprising prediction. Everyone also gives opinions.
- ◆ **Topics are about society**, not about the learners' own lives: getting around, work, shopping, homes, schools, food, money, phones, our city, free time, doctors and hospitals, learning languages. Each card

has two questions and a sentence starter.

- ◆ **Talking chips:** each learner has 3 chips. Put one in the middle every time you speak for more than a sentence. When your chips are gone, you listen and ask questions until everyone has used theirs. Then everyone takes their chips back.
- ◆ **Language targets** on the card: 1 prediction with *will / might / won't / will probably*, 1 *will be + -ing* ("In 2040 most people will be working from home."), 1 time clause ("When cars drive themselves, people won't need a license."), and one polite disagreement ("I'm not sure. I think...").

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DISCUSSION

SAY: *Are we talking about your own life in 2040? (No, about society: work, transport, shopping...) · Must you talk about your own next week? (No. You can choose a card or an imagined person.) · What does the Chair do? (Makes sure everyone speaks.) · When do you put a chip in the middle? (When I speak.) · No chips left: what do you do? (Listen and ask questions.) · What do you say if you disagree? ("I'm not sure. I think...")*

◆ HANDLING DOMINANT SPEAKERS

B1 discussions often turn into one learner's speech. The **talking chips** and **roles** fix most of it without comment. Give a strong, talkative learner the **Question-asker** or **Timekeeper** role: they stay active but spend their energy getting others to talk. Give a quiet learner the **Chair** role with the card in hand: reading the question aloud is a safe first turn. If someone still takes over, walk past and say to the whole group: "Chair, has everyone answered this one?" Never correct a quiet learner in front of the group during the discussion.

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use the picture topic cards () and three frames only: "In 2040, people will ____." / "I think ____ might ____." / "I don't think ____ will ____." For the future continuous, use the clock frame "At ____ tomorrow, I'll be ____-ing" with the Priya pictures from Ex 4. Target: 3 predictions and 1 "I'll be -ing" sentence. Pair the learner with a supportive Reporter.

STRETCH

Use *will probably / probably won't* in the right position, *by 2040* with the future continuous ("By 2040, we'll be using..." is fine), and two time clauses in one idea ("As soon as batteries get cheaper, most people will drive electric cars, and when that happens, cities will be quieter."). Early finishers write a 6-sentence "A day in 2040" paragraph with four future forms.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"When I will arrive":** French (*quand j'arriverai*), Russian (*kogda ya priedu*, future form), Greek and others use a future form after "when." Spanish and Portuguese use a subjunctive, so learners guess. Link it to the first conditional: "like *if*: present after *when*."

- ◆ **Present simple for the future:** "I call you tomorrow." "Next week I go to Chicago." (German, Russian, Spanish, Chinese, Japanese). Understood; recast with the best form. Timetables are the exception: "The train leaves at 6."
- ◆ **"I'll flying" / "I will be fly":** missing **be** (Arabic, Vietnamese, Chinese) or missing **-ing**. Board chant: "will + be + -ing."
- ◆ **"After ten years, cars will fly."** for "in ten years": Spanish *después de*, Chinese 以后, Korean 10년 후. *In* + amount of time = from now; *after* + amount = after something else.
- ◆ **German / Dutch "will" = want:** "I will a new job" = I want. Back again from A2: "I **want** (a wish) / I'll (future)."
- ◆ **Very direct disagreement:** "No. You are wrong." Some learners (German, Dutch, Russian, Israeli) may sound blunt; others (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Filipino) may never disagree. Teach the middle: "I'm not sure. I think..." and "Maybe, but...".

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_15.html. Listen to the colleagues' conversation with 🎧 and read it aloud; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 5.3: "My future sentences" (next week or an identity card, plus 2040), "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I'll phone you when I get home. · Q2 **B** will be flying · Q3 (new) **B** 'll be doing. Nora and Sam (Ex 1): 1 a small party for Leo's birthday · 2 he's seeing the dentist · 3 pick up the cake · 4 as soon as she gets the order number · 5 working from home. Forms: arrangement *I'm having / I'm seeing* · plan *I'm going to order* · offer *I'll pick it up* · future continuous *Will you be using / I'll be working / we'll be eating* · time clause *as soon as I get it / until the party starts*.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C16: MODULE 5 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "rewind, tell, fast-forward": **had + pp** (the earlier past) → **was -ing / past simple / had + pp** together (a whole story) → **will / going to / -ing / will be -ing** (the future). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C17 warmer.

Check the C14 goals. At the end of C16, invite learners to read their Progress Test goal again (the "Look back" box in Workbook 5.3): "Did you practice it? What will you do next?" This is private: no one reports to the class.

Watch for in Module 6: articles (*a / the / zero*) show up in every story. Learners who just told stories will say "I went to the work" or "The life is hard." Keep a 2-minute story warmer in C17–C19: one learner gives a 3-sentence story, the class listens for articles as well as tenses.

Final assessment (C26) covers all eight modules. From this module it tests: past perfect (+ / – / ?), earlier vs later action, *by the time / already / just / never ... before*, narrative tenses in a story, *while / when*, story connectors, the choice of future form, the future continuous, and time clauses with the present simple.

Module 6 — Precision & Detail

Three classes on the small words that make B1 English sound exact. First the articles (*a / an, the* and no article), organized around one question:

Does my listener already know which one I mean? Then verb patterns:

which verbs take *-ing* and which take *to*, plus the verbs that change

meaning (*stop, remember, forget, try*). Last, **degree and quantity**: *too /*

enough, so / such ... that, (a) few / (a) little and *all / most / some / none of*,

used for real in complaints and compliments.

3 lessons

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

Weeks 9–10

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle, role-play) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from `slides/module-6-precision.html`. Print `materials/module-6/classroom-materials.html` before C17. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the Editor texts, the Describe & Draw place cards, the verb-sort and meaning-change sentence cards, the Find Someone Who game, the complaints & compliments role-play cards, the Community Center problem-solving task and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home.
- This is a precision module, not a new-tense module.** Learners already *communicate* without perfect articles or verb patterns. The goal is accuracy that grows over time, not overnight perfection. Say this out loud in C17: "Article mistakes almost never stop people understanding you. We're polishing, not fixing something broken." Learners from article-free languages need to hear it.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** A2 covered *like / want / would like* + *-ing / to* and *too / enough* with adjectives. Check what learners know in each lead-in and move fast where they are strong. The new B1 work is the **choice**: the article decision flow and the fixed cases, verb + object + *to*, *-ing* after prepositions, the meaning-change verbs, *so / such ... that* and *few vs a few*.
- American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons often use British forms: *film, holiday, favourite, practise, travelling, post a letter, queue, play football, at the weekend*, and (6.1) *go to hospital*. Teach *movie*,

vacation, favorite, practice, traveling, mail a letter, line, play soccer, on the weekend and **go to the hospital** (American English keeps *the* here). Accept the British forms when learners use them.

- Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Which one? → Which form? → How much? In C17 learners decide *which thing* they mean (*a new one, the one we both know, or things in general*), and they act as **editors** who fix a real text. In C18 they decide *which verb form* follows another verb, and they learn that sometimes the form changes the meaning (*I stopped buying coffee* ≠ *I stopped to buy coffee*). In C19 they say *how much* (*too cold, not warm enough, so loud that..., a few towels*) and use it for a real-life job: complaining politely and giving a compliment. Every class ends with a speaking task where precision makes a difference to the listener.

FLUENCY FIRST, THEN ACCURACY — AND DOMINANT SPEAKERS

Precision is easy to over-correct. In the freer stages, do not stop speakers to fix an article or an -ing form. Walk around with a notepad and write down what you hear (good and not yet right). Correct **after** the task, on the board, without names. Only interrupt if a partner truly cannot understand. In controlled stages (workbook, drills), correct on the spot, quickly and kindly.

Dominant speakers. B1 classes often have one or two fluent, confident talkers. Give every pair and group task a visible structure: a **timer** for each speaker, a **talking token** (a pen that passes), or a **role** (speaker / listener / checker in C18). In whole-class feedback, use "a new voice, please" and wait 5 seconds before you accept an answer. Give strong speakers a stretch job (the checker, the Editor B text, the manager role in C19) so they are busy, not bored.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: PLACES, MEMORIES AND COMPLAINTS

Three tasks in this module can touch painful things. **C17** asks learners to describe a place they know well: for some, "home" is a camp, a shelter, or a place they lost. **C18** uses *remember doing*: childhood memories are not easy for everyone. **C19** practices complaints: some learners have had real, frightening conflicts with landlords, employers or officials. For every personal task, offer three choices out loud: **a real place or memory, a new identity card** (in the classroom materials), or **a place card / an invented one**. In C19 the role-plays are clearly **roles** on cards; nobody has to use a real complaint. Anyone can say "Pass." Say it every time, so choosing a card is normal and not a sign that something is wrong.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **picture flashcards** (one set for the board): the a/an sound cards, the fixed-phrase cards (go to bed, by bus, play the guitar...), and the degree & quantity cards. Card stock helps. Cut them before C17.

- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table for all three classes, where anyone can take one without asking.
- For C17: one **Editor B** text per pair (the Editor A text is in the workbook), and one **Describe & Draw** place card per learner. Blank paper for drawing.
- For C18: one **verb-sort** set and one **meaning-change sentence card** set per pair (cut and clip them), one **Find Someone Who** sheet per learner, and one **two-minute talk checker card** per pair. A phone timer.
- For C19: one **complaints & compliments A/B** card set per pair (6 situations), and one **Community Center** problem-solving sheet per group of 3–4 (for early finishers or as the alternative task).
- Bring a real mug or cup (the "coffee" lead-in in C17) and something too heavy or too high to reach (C19 lead-in).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
6.1	C17 • wk 9	<i>a / an</i> (first mention, one of many, jobs; <i>an</i> + vowel sound), <i>the</i> (second mention, unique, clear from the situation, superlatives, defined by what follows), zero article (general plurals and uncountables, most countries, meals, languages), fixed cases (<i>go to bed, have lunch, by bus, play the guitar</i>)	edit a short text and fix its article mistakes, and describe a place they know well in 8+ sentences, moving from <i>a</i> to <i>the</i>
6.2	C18 • wk 9	verb + -ing (<i>enjoy, avoid, finish, suggest, keep, mind...</i>), verb + to (<i>want, decide, hope, promise, offer, refuse, manage...</i>), verb + object + to (<i>tell / ask / advise someone to</i>), -ing after prepositions and as a subject, meaning-change verbs <i>stop / remember / forget / try</i>	talk for two minutes about their habits, plans and preferences with 10 different verb patterns, and explain the difference between <i>stop doing</i> and <i>stop to do</i>
6.3	C19 • wk 10	<i>too</i> + adjective, adjective + <i>enough</i> , <i>enough</i> + noun, <i>too much / too many</i> , <i>so</i> + adjective / <i>such</i> (a) + noun ... <i>that</i> , <i>a few / few, a little / little, all / most / some / none</i> (of)	make a polite complaint and give a compliment, saying exactly what is wrong and what is good (<i>The room is too cold. There aren't enough towels. The staff were so helpful!</i>)

6.1 · C17

Articles — a / an, the & No Article

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use *a / an* for a first mention, for "one of many," and for jobs (*She's **an** engineer.*), choosing *an* by the sound (*an hour, a university*)
- ◆ use *the* when the listener knows which one: second mention, only one exists, clear from the situation, superlatives and ordinals, defined by what follows (*the woman who called you*)
- ◆ use **no article** for general plurals and uncountables (*I love music. Dogs are loyal.*), most countries, languages, meals, days and sports
- ◆ use the fixed cases as chunks: *go to bed / school / work, have breakfast, by bus, play the guitar* (and American *go to the hospital*)
- ◆ find and fix article mistakes in a short text, and describe a place in 8+ sentences

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "A place I know well" plan)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · a real mug or cup · a/an sound flashcards + fixed-phrase flashcards · **Editor B** text (1 per pair) · **Describe & Draw** place cards (1 per learner) + blank paper · new identity cards
- ◆ Listening script 6.1-A (My new neighborhood). Script 6.1-B (dictation) is for the C18 warmer.

BOARD PLAN

Left: the question in a box: **Does my listener know which one?** → YES: **the** · NO + one countable thing: **a / an** · NO + general plural / uncountable: — (**no article**)

Center: one noun, three ways: I need **a** coffee. (any cup) · **The** coffee here is great. (this coffee) · I don't drink coffee. (in general) · Under it: I saw **a** dog. → **The** dog was huge. (first → second mention)

Right: **an** + vowel SOUND: an apple · an hour · an honest man | **a** + consonant SOUND: a car · a university · a European city. Below: fixed: go to bed · have lunch · by bus · play **the** guitar · play soccer.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: this time tomorrow	8	S-S → T-S	Review C16 (5.3, future forms). Pairs finish three sentence starters on the board: "This time tomorrow I'll be..." · "When I get home tonight, I'll..." · "I'm ... on Saturday." (real, a new identity card, or imagined). Two pairs share one sentence each. Correct only "When I will get home" (time clause).
Lead-in: one noun, three ways	7	T-S → S-S	Hold up a mug. Say three sentences: "I need a coffee." " The coffee in this building is terrible!" "My sister doesn't drink coffee." Write them on the board. Ask: "What's different? Why <i>a</i> , why <i>the</i> , why nothing?" Let pairs guess for 1 minute. Then a quick class survey: "Does your first language have words like <i>a</i> and <i>the</i> ?" Many will say no. Say: "Good. Today we find the one question behind them."
Grammar: a / an · the · zero	15	T-S	Slides 3–4. Build the board: the question box, then the three uses of <i>a / an</i> , the reasons for <i>the</i> , and the zero article. Use the "which one?" test with the CCQs (below). Then slide 5: <i>a</i> or <i>an</i> ? It's the sound . Hold up the sound flashcards (apple, egg, umbrella, hour, university, uniform); learners call out "an!" or "a!". Drill the weak forms (see Pronunciation).
Fixed cases	6	T-S	Slide 6 + fixed-phrase flashcards. "go to bed" (to sleep) vs "The cat is on the bed" (the object). "go to school" (as a student) vs "go to the school" (the building, for a meeting). Meals: "have breakfast." Transport: "by bus / by car" (but " on the bus"). Instruments take <i>the</i> , sports don't. Flag the US/UK difference: "go to the hospital" (US).
Listening: my new neighborhood	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 6.1-A twice at natural speed (weak articles). Learners write <i>a / an / the / —</i> in the 13 gaps. Pairs compare and say <i>why</i> for three gaps (" <i>the</i> park: second mention"). Check on slide or board.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (a, an, the or —) and Ex 4 (one mistake in each sentence) alone, then pairs check. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers write Ex 5 (one noun, three ways).
The Editor	13	S-S	Slide 7. Workbook Ex 3: learners are the editors of a community newsletter. The writer's first language has no articles; the text has 12 mistakes (6 missing, 3 extra, 3 wrong). Pairs mark each one with the editor's code (^ = add, / = delete,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			circle = change) and write the correct article (8 min). Then pairs join another pair and compare (3 min). Class check on the slide: learners read the corrected sentence and say the reason (2 min). Fast pairs take the Editor B text (10 mistakes). ICQs first.
Freer: Describe & Draw	15	S-S	Slide 8. (1) Each learner chooses a place: a real place they know well, a place card , or the place on their new identity card. They make notes in the workbook plan: 4 things with <i>a / an</i> , what's special about them with <i>the</i> , and 2 general sentences (4 min). (2) A describes; B draws, and asks "Where's the table?" "Is there a window?" (4 min). Swap (4 min). (3) Compare the drawings with the speaker's notes. Pairs tell each other one article they want to check (3 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed error correction: write 4 sentences you heard (2 good, 2 with errors, no names), e.g. "There is table near the window. Table is very old." · "I love the nature." Learners fix them and give the reason. Praise one clear <i>a</i> → <i>the</i> description.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.1 on screen and point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 7 + 15 + 6 + 8 + 8 + 13 + 15 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Shorten the fixed cases to the three most common (*go to bed, have breakfast, by bus*) and let Ex 2's last items do the rest. Don't cut the Editor: finding mistakes in someone else's writing is where learners start to see articles. If you must, do Describe & Draw one way only (A describes, B draws) and ask B to describe their own place at home for homework.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the one question. Does my listener already know which one I mean? If yes → *the*. If no, and it's one countable thing → *a / an*. If I mean things in general (a plural or an uncountable) → no article.

SAY: "I saw a dog in the park." Do you know this dog? (No, it's new.) · "The dog was huge." Which dog? (The one I just told you about.) · "Can you close the door?" Which door? (That one. We can both see it.) · "The sun is hot." How many suns? (One. It's unique.)

SAY: "I love music." All music, or one song? (All music, in general.) · "I love the music in this café." In general, or this music? (This music, here.) · "She's a doctor." Is this her job? (Yes.) Can I say "She's doctor"? (No. Jobs need a / an.)

SAY: "an hour" — the first letter is h. Why an? (We don't say the h. The first sound is a vowel.) · "a university" — the first letter is u. Why a? (It sounds like "you." That's a consonant sound.)

SAY: Fixed cases: "I go to bed at eleven." Am I going to the bed to fix it or to sleep? (To sleep.) · "My mom is in the hospital." American or British? (American. British says "in hospital.") · "She plays the piano. He plays soccer." Which one has the? (Instruments. Sports don't.)

Form.

a / an	singular countable noun: new, one of many, a job	I bought a phone. · Pass me a pen. · He's an engineer.
the	singular, plural or uncountable: the listener knows which	The phone stopped working. · the sun · the best day · the woman who called
— (zero)	plural or uncountable noun, in general	I like cats . · Water is essential. · Life is hard.
zero (fixed)	most countries, languages, meals, days, cities, streets, sports	in Japan · speak Spanish · have lunch · on Monday · play chess
the (fixed)	some countries, instruments, unique things	the USA · the UK · play the guitar · the internet
purpose vs place	go to bed / school / work / church (for its purpose)	go to the school (the building) · US: go to the hospital

Pronunciation. Articles are almost always **weak** and unstressed: *a* /ə/, *an* /ən/, *the* /ðə/ before a consonant sound. Before a vowel sound many speakers say *the* /ði/: "thee apple," "thee hour." *An* links to the next word: "an_apple" sounds like "a-napple." Learners who stress every article ("I saw **A** dog") sound slow and robotic; drill the weak form in chunks: "a_dog, the_dog, an_hour." The *th* sound /ð/: Spanish, French, Russian, Tagalog, Arabic and Vietnamese speakers may say "de" or "ze"; show the tongue between the teeth, but don't make it the focus today.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 First → second mention:** T: "I bought... jacket." → S: "I bought a jacket. The jacket was expensive." T: "I saw... man." → S: "I saw a man. The man was singing." Choral ×2, then 5–6 individuals with new nouns (a cake, an umbrella, a letter).
- 2 a or an?** T says a noun; learners say it with the article, fast: "hour" → "an hour" · "university" → "a university" · "honest man" → "an honest man" · "European city" → "a European city" · "umbrella" → "an

umbrella" · "uniform" → "a uniform".

- 3 **General or specific?** T: "music, general" → S: "I love music." T: "music, this café" → S: "I love the music in this café." T: "dogs, general" → S: "Dogs are loyal." T: "dogs, next door" → S: "The dogs next door are loud."
- 4 **Jobs chain:** S1: "I'm a cook. What do you do?" → S2: "I'm an office assistant. What do you do?" (real job, a new identity card, or a dream job: "I want to be a...").
- 5 **Fixed chunks, choral:** "go to bed · go to work · have breakfast · by bus · on the bus · play the guitar · play soccer." Then T gives a picture card; learners make a sentence about their day.

◆ THE EDITOR – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Set the scene: "You're the editors of the community newsletter. A new volunteer wrote this. Her first language has no articles. Her ideas are great; your job is to make it perfect before it's printed." This makes the mistakes *someone else's* and treats the writer with respect.
- ◆ Tell them the number: **12 mistakes: 6 missing, 3 extra, 3 wrong.** Knowing the number keeps pairs searching and stops them "fixing" correct articles. There are also correct articles that *look* suspicious (*The children come every Friday; Most beds belong to families*). Those are traps.
- ◆ Editor's code: ^ add an article · / delete it · **circle** it and write the new one above. Pairs must agree on a reason for each change, using the board question.
- ◆ Finished early? Editor B (a text message about a new job, 10 mistakes: 4 missing, 5 extra, 1 wrong). Answers are in the answer key.
- ◆ **L1 note to share:** "If your language has no articles, like Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Russian, Vietnamese or Polish, missing articles are your typical mistake. If your language has articles, like Spanish, French, Portuguese or Arabic, extra *the* in general sentences is your typical mistake. Which editor are you?" Learners enjoy spotting their own pattern.

◆ DESCRIBE & DRAW – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ A sits with the notes; B has a blank paper and a pencil. B must not see A's notes. A describes: "There's **a** big window on the left. **The** window has green curtains. Under **the** window there's **a** sofa..." B draws and checks: "Is **the** sofa under **the** window?"
- ◆ Each description needs 8+ sentences: new things with *a / an*, then the same things with *the*, plus 2 general sentences with no article ("It sells coffee and cakes." "I love quiet mornings there.").
- ◆ Place cards (café, bus station, library, laundromat, playground, workplace kitchen) give ready ideas. A learner with a new identity card describes that person's place. Nobody explains why they chose a card.
- ◆ While they talk, you write down sentences for the feedback stage. Don't correct during the task.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE EDITOR AND DESCRIBE & DRAW

SAY: Editor: How many mistakes? (Twelve.) · How many are missing articles? (Six.) · What does ^ mean? (Add an article.) · Do you change every article? (No! Some are correct.) · Do you need a reason? (Yes, for every change.)

SAY: Describe & Draw: Can B see A's notes? (No.) · First time you say "window": a or the? (A.) · Second time? (The.) · Must you describe your real home? (No. A place card or a new identity card is fine.) · How many sentences? (Eight or more.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on two jobs of articles: *a* for a new thing and *the* for the same thing again, plus *a / an* with jobs. In the Editor, give a large-print copy of the first four lines only, with each mistake already underlined: the learner only decides "add, delete or change." In Describe & Draw, the learner uses the place card's picture list and says 4 pairs of sentences ("There's a table. The table is big."). Pair them with a patient partner who draws.

STRETCH

Add *the* + **defined by what follows** (*the café on the corner, the man who works there*) and superlatives (*the best seat, the only window*) to the description. In the Editor, explain each change in writing using the grammar words (first mention, general, unique). Early finishers do Editor B and then write a "trap" sentence with a correct but surprising article for the class to judge.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **No articles at all** ("I bought phone. Phone is broken."): Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Russian, Polish, Ukrainian, Vietnamese, Thai, Hindi/Urdu, Turkish (*bir* ≈ one only), Swahili and many more. These learners often *cannot hear* the weak /ə/ at first. Be patient: noticing comes first, then accuracy. Tagalog markers (*ang, ng, si*) are not articles, so Filipino learners also drop or add them unpredictably.
- ◆ **Extra "the" for general ideas** ("The life is hard." "I like the animals." "She studies the medicine."): Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, German and Arabic (*al-* works for general meaning, *al-ḥayāt* = "the life"). Teach "In English, general = no article."
- ◆ **No "a" with jobs** ("She's doctor." "I want to be teacher."): Spanish *soy doctora*, Portuguese, French *je suis médecin*, German *Ich bin Lehrer*, Arabic (no indefinite article), Russian. Very frequent. Drill it.
- ◆ **"the France / the Brazil"**: French *la France*, Portuguese *o Brasil*, Italian *l'Italia*. Most countries = no article; only *the USA, the UK, the Netherlands, the Philippines* (plural or "united / republic / kingdom" names).
- ◆ **Meals and instruments**: "have the breakfast" (French *le petit-déjeuner*, Spanish *el desayuno*), "play guitar" (fine in casual US English, so accept it; teach *play the guitar* as the standard).

- ◆ **a / an by spelling:** "a hour, an university." Everyone, especially learners who read more than they listen. Always say it; don't look at it.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_16.html. Listen to the five model sentences with  and say them aloud, with weak articles. Do the three online exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 6.1: finish Ex 5 and write "A place I know well" (8+ sentences, from the plan), "My new words" and the journal (one noun, three ways, with the reasons).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** She's a teacher at a big school. · Q2 **B** music ... the music · Q3 (new) **B** an hour. Script 6.1-A (Ex 1): 1 a · 2 a · 3 the · 4 a · 5 the · 6 an · 7 an · 8 a · 9 The · 10 the · 11 — · 12 — · 13 —. Editor A (Ex 3): *a* group · *an* empty lot · ~~the~~ Maple Street · into *a* garden · *the* garden (not a) · also *a* bed · *a* volunteer · ~~the~~ tomatoes · ~~The~~ gardening · on *the* first Saturday · *an* expert (not a) · *a* hat (not the).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use verb + **-ing** after *enjoy, avoid, finish, suggest, keep, mind, can't stand, feel like, give up, miss, practice*
- ◆ use verb + **to** after *want, decide, hope, promise, learn, offer, refuse, manage, agree, plan, need, can't afford*
- ◆ use verb + **object + to**: *She told **him** to wait. The doctor advised **her** to rest.*
- ◆ use **-ing after a preposition** (*good at drawing, looking forward to seeing you*) and as the **subject** (*Swimming is good for you.*)
- ◆ explain and use the meaning-change verbs: *stop, remember, forget, try* + -ing vs + to
- ◆ talk for two minutes about their habits, plans and preferences with 10 different verb patterns

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the two-minute talk plan)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · **Verb-sort cards** (1 set per pair) · **Meaning-change sentence cards** (1 set per pair: 12 sentence cards + 12 meaning cards) · **Find Someone Who** (1 per learner) · **Two-minute talk checker card** (1 per pair) · a phone timer · new identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.1-B (dictation, for the warmer) and 6.2-A (Which one did you hear?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: three columns. + **-ing**: *enjoy, avoid, finish, suggest, keep, mind...* · + **to**: *want, decide, hope, promise, offer, refuse, manage...* · + **person + to**: *tell / ask / advise / want someone to...*

Center: always -ing: after a preposition (*good at drawing · look forward to seeing you*) · as a subject (*Swimming is good for you.*)

Right: the meaning changes! *stop buying* coffee (no more) ≠ *stop to buy* coffee (pause → in order to) · *remember locking* the door (a memory ←) ≠ *remember to lock* the door (a task →) · *try restarting* it (a test) ≠ *try to open* the jar (an effort)

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: dictation + fix	8	T-S → S-S	Review C17. Read Script 6.1-B (5 sentences) at natural speed, each twice. Learners write them. Pairs compare and underline every article, then say why for two. Show the sentences on the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			board. Two volunteers read one sentence from their "A place I know well" homework.
Lead-in: my confessions	5	T-S	Tell the class 4 true (or invented) facts: "I enjoy cooking, but I want to learn to bake bread. I stopped drinking soda last year. I keep forgetting my keys!" Learners ask one follow-up question each. Write two sentences on the board and ask: "After <i>enjoy</i> ? After <i>want</i> ?" Elicit -ing and to. Most learners know this from A2.
Verb sort: -ing or to?	12	S-S → T-S	Pairs get the verb-sort cards and sort 20 verbs into -ing / to (4 minutes, from memory and guessing). Check with slide 9. Then pairs make one true sentence with 4 of the cards. Leave the four "both" cards (stop, remember, forget, try) aside: "These are special. Later!" Drill (below).
Object + to, prepositions, -ing subject	8	T-S	Slide 10. Verb + person + to: "The doctor said: 'You should rest.' → The doctor advised her to rest ." -ing after a preposition, including the "to" trap (<i>looking forward to seeing, be used to getting up</i>): "Can you put a noun after it? <i>Looking forward to the weekend</i> . Yes, so -ing." -ing as a subject: " Learning a language takes time." CCQs.
Controlled practice 1	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (-ing or to) and Ex 3 (verb + object + to) alone, then pairs check. Board-check the items pairs disagree on, usually Ex 1 item 6 (looking forward to) and Ex 3 item 5 (warned him not to).
Meaning-change verbs	15	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Act out <i>stop</i> : walk across the room, "stop" and mime buying a coffee: "I stopped to buy a coffee." Then mime pushing coffee away: "I stopped buying coffee. Too expensive!" CCQs (below). Then <i>remember / forget</i> (memory ← or task →) and <i>try</i> (test or effort). Pairs match the meaning-change sentence cards to their meaning cards (5 min). Then Script 6.2-A : you read 8 sentences; learners circle the meaning in Workbook Ex 4.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice 2	5	S	Workbook Ex 2 (choose the form to match the meaning) alone. Quick check with slide 11.
Freer 1: Find Someone Who	12	S-S (mingle) → T-S	Slide 13. Learners change the prompt into a question ("Do you enjoy cooking for other people?" "Do you remember learning to ride a bike?") and mingle. One name per line; ask the extra question (9 min). Sit down: 3-4 learners report one surprising answer with he/she: "Tomás can't stand waiting in line. He always shops at night." (3 min). ICQs first.
Freer 2: the two-minute talk	7	S-S	Pairs. Speakers use their workbook plan (habits · plans · preferences, real or a new identity card). A talks for 2 minutes; B is the checker and ticks each verb pattern they hear on the checker card. Swap. Each checker tells the speaker their number: "You used 11 patterns!"
Feedback	5	T-S	Board: 4 heard sentences, e.g. "I'm looking forward to see my family." · "She told to wait." · "I enjoy to cook." · "I stopped to smoke" (said by someone who quit). Learners fix them. Praise the best checker score.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 6.2; workbook Ex 5 (my verb collection) and the journal. Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 8 + 8 + 15 + 5 + 12 + 7 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This class has a lot of grammar. Do the verb sort with 12 cards instead of 20. Skip controlled practice 2 (set Ex 2 as homework; it's short). Never cut the meaning-change stage: *stop / remember / try* is the part learners remember and enjoy. If time is very short, choose **either** Find Someone Who **or** the two-minute talk, and do the other as the C19 warmer.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: two forms after a verb. The first verb decides. Many -ing verbs are about experiences and reactions (*enjoy, avoid, mind*); many to-verbs look forward (*want, hope, plan, promise*). It's a helpful idea, not a rule. Learn them in groups.

SAY: "I enjoy cooking." Is cooking an activity I like now, in general? (Yes.) · "I want to learn to bake." Now or in the future? (The future.) · "She told him to wait outside." Who waits? (He does.) Who gives the instruction? (She does.) · "He asked to help." Who helps? (He does.) "He asked me to help." Who helps now? (I do.)

SAY: "I'm looking forward to seeing you." Can I say "looking forward to the weekend"? (Yes.) So is this to part of a verb, or a preposition? (A preposition.) So...? (-ing.) · "Swimming is good for you." What's the subject of the sentence? (Swimming.)

Meaning: the four special verbs.

SAY: stop: "He stopped working last year." Does he work now? (No.) · "On the way home, he stopped to buy bread." Did he stop walking or driving? (Yes.) Why? (To buy bread.) Does to mean "in order to"? (Yes.)

SAY: remember / forget: "I remember locking the door." Did I lock it? (Yes.) Is it a memory? (Yes, the past.) · "Remember to lock the door." Did you lock it? (Not yet.) Is it a task for later? (Yes.) · "I forgot to call my mom." Did I call her? (No.)

SAY: try: "My laptop froze. Try restarting it." Is it difficult to restart a laptop? (No.) Is it a test, an idea to fix the problem? (Yes.) · "I tried to open the jar, but I couldn't." Easy or difficult? (Difficult.) Did I make an effort? (Yes.)

Form.

verb + -ing	enjoy, avoid, finish, suggest, keep, mind, can't stand, feel like, give up, miss, practice, imagine	Do you mind waiting ? · He suggested going out.
verb + to	want, decide, hope, promise, learn, offer, refuse, manage, agree, plan, need, can't afford, would like	We managed to finish on time.
verb + person + to	want, tell, ask, advise, allow, remind, invite, warn, encourage, teach	I want you to listen . · She warned him not to touch it.
preposition + -ing	good at, interested in, tired of, before, after, without, instead of, look forward to, be used to	We walked instead of taking the bus.
-ing as subject	-ing + verb...	Getting up early is hard in winter.
like / love / hate	+ -ing or to (almost the same)	I like swimming . = I like to swim .

Pronunciation. *-ing* is /ɪŋ/: one nasal sound at the back, no hard /g/ after it ("sing-g" is a common over-correction by Spanish and Polish speakers) and not /ɪn/ in careful speech. *to* is weak /tə/ and joins the verb: "want to" /'wʌntə/, "decided to" /dɪ'saɪdɪd tə/. In "stopped to buy," the /t/ of *stopped* and *to* run together, so learners may *hear* "stop to buy." Stress carries the meaning: "I stopped to **BUY** coffee" / "I stopped **BUYING** coffee." Vietnamese and Cantonese speakers may drop the -ed and final consonants; clap the two beats: "stopped · to."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **-ing or to, quick-fire:** T: "enjoy / swim" → S: "I enjoy swimming." T: "decide / stay home" → S: "I decided to stay home." T: "mind / wait" → "Do you mind waiting?" T: "manage / finish" → "We managed to finish." Choral, then individuals, faster.
- 2 **Report the instruction:** T: "Teacher to Ana: 'Open the window.'" → S: "The teacher told Ana to open the window." T: "Doctor to Omar: 'You should rest.'" → S: "The doctor advised Omar to rest." T: "Mom to me: 'Don't be late.'" → S: "My mom told me not to be late."
- 3 **Preposition + -ing chain:** S1: "I'm good at cooking. What are you good at?" → S2: "I'm good at fixing bikes. What are you interested in?" → S3: "I'm interested in learning Korean. What are you looking forward to?" → S4: "I'm looking forward to seeing..."
- 4 **Two meanings, two gestures:** T says a sentence; learners point **back** over the shoulder (memory) or **forward** (task): "I remember meeting her." (back) · "Remember to call her." (forward) · "I forgot to pay the bill." (forward: a task I didn't do) · "I'll never forget seeing the ocean." (back).
- 5 **Stop, act it:** learners walk; T says "Stop to tie your shoe!" (they stop and tie) / "Stop walking!" (they freeze). Fun and fast; 1 minute.

◆ MEANING-CHANGE SENTENCE CARDS – HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ Each pair gets 12 **sentence cards** (6 pairs, e.g. "She stopped buying coffee." / "She stopped to buy a coffee.") and 12 **meaning cards** ("She doesn't buy coffee anymore." / "She paused on her way so she could buy one."). Spread them face up.
- ◆ Pairs match each sentence to its meaning (5 min). The two sentences in a pair look almost the same, so learners must read the **form** carefully: -ing or to.
- ◆ Check: one pair reads a sentence, another pair reads the meaning. Ask "Why?" and point at the board ("memory or task?", "test or effort?").
- ◆ Round 2 (stretch or fast pairs): turn the meaning cards face down. A reads a sentence; B says the meaning without looking. Or A reads a meaning; B says the sentence.
- ◆ Keep the cards for the C19 warmer (turn them over and play memory / pairs).

◆ FIND SOMEONE WHO & THE TWO-MINUTE TALK – HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ Before the mingle, learners turn two prompts into questions with you: "enjoys cooking for other people" → "Do you enjoy cooking for other people?" · "remembers learning to ride a bike" → "Do you remember learning to ride a bike?" The -ing / to stays the same in the question. That's the point.
- ◆ One name per line; ask each person 1–2 questions, then move on. A "No" is fine: "OK, thanks!" and ask someone else. Anyone can answer as their new identity card person, or say "Pass."
- ◆ The two-minute talk: the speaker talks; the checker listens and ticks patterns on the card (enjoy + -ing, decide + to, told me + to, good at + -ing, a meaning-change verb, an -ing subject...). The checker does not correct. They only count. This keeps confident speakers honest and gives quiet learners a clear job.
- ◆ Dominant speaker in a pair? The timer rules: at 2:00 the speaker stops, even mid-sentence. Then swap.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MINGLE AND THE TALK

SAY: Mingle: Do you read the line, or make a question? (Make a question.) · "enjoys cooking": what's the question? ("Do you enjoy cooking...?") · "Yes": what do you do? (Write the name, ask the extra question.) · How many names for one person? (One.)

SAY: Talk: How long does A speak? (Two minutes.) · What does the checker do? (Listens and ticks the patterns.) · Does the checker correct? (No, only count.) · Must you talk about your real life? (No. A new identity card is fine.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with 6 verbs only: *enjoy, like, can't stand* (+ -ing) and *want, need, would like* (+ to), plus *stop*. In the verb sort, give 6 cards with a small picture next to the verb (😊 enjoy, 😞 can't stand, 🎯 want). In the mingle, give a sheet with the questions fully written; the learner reads the question and writes the first letter of the name. Talk target: 1 minute with 5 patterns, using the plan's sentence starters.

STRETCH

Add *regret* (I regret not studying more) and *need* + -ing (My car needs washing) as "extra collection" verbs. In the two-minute talk, aim for 15 patterns, all four meaning-change verbs and two -ing subjects. Early finishers write 4 "true for me" pairs: "I stopped eating meat / I stopped to eat lunch at a gas station."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Infinitive after a preposition and as a subject** ("before to leave," "interested in learn," "To swim is good," "Swim is good for you"): Spanish, Portuguese, Italian and French use the infinitive here (*antes de salir, interesado en aprender*). Very common. Keep saying: "After a preposition: -ing. Always."
- ◆ **"I want that you listen" / "She said me to wait"**: Spanish *quiero que escuches*, Portuguese, French, Russian, Arabic. Drill "want you to, told me to."

- ◆ **"He suggested to go" / "I suggest you to go":** German *vorschlagen zu*, Spanish *sugerir*, French. Teach *suggest + -ing* (or *suggest that we go* for stretch).
- ◆ **No -ing form at all** ("I enjoy cook," "I finish read"): Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai (no verb endings). The -ing is a small sound: say it clearly and write it in color.
- ◆ **"I enjoy the swimming":** Arabic uses a verbal noun with *al-* (the). Link to C17: "general activity = no article."
- ◆ **"Looking forward to see you":** everyone, including very fluent speakers and many native writers. Use the noun test every time.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_17.html. Listen to the model sentences and the Lena and Marco dialogue with 🎧 and read them aloud. Do the three exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 6.2: Ex 5 (my verb collection: 5 -ing verbs, 5 to verbs, one true sentence each), "My new words," and the journal (one meaning-change verb, both versions, and the difference in your own words).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I enjoy swimming in the sea. · Q2 **B** stopped to have · Q3 (new) **B** seeing. Script 6.2-A (Ex 4): 1 b · 2 a · 3 a · 4 b · 5 a · 6 a · 7 b · 8 b.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use *too* + adjective (a problem) and adjective + *enough* / *enough* + noun, with a to-infinitive result (*It's too cold to swim. She's old enough to drive.*)
- ◆ choose *too many* (countable) or *too much* (uncountable)
- ◆ add emphasis with *so* + adjective / adverb and *such* (a) + (adjective +) noun, plus ... *that* + result
- ◆ feel the difference between *a few* / *a little* (some, positive 😊) and *few* / *little* (not many / not much, negative 😞)
- ◆ use *all* / *most* / *some* / *none*, with *of* before *the* / *my* / *them*
- ◆ make a polite complaint and give a compliment, saying exactly what is wrong and what is good

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the role-play plan)
- ◆ Slides 14–20 · degree & quantity flashcards + the 😊 / 😞 cards · something heavy or high (a full bag, a top shelf) · **Complaints & Compliments** A/B cards (1 set per pair) · **Community Center** problem-solving sheet (1 per group, for early finishers or as the alternative task) · C18 meaning-change cards for the warmer
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.3-A (a restaurant review) and 6.3-B (happy or sad?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: too hot (😞 a problem) · very hot (a fact) · hot enough (✓ OK) · enough money · too many cars (count) · too much noise (no count). Arrow: too cold to swim · old enough to drive.

Center: Noun after it? NO → so good / so quickly · YES → such a good movie / such kind people. + that + result: It was so hot that we left early.

Right: a 2×2 box: 😊 a few friends / a little time · 😞 few friends / little time (count / no count). Below: all → most → some → none · Most people (general) / Most of the people here · none of them.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: meaning-change memory	7	S-S	Review C18. Pairs turn the meaning-change sentence cards and meaning cards face down and play memory: turn two, keep a match only if you can read it aloud and explain it. Then 2–3 learners share one sentence from their verb collection.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Lead-in: too heavy!	5	T-S	Try to lift a heavy bag, or reach a high shelf. "I can't! It's too heavy. I'm not strong enough ." Then slide 14: learners describe the pictures (too hot, too expensive, too small, big enough). Ask: "Is 'too' good or bad?" (Bad: a problem.) "Can I say 'This cake is too good'?" (Not as praise. Say "so good.")
too / enough / too much / too many	13	T-S	Slide 15. Position: <i>too</i> before the adjective, <i>enough</i> after an adjective but before a noun. Then <i>too many</i> (count it) / <i>too much</i> (you can't count it). CCQs and drill (below). Contrast <i>very</i> and <i>too</i> : "It's very hot. We can swim!" / "It's too hot. We can't go outside."
Controlled practice 1	5	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 alone, then pairs check. Quick board check.
so / such ... that	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. The noun test. Read the Priya and Dan dialogue (also on slide 16) in two halves of the room. Then pairs make <i>so / such ... that</i> sentences from prompts on the board: "tired / fell asleep" · "good movie / watched it twice" · "kind people / cried when we left."
(a) few / (a) little · all / most / some / none	10	T-S	Slide 17. The 2×2 box, then Script 6.3-B : learners hold up 😊 or 😞 for 8 sentences. Then the scale all → most → some → none and the <i>of</i> rule: "Most people..." / "Most of the people here..." CCQs.
Controlled practice 2	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 and Ex 3 alone, then pairs check. Board-check Ex 3 Part B (the <i>of</i> items).
Listening: a restaurant review	6	T-S	Workbook Ex 4. Read Script 6.3-A twice. Learners note two good things and three problems, and the exact words (<i>so delicious that, such a friendly person, too small, not enough space</i>). This gives the language for the role-play.
Freer: Complaints & Compliments	17	S-S → T-S	Slides 18–19. Model the front-desk dialogue with a strong learner. (1) Pairs take situation cards (A = customer, B = staff). A reads the problems; B reads what they can offer. 1 minute to plan: no writing the whole dialogue (2 min). (2) Role-play: A complains politely and precisely; B apologizes and offers a solution; when it's fixed, A gives a compliment (4 min). (3) Swap roles with a new card (4 min). (4) New partner, a third card (4 min). (5) Two pairs perform for the class; the class listens for one <i>too / enough</i> and one <i>so / such</i> (3 min). ICQs first. Groups

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			who finish early, or classes who prefer it, do the Community Center problem-solving task.
Feedback + module check	5	T-S	Delayed correction: "The service was too good!" (praise) · "The room isn't enough big." · "It was so a long wait." · "Most of people were kind." Learners fix them. Then learners tick the Module 6 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 6.3 and the review project (write a review of a meal, a trip, a store, or a movie: 8+ sentences). Preview C20: "Next class: agreeing and disagreeing. Is it <i>too</i> easy to disagree in English?"
Total	90		7 + 5 + 13 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 7 + 6 + 17 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Four small grammar points in one class is a lot. *all / most / some / none* is the easiest to shorten: teach only the *of* rule with two examples and leave the rest to Ex 3 Part B at home. Keep the 😊 / 😞 listening: it's fast and memorable. Don't cut the role-play below 12 minutes; do two rounds instead of three.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: too / enough / very. *too* = more than you want: there's a problem or a result you don't like. *enough* = the right amount. *very* = strong, but no problem.

SAY: "The coffee is too hot." Can I drink it now? (No.) Is it a problem? (Yes.) · "The coffee is very hot." Can I drink it? (Maybe, carefully.) · "She's old enough to drive." Can she drive? (Yes.) · "We don't have enough chairs." Can everyone sit down? (No.)

SAY: "There are too many cars." Can we count cars? (Yes: one car, two cars.) So...? (too many.) · "There's too much noise." Can we count noise? (No.) So...? (too much.) · "You worry too much." Is there a noun? (No, it's after a verb: too much.)

Meaning: so / such. Same meaning: "really, very." The difference is grammar: what comes after.

SAY: "It was such a good movie that I watched it twice." Was the movie good? (Very good.) What happened because of that? (I watched it twice.) Is there a noun after "such a good"? (Yes, "movie.") · "It was so good that I watched it twice." Is there a noun after "so good"? (No.)

Meaning: a few / few, a little / little.

SAY: "I have a few friends here." Some friends or no friends? (Some.) Am I OK? (Yes 😊.) · "I have few friends here." Many or not many? (Not many, almost none.) How do I feel? (A bit lonely 😞.) · "We have a little time." Hurry, or relax? (Relax. There's some time.) · "We have little time." (Hurry!) · Friends: countable or not? (Countable: few.) Time? (Uncountable: little.)

SAY: "Most people like music." All people in the world, generally? (Yes, in general.) Is there of? (No.) · "Most of the people in this room like music." General, or a specific group? (Specific: this room.) So...? (Add of.) · "None of them came." How many came? (Zero.)

Form.

too	too + adjective / adverb (+ to...)	It's too cold to swim. · He drives too fast.
enough	adjective + enough · enough + noun (+ to...)	She's old enough to drive. · We don't have enough chairs.
too many / much	too many + plural noun · too much + uncountable noun · verb + too much	too many meetings · too much sugar · You worry too much.
so	so + adjective / adverb (+ that...)	I was so tired that I fell asleep. · She spoke so quietly that...
such (a)	such a / an (+ adj.) + singular noun · such (+ adj.) + plural / uncountable	such a long show · such kind people · such nice weather
(a) few / (a) little	😊 a few + plural · a little + uncountable · 😞 few / little (= not many / not much)	a few minutes · a little money · few people came · little time
all / most / some / none	+ noun (general) · + of + the / my / this / them (specific)	Most people agree. · Some of my friends came. · None of them.

Pronunciation. *too* is always **stressed** and long /tu:/: "It's **TOO** hot." (Compare weak *to* /tə/.) *enough* /ɪˈnʌf/: *gh* = /f/, stress on the second syllable. *so* and *such* carry the emphasis, so they are stressed and can be stretched: "It was **sooo** good!" *such* /sʌtʃ/ ends in "ch" (Spanish and Portuguese speakers may say "such" like "sush"). *a few* /ə 'fju:/: the /ə/ is tiny but it changes the meaning; say "a few" as one word and let learners hear it several times. For complaints, **intonation matters more than grammar**: a soft, rising start ("Excuse me... I'm sorry to bother you, but...") sounds polite; a flat, loud "The room is too cold." can sound angry even with perfect grammar.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 too or enough?** T shows a card and says the adjective: "hot tea, hot" → S: "It's too hot to drink." · "15 years old, old, drive" → S: "She isn't old enough to drive." · "small apartment, big" → S: "It isn't big enough." · "10 people, 6 chairs" → S: "We don't have enough chairs."

- 2 **many or much?** T: "cars" → S: "too many cars." T: "sugar" → "too much sugar." T: "people" → "too many people." T: "homework" → "too much homework." T: "noise" → "too much noise." Fast.
- 3 **so or such?** T: "tired" → S: "I was so tired!" T: "a long day" → S: "It was such a long day!" T: "kind people" → "They're such kind people!" T: "quickly" → "The time went so quickly!"
- 4 **Complaint → compliment:** T: "the room / cold" → S: "Excuse me, the room is too cold." T: "the staff / helpful" → S: "The staff were so helpful. Thank you!" Practice the polite intonation, choral then individual.
- 5 **of or no of?** T: "most / people" → "Most people..." T: "most / the people here" → "Most of the people here..." T: "none / them" → "None of them..."

◆ COMPLAINTS & COMPLIMENTS – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Six situation cards: a hotel room, a restaurant, a store return, a phone and internet company, a delivery order, and a community class. **A** (customer) has 3 problems as prompts (🧊 room / warm → "The room isn't warm enough."). **B** (staff) has what they can and can't offer ("You have a few rooms free on the 5th floor. None of them have a view.").
- ◆ The polite complaint shape (on slide 18): **1** Excuse me / I'm sorry to bother you, but... **2** the exact problem (too / not ... enough / too many) **3** a request: Could you...? / Would it be possible to...? **B:** **4** I'm so sorry about that. I'll... / Let me see what I can do. **A:** **5** a compliment when it's fixed (so / such ... that).
- ◆ Precision is the point. "The room is bad" is not enough; "The room is too cold, and there aren't enough towels for three people" gets a solution. Tell learners: "In real life, a precise complaint gets a faster answer."
- ◆ The compliment is not optional. Many learners have learned complaining is rude or dangerous; the round ends with thanks and praise, so it feels safe and positive. It also practices *so / such* in a friendly way.
- ◆ These are **roles**. Nobody needs to share a real complaint. If a situation card is uncomfortable (for example, the apartment or the phone company), the pair takes a different one. Some learners prefer to solve the problem as a group: give them the **Community Center** sheet (below).

◆ COMMUNITY CENTER PROBLEM-SOLVING – THE ALTERNATIVE TASK

- ◆ Groups of 3–4. The sheet lists 8 complaints from members (too few chairs, not enough parking, the room is too cold in winter, too many people at the Saturday class...) and a budget of \$1,500 with 9 possible fixes and their prices.
- ◆ The group chooses the fixes to buy (the total must be \$1,500 or less), then reports: "Most of the complaints are about the big room. It's too cold, so we'll buy a heater. There aren't enough chairs, so we're buying 20. We have a little money left for..."
- ◆ Use it for early finishers, as a 12-minute replacement for round 3 of the role-play, or as the main freer task

in a class that prefers group discussion to role-play. It is also a good "discussion" preview for Module 7.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE ROLE-PLAY

SAY: *Is A the customer or the staff? (The customer.) · Do you write the whole dialogue first? (No, just plan for a minute.) · Is "The room is bad" enough? (No, say exactly what: too cold, not enough towels.) · What does A say at the end? (A compliment: "You've been so helpful.") · Must you use a real complaint? (No. They're roles.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on *too* + adjective, *not ... enough* and *so* + adjective. Use the picture flashcards (hot, cold, small, expensive) as prompts. In the role-play, give the phrase strip (on the role-play page) and the hotel card only; the partner or teacher reads the situation aloud. Target: 2 complaints ("It's too cold. It isn't big enough.") + 1 request ("Could you help me, please?") + 1 compliment ("You're so kind. Thank you!").

STRETCH

Play the **staff** role with a difficult customer: B can't fix everything and must offer an alternative ("None of the rooms with a view are free, but I can give you a free breakfast."). Use *so ... that* and *such ... that* in every compliment, and a *few / little* pair. Early finishers write the online review of the place in 8 sentences, including *most of / none of*.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"too" as praise** ("The food was too delicious!" "You're too kind" meaning very kind): Chinese *tài hǎo le* 太好了, Tagalog *sobra*, Spanish *demasiado* (in some countries), Arabic, Hindi/Urdu *bahut*. It can sound like a complaint. Teach "so / really / very" for praise. (Note: "You're too kind" is a fixed polite phrase in English and is fine.)
- ◆ **"enough big" / "enough old"**: Spanish *suficientemente grande*, Portuguese *grande o suficiente* (OK) but *bastante grande*, French *assez grand*, Russian, Chinese *gòu dà* 够大 (enough before the adjective). Very common. Chant: "big enough, old enough, warm enough."
- ◆ **"so a nice day" / "such nice" (no noun)**: Spanish *tan* and French *si / tellement* work before adjectives and nouns. Use the noun test.
- ◆ **"much people" / "too much cars"**: Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Tagalog, Arabic (no countable/uncountable grammar). Link to C17: "Can you put a number in front?"
- ◆ **"the most of people" / "most of people"**: Spanish *la mayoría de la gente*, Portuguese *a maioria das pessoas*, French *la plupart des gens*. Teach: general → *no of*; specific → *of the*.
- ◆ **Direct complaints**: in some cultures a complaint is very indirect (learners may only say "It's a little cold, maybe..."), in others very direct ("This is bad. Change it."). Teach the English middle: soft start + exact problem + polite request.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_18.html. Listen to the model sentences and the Priya and Dan dialogue with 🗣️ and say them aloud. Do the three exercises and the Quick Quiz.

Workbook 6.3: Ex 5 and the project "Write a review" (8+ sentences about a meal, a trip, a store, a class or a movie: one *too*, one *enough*, one *too much / many*, one *so ... that*, one *such (a) ... that*, one *a few / a little*, one *most / some / none of*, "My new words" and the journal (*a few / few* and *a little / little* about your own life).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B She isn't old enough to drive. · Q2 B such an ... that · Q3 (new) B little. Script 6.3-B (😊 / 😞): 1 😊 · 2 😞 · 3 😞 · 4 😊 · 5 😊 · 6 😞 · 7 😊 · 8 😞. Script 6.3-A (Ex 4): good: the food was so delicious that they stayed three hours; the waiter was such a friendly person (he remembered their names) · problems: too small; too many tables / not enough space; too much noise; most of the desserts were sold out (only a few left) · 3 stars · she'd go back on a quiet Tuesday.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C19: MODULE 6 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 20, the three precision questions: **Which one?** (*a / the / no article*) → **Which form?** (*-ing / to*, and the meaning-change verbs) → **How much?** (*too / enough, so / such, a few / few*). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C20 warmer.

Keep it alive. Precision grows slowly. For the rest of the course, use a 2-minute "Editor" warmer once a week: write one sentence from learners' homework with an article or verb-pattern slip and let the class fix it. Keep the C17 board question ("Does my listener know which one?") on a poster on the wall.

Watch for in Module 7: discussion language (*I agree / I'm not sure I agree / That's a good point, but...*) is a natural place to recycle this module: *too* vs *very* when giving opinions ("That's too expensive for most people"), *most of / some of* in summaries ("Most of us think..."), and verb patterns (*I suggest waiting, I refuse to believe...*). The Community Center task is a good bridge.

Module 7 — Real-World Communication

Three practical speaking classes about using English in the situations adults care about. First, a **structured discussion**: giving opinions, agreeing, disagreeing politely and taking turns on everyday community topics. Then **complaints and getting things fixed** with stores, landlords and utility companies, in person, on the phone and by email, with polite escalation to a manager. Last, a **job-interview lab**: describing experience with the present perfect, STAR-style answers, and mock interview panels with observer checklists.

3 lessons

Lessons 7.1–7.3

Classes C20–C22

Weeks 10–11

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- ◆ One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (groups, role-plays, panels) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- ◆ The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes. In this module the freer stage is the biggest stage of every class (20–23 minutes). Protect it: if you run late, cut controlled practice and give the rest for homework.
- ◆ Present from [slides/module-7-real-world.html](#). Print [materials/module-7/classroom-materials.html](#) before C20. It holds the flashcards, discussion topic cards, discussion role cards and talking tokens, Discussion Phrase Bingo, the complaint role-play cards (in person, phone, email), the candidate profile cards, interviewer question cards, the observer checklist and the listening scripts.
- ◆ The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home.
- ◆ **This is a functional module, not a new tense.** The language is mostly fixed **chunks** (*I see your point, but...; Would it be possible to...?; I'm responsible for...*). Teach them as whole phrases and drill them for rhythm and polite intonation. The grammar inside them is recycled: the **present perfect** and **present perfect continuous** (1.1–1.2) for experience, the **passive** (4.1) for describing a problem without blame, and **-ing after prepositions** (6.2) for *good at / responsible for / mind*. Treat these as extension and contrast, not re-teaching.
- ◆ **Building on A2.** A2 Module 7 practiced simple returns ("There's a problem with this jacket. Can I have a refund?"). The new B1 work is **register** (how polite, how formal), **three channels** (in person, phone, email), and **polite escalation**.

- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use some British forms: *favourite, colour, apologise, organisation, organising, practise* (verb), *parcel, mobile, CV*. Teach *favorite, color, apologize, organization, organizing, practice, package, cell phone, résumé*. Accept British forms when learners use them. Note: in online lesson 7.2 Exercise 1, the gap checker accepts only *apologise*. Tell learners that *apologize* is also correct.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Speak up → stand up for yourself → present yourself. In C20 learners take part in a *fair* group discussion: they give an opinion, agree, disagree without offending anyone, and invite quieter people in. In C21 they use the same softening language to *get something fixed*: a broken sink, a double charge, a faulty jacket. They open politely, describe the problem, ask for action and, if needed, ask for a manager. In C22 they present their *own experience* to an employer with confidence and proof (STAR stories). The same idea runs through all three classes: **calm, polite and clear gets results**. Say this at the start of every class.

B1 SPEAKING CLASSES: FLUENCY FIRST, THEN ACCURACY

During the freer tasks, do not stop learners to correct. Walk around with a notepad split into two columns: *Great language I heard* and *Fix it together*. Correct on the spot only if a mistake blocks meaning (the listener can't understand). After the task, give feedback in this order: (1) **content** ("Which group changed their mind? What was the best argument?"), (2) **great language** (read 2–3 good phrases aloud, no names, and praise them), (3) **fix it together**: 3–4 sentences on the board, no names, learners correct in pairs. This keeps confidence high and makes feedback useful.

DOMINANT AND QUIET SPEAKERS: MAKE TURN-TAKING FAIR

Every B1 class has one or two people who talk a lot and a few who never start. This module gives you tools. (1) **Talking tokens** (materials Set C): each person has three. They put one in the middle each time they speak. When your tokens are gone, you wait until everyone has used theirs. (2) **Roles**: give the most talkative learner the **chair** or **observer** role. Their job is to bring others in, not to speak. (3) **Think time**: give 1 minute of silent planning before every discussion, so slower speakers are ready. (4) **Round first**: each person says one sentence before open discussion starts. (5) Praise listening out loud: "Great, you asked Mai what she thinks." Never shame a strong speaker. Say "Hold that thought. Let's hear from someone new first."

TRAUMA-INFORMED AND SAFE: TOPICS, PROBLEMS AND WORK HISTORIES

C20 topics are everyday community topics (public transport, working from home, phones in schools, city vs country, online shopping). **Do not use** politics, religion, immigration, or any topic about a learner's country or identity. If a learner brings one up, redirect kindly: "That's a big topic. Let's keep to our card today." **C21:** problems with a landlord or a utility company can be very real and very stressful (housing, shut-off notices, fear of trouble). The role-plays use **fictional situation cards**. Nobody has to share a real problem. This class teaches **communication, not law**. If a learner has a real housing, billing or safety problem, do not give legal advice. Connect them with your program's case manager or navigator, or local legal aid or a tenant helpline, after class. **C22:** some learners have gaps in their work history, qualifications that are not recognized here, or jobs they don't want to talk about. Say it every time: **"Use your real experience or a candidate profile card. Both are good."** Caregiving, volunteering, farming, a family business and studying all count as experience.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **picture flashcards** (one set for the board): topics (7.1), problems (7.2) and jobs (7.3), plus the word-only phrase cards. Card stock helps.
- ◆ For C20: one set of **discussion topic cards** and one set of **role cards** (chair, timekeeper, observer, summarizer) per group of 4–5. Cut **talking tokens** (3 per learner), or use coins, paper clips or dried beans. One **Discussion Phrase Bingo** card per observer (cards A and B are different).
- ◆ For C21: one set of **complaint role-play cards** per pair (in person and phone), the **email task cards**, and the **escalation cards** (the "I'm afraid I can't do that" staff cards). Set up the room as three stations: a "counter" (a desk), "phone" chairs back to back, and a writing table.
- ◆ For C22: one **candidate profile card** set on a side table, **interviewer question cards** per trio, and **three observer checklists** per learner (one per round). Ask learners in C21 to bring a **real job posting** to C22 if they want (from a job board, a store window or your program's job developer). Bring 3–4 printed postings for people who don't have one.
- ◆ If your program has a **career services team, job developer or WIOA workforce partner**, invite them to be a "guest interviewer" for 20 minutes in C22. Learners love a real interviewer, and it builds a link to services.
- ◆ A toy or real phone for the C21 phone demo helps. Back-to-back chairs make phone role-plays realistic (no lip-reading, no gestures).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
7.1	C20 • wk 10	Opinion openers (<i>In my opinion, It seems to me that, As far as I'm concerned</i>); agreeing (<i>I couldn't agree more, That's a good point</i>); <i>So do I / Neither</i>	take part in a 10-minute structured group discussion on an everyday topic: give a

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		<i>do I</i> ; polite disagreement (acknowledge → but → your view); asking for opinions; softeners (<i>maybe, I suppose, to be honest</i>); turn-taking	reasoned opinion, agree, disagree politely, and invite someone else to speak
7.2	C21 · wk 11	Describing problems (<i>It doesn't work, I was charged twice, It's been leaking since...</i>); passive for no blame; polite openers; the polite ladder (<i>Would it be possible to...? Would you mind + -ing?</i>); staff responses (apology + action); polite escalation (<i>I'd like to speak to a manager</i>); phone and email complaints	make a clear, polite complaint in person, on the phone and by email, ask for a specific fix, and escalate politely if the first person can't help
7.3	C22 · wk 11	Work vocabulary (<i>apply for, position, colleague, deadline, strengths</i>); <i>I've been working as... for / since; responsible for / good at / experience in</i> + noun / -ing; the six classic interview questions; Present → Past → Future; STAR answers (Situation, Task, Action, Result); thinking-time fillers	answer six common interview questions in a mock interview with real or fictional experience, including one STAR story, and give a partner useful feedback with a checklist

7.1 · C20

Agreeing, Disagreeing & Discussion

90 min

OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- give an opinion with a reason, using a variety of openers: *In my opinion, ... · It seems to me that... · As far as I'm concerned, ... · If you ask me, ... · Personally, I feel...*
- agree at different strengths: *Exactly. · I couldn't agree more. · That's a good point. · I know what you mean.* and agree about themselves with *So do I / So am I / Neither do I*
- disagree politely with the pattern **acknowledge → but → my view**: *I see your point, but... · I'm not so sure. · Actually, I think... · That may be true, but...*
- ask for opinions (*What do you think? How do you feel about...?*) and soften (*maybe, I suppose, to be honest, a bit*)
- take part in a fair 10-minute group discussion with a chair, and take turns without interrupting

MATERIALS

- Workbook 7.1 (Useful phrases, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Discussion planner)
- Slides 3–8 · Topic flashcards + word-only phrase cards · **Discussion topic cards + role cards** (1 set per group) · **talking tokens** (3 per learner) · **Discussion Phrase Bingo** (for observers)
- Listening script 7.1-A (Phones at school: a parents' meeting) and 7.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Four columns:  **OPINION** *In my opinion, ... / It seems to me that... / As far as I'm concerned, ...* · 

AGREE *Exactly. / I couldn't agree more. / That's a good point. / So do I.* ·  **DISAGREE POLITELY** *I see your point, but... / I'm not so sure. / Actually, I think...* ·  **ASK** *What do you think, ...? / How do you feel about...?*

Under the columns: 1 **acknowledge** → 2 **but** → 3 **my view**. "I see your point, **but** I think the cost is too high."

Right corner: softeners: *maybe · I suppose · to be honest · a bit · kind of*. Golden rule: **attack the idea, not the person**.  I'm agree →  I agree.

STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: our town	8	S–S	Review C19 (6.3, too / enough, so / such, few / little). Pairs finish 4 sentences about the town where they live now (or a town

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			they know): "The buses are too... · There aren't enough... · It's such a... · There are very few..." Two pairs share one sentence. Write two on the board. They become today's first discussion ideas (e.g. "There aren't enough buses at night.").
Lead-in: opinion line	6	T-S (whole class)	Put a paper line on the floor (or point to two walls): Strongly agree ↔ Strongly disagree . Read a light statement: "Public transport in this town is good enough." Learners stand where they are. Ask 2–3 people "Why are you here?" Don't teach yet. Just notice what they say. Most will say "I think..." or "Yes / No." Say: "Today you'll get 20 new ways to say this."
Opinions + agreeing	12	T-S → S	Slides 3–4. Opinion openers (register: casual → careful). Form after each opener (see notes). Then agreeing at three strengths and <i>So do I / Neither do I</i> . CCQs on <i>I couldn't agree more</i> . Drill (see script). Stick the word-only phrase cards into the four board columns as you go.
Disagreeing politely + softeners	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 5–6. The three-step pattern. Show a blunt reply ("No. You're wrong.") and a polite one on the slide. Ask: "Which person will listen to you?" CCQs on <i>actually</i> (not "now"). Softeners, then "Ask" phrases. Quick pair drill: A reads a strong opinion from the slide, B disagrees politely using the pattern. Swap.
Listening: phones at school	10	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 7.1-A twice (or with a confident learner as a second voice). First listen: "How many people agree with a phone ban in class?" (all of them, in the end). Second listen: the questions. Pairs compare, then find one phrase from each column of the board in the script.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (agree or disagree?), Ex 3 (complete the discussion), Ex 4 (So do I / Neither do I) and Ex 5 (make it polite) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start the Discussion planner.
Freer: structured discussion	20	S-S (groups of 4-5) → T-S	Slide 8. Groups get a topic card and role cards (chair, timekeeper, observer, summarizer, + speakers) and 3 talking tokens each. (1) Silent planning with the Discussion planner: my opinion + reason + one question to ask (2 min). (2) Round: the chair asks each person for one opinion; no replies yet (2 min). (3) Open discussion, 6 minutes; the observer plays Phrase Bingo. (4) The summarizer reports: "Most of us think... but Ana doesn't agree because..." (1 min per group). (5) Rotate roles and topic cards; round 2 (6 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first: "Did anyone change their mind?" Observers read their bingo lines. Then great language (2-3 phrases you heard). Then delayed correction: 4 sentences on the board, no names ("I'm agree with Tom." · "Actually, I live here since 2019." · "So am I." after "I like it"). Pairs fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.1 on screen; point at the 🗣️ buttons on the Nadia / Tom / Priya discussion. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box. Ask learners to bring a real job posting to C22 if they want.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 12 + 12 + 10 + 12 + 20 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: opinion openers. They all mean "this is my view, not a fact." They differ in **register**: *If you ask me* is casual; *In my opinion* is neutral to formal; *It seems to me that* is careful and thoughtful; *As far as I'm*

concerned is a strong personal view.

SAY: "In my opinion, cities are too crowded." Is this a fact? (No, an opinion.) Can another person think differently? (Yes.) · "If you ask me, the country is more relaxing." Would you say this in a job interview or to a friend? (To a friend. It's casual.)

Meaning: I couldn't agree more. This is the strongest agreement, even though it has *couldn't*.

SAY: "I couldn't agree more." Is it negative or positive? (Positive.) Do I agree a little or completely? (Completely.) Is it the same as "I couldn't care less"? (No! That means "I'm not interested at all.")

Meaning: polite disagreement. First show that you heard the other person, then give your view.

SAY: "I see your point, but I think the cost is too high." Do I agree? (No, not really.) Did I listen to the other person? (Yes: "I see your point.") Is it rude? (No.) · "Actually, I find the city quite relaxing." Does "actually" mean "now"? (No. It means "in fact," and it softens a different opinion.)

Form.

Opener + comma	In my opinion, / As far as I'm concerned, / If you ask me, / Personally, + sentence	In my opinion, the buses are too slow.
Opener + (that) clause	I think (that) / It seems to me that / I feel (that) + subject + verb	It seems to me that both sides have a point.
agree = a verb	I agree (with you / with that). · I don't agree. (never "I'm agree")	I agree with Priya.
So / Neither	+ statement → So + auxiliary + I · – statement → Neither + auxiliary + I	I love it. → So do I. · I'm tired. → So am I. · I can't cook. → Neither can I. · I don't drive. → Neither do I.
Disagree	acknowledge + but + your view	That may be true, but it's very expensive.

Pronunciation. In English, **tone carries politeness**. A flat, low voice sounds rude even with polite words. Model a wide, warm pitch. *I see your POINT* ↘ ↗, *but...* has a fall-rise on *point*: it says "there's more coming." Stress: *I couldn't agree MORE*; *oPINion*; *ACTually* /'æk.tʃu.ə.li/ (3–4 syllables, not "ak-TWAL-ly"); *NEither* /'ni:.ðə/ in American English (/ˈnaɪ.ðə/ is also fine). *So do I* stresses **I**: "So do I."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Phrase rhythm (choral):** "In my o-PIN-ion" ×3 · "I couldn't agree MORE" ×3 (big smile) · "I see your POINT, but..." ×3 (fall-rise) · "I'm not SO sure" ×3. Half the room, then 4–5 individuals.

- 2 **Same opinion, new opener:** T: "The buses are too slow. Casual!" → S: "If you ask me, the buses are too slow." T: "Careful!" → S: "It seems to me that the buses are too slow." T: "Strong!" → S: "As far as I'm concerned, the buses are too slow."
- 3 **So / Neither quick-fire** (point at learners): T: "I love coffee." → S: "So do I." · "I'm hungry." → "So am I." · "I don't like the rain." → "Neither do I." · "I can't swim." → "Neither can I." · "I've been to the new library." → "So have I."
- 4 **Blunt → polite transformation:** T (in a flat voice): "No. That's wrong." → S: "I'm not so sure about that." · T: "You're wrong. It's expensive." → S: "I see your point, but it's quite expensive." · T: "Bad idea." → S: "Maybe, but don't you think...?"
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1: "In my opinion, everyone should learn to cook. What do you think, Ali?" → S2 agrees or disagrees politely, then gives a new opinion and asks S3. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ STRUCTURED DISCUSSION – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 4–5.** Mix first languages and mix strong and quieter speakers. Each group gets one topic card (two sides + idea prompts) and a role card for each person.
- ◆ **Roles:** **Chair** starts, asks every person, and stops interruptions ("Let's hear from Mai first."). **Timekeeper** says "Two minutes left." **Observer** listens, ticks Phrase Bingo and does not speak (give this role to a dominant speaker in round 1). **Summarizer** reports the result. In a group of 5, the fifth person is a speaker only. Everyone except the observer gives opinions.
- ◆ **Talking tokens:** 3 each. Put one in the middle every time you speak. When yours are gone, you listen until everyone has used theirs, then everyone takes their 3 back.
- ◆ **Each speaker must:** give one opinion with a reason, agree once, disagree politely once, ask someone "What do you think?", and use one softener. It's on their Discussion planner.
- ◆ **No "winner."** The goal is to hear everyone and try to find a shared idea, or "agree to disagree" politely.
- ◆ Round 2: rotate roles clockwise and pass the topic card to the next group.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DISCUSSION

SAY: *Who asks everyone for their opinion? (The chair.) · Does the observer talk? (No, the observer listens and ticks bingo.) · What do you do with a token? (Put it in the middle when I speak.) · No tokens left: can you speak? (No, I wait.) · How do you disagree? (Say "I see your point, but..." first.) · Is there a winner? (No.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **phrase strip** with four phrases only, one per column and with an icon: 🗨️ "I think... because..." · 👍 "That's a good point." · 🙄 "I see your point, but..." · ❓ "What do you think?" Learners point to the phrase as they say it. Use the topic cards with a picture (bus, phone, desk) and read the card aloud to the group. Target: one opinion with *because*, one agreement and one polite disagreement. The timekeeper role is a good first role (it needs little reading).

STRETCH

Use the more careful openers (*It seems to me that...*, *As far as I'm concerned...*) and **concede then counter**: "That may be true, **however**, ..." Add a **second conditional** (2.2) to argue: "If buses were free, more people would leave their cars at home." As summarizer, report with **reported speech** (3.1): "Tom said that he missed his colleagues." Early finishers write a 4-sentence opinion paragraph for their topic.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "I'm agree" / "I am agree with you": Spanish *estoy de acuerdo*, Portuguese *estou de acordo*, French *je suis d'accord*, Russian *я согласен* (an adjective form). Teach: **agree** is a verb. "I agree. · I don't agree." Board it, and use a hand signal (cross out "am").
- ◆ "Actually" = **now**: Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, Portuguese *atualmente*, Italian *attualmente*, German *aktuell* all mean "currently." "Actually I work in a hotel" may mean "Currently...". Recast: "Oh, you mean **currently** / **right now**."
- ◆ "According to me" / "In my opinion, I think...": French *selon moi*, South Asian English. Use one opener, not two.
- ◆ "Me too" after a negative: "I don't like rain." — "Me too." Teach "**Me neither**" (informal) and "**Neither do I**."
- ◆ "We discussed about it": Spanish *discutir sobre*, French *discuter de*, Arabic. *Discuss* takes a direct object: "We discussed the topic." Also, Spanish *discutir* can mean "argue." In English, a discussion is calm.
- ◆ **Directness differs**. Some learners (e.g. German, Dutch, Russian, Hebrew speakers) may sound blunt in English with a flat "No, this is wrong." Others (e.g. many Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Vietnamese and Filipino learners) may avoid disagreeing at all and say "maybe" to mean "no." Neither is wrong. Teach the English middle: **disagree, but cushion it**. Say clearly that polite disagreement is welcome in this class.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_19.html. Listen to the Nadia / Tom / Priya discussion with 🎧 and read one speaker's part aloud with the audio. Do the three exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 7.1: finish the Discussion planner for a new topic, "My new words" and the journal (an opinion without "I think" + a polite disagreement).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I see your point, but I think we should wait a little longer. · Q2 **B** So do I. · Q3 (new) **B** I agree with you.

Phones at school (Ex 1): 1 David · 2 Grace, "I couldn't agree more." · 3 parents need to contact their children, e.g. when the bus is late · 4 it depends on the age · 5 no phones in class · softeners: maybe, to be honest, I suppose.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- describe a problem clearly: *It doesn't work.* · *It's faulty.* · *It's the wrong size.* · *I was charged twice.* · *It hasn't arrived yet.* · *The sink has been leaking since Monday.*
- use the **passive** to describe a problem without blaming a person: *I was overcharged* (not "You overcharged me")
- make a complaint in **three parts**: soft opener → problem → polite request (*Would it be possible to...?* · *Could you...?* · *Would you mind + -ing...?* · *I'd appreciate it if you could...*)
- respond to a complaint as staff with **apology + action**, and **escalate politely** as a customer: *I understand, but I'd like to speak to a manager, please.*
- complain on the **phone** (spell names, give numbers, ask for a reference number) and in a short **email** (*I'm writing to complain about...*)

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 7.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Complaint planner)
- Slides 9–13 · Problem flashcards · **Complaint role-play cards** (in person + phone, A/B) · **escalation cards** · **email task cards** · a toy phone
- Listening scripts 7.2-A (Ana calls the building manager), 7.2-B (Mr. Osei calls the power company) and 7.2-C (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the 3 parts. 1 🧸 Soft opener: I'm sorry to bother you, but... / I'm afraid there's been a mistake. → 2 🔍 Problem: The heating doesn't work. / I was charged twice. → 3 🙏 Request: Would it be possible to...? / Could you...?

Center: the polite ladder (top = softest): Would it be possible to **send**...? · Would you mind **sending**...? · I'd appreciate it if you **could send**... · Could you **send**...? · Can you...? · ~~Send it!~~

Right: no blame → You charged me twice ❌ → I **was charged** twice ✅. **Staff** = sorry + action: I do apologize. I'll sort that out right away. **Still no?** → I understand, but I'd like to speak to a manager, please. 📞 Ask for: name · reference number · date.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: agree or	7	S–S	Review C20. Read 4 statements about everyday annoyances: "Waiting on

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
disagree?			hold is the worst thing about modern life." · "Self-checkout machines are better than cashiers." · "It's OK to complain in a restaurant." · "Online reviews are useful." Pairs react with the C20 phrases: opener, agree, or polite disagreement. Listen for "I'm agree" and <i>So do I / Neither do I</i> .
Lead-in: what went wrong?	6	T-S → S-S	Slide 9: problem pictures (remote, bill, jacket, sink, shower, fridge). "What's the problem?" Learners guess: "It's broken. There's no hot water." Pairs: "Has anything like this happened to you, or to someone you know?" (real or invented; "Pass" is fine). Two pairs share. Ask: "Did it get fixed? How?"
Describe + open politely	12	T-S → S	Slides 9–10. Problem phrases, including <i>has been leaking since</i> (1.2 recycle) and the passive for no blame (4.1 recycle). Then soft openers and <i>I'm afraid</i> (CCQs). Drill steps 1–2.
Ask for action + staff + escalate	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 10–11. The polite ladder (form after each step). Staff: apology + action. Then escalation and the three channels (in person / phone / email). Phone skills: spelling names and numbers, "Could I have a reference number?" Drill steps 3–5.
Listening: two phone calls	10	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 7.2-A (Ana and the building manager) twice: learners complete the repair note. Then Script 7.2-B (Mr. Osei and the power company): learners answer the questions. Pairs compare. Ask: "When did Mr. Osei ask for a supervisor? What exactly did he say?"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (soften the rude complaint), Ex 3 (complete the complaint) and Ex 4 (match problem and request). Check in pairs. Ex 5 (the email) is homework. Show its layout on slide 11 now.
Freer: complaint carousel	23	S-S (pairs, 3 stations) → T-S	Slide 13. Three stations, about 6 minutes each, then pairs move. Counter (in person): store or restaurant cards. Phone (back-to-back chairs): landlord, internet or delivery cards. Here the staff card sometimes says "I'm afraid I can't...", so the caller must escalate politely ; the partner then turns over the card and plays the manager. Desk (writing): pairs write a 5-line complaint email from an email task card, then swap with another pair, who reply as the company (apology + action). A and B swap roles at every station. 5 min feedback in the next stage. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content: "Who got a refund? Who got a manager? Who got a reference number?" Great language: read 2-3 polite requests you heard. Delayed correction on the board: "I want that you give me refund." · "The sink is leaking since Monday." · "Would you mind to check?" · "You charged me two times!" Pairs fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.2 and the hotel dialogue 🗣️. Set the homework (below), including Ex 5, the email. Remind learners: bring a job posting to C22 if you want (real or from the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			teacher's pile). Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		7 + 6 + 12 + 12 + 10 + 10 + 23 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: why polite works. A polite complaint separates the **problem** from the **person**. The staff member is not the enemy. They are the person who can fix it.

SAY: "I'm afraid there's been a mistake with my bill." Am I scared? (No!) What does "I'm afraid" do? (It softens bad news.) Is it a complaint? (Yes, a polite one.) · "I was charged twice." Who charged me? (We don't say. The company, the machine.) Why don't we say "You charged me"? (It blames the person. It makes them defensive.)

SAY: "Would it be possible to get a refund?" Is it a question or an order? (A question, so it's polite.) Is it very polite or a little polite? (Very polite.) · "Would you mind checking my order?" If the answer is "Not at all," is it yes or no? (Yes! "Not at all" = "I don't mind. I'll do it.")

Meaning: escalation. If the first person can't help, you ask for someone with more power. You stay calm, and you don't blame the first person.

SAY: "I understand, but I'd like to speak to a manager, please." Am I angry? (No, calm.) Is the first person bad? (No, they just can't help.) What do I say first? ("I understand" = I heard you.)

Form.

Problem	It doesn't work. · It's faulty / broken. · It's the wrong size. · It hasn't arrived yet. · The sink has been leaking since Monday.	present perfect (continuous) for "started in the past, still a problem"
No blame (passive)	I was charged twice. · My card was declined . · The room hasn't been cleaned .	be + past participle
+ base verb	Could you check ...? · Would it be possible to send ...? · I'd appreciate it if you could fix ...	Can / Could / possible to / could + base verb
+ -ing	Would you mind sending a new one?	<i>mind</i> + -ing (6.2)
Escalate	I understand, but I'd like to speak to a manager / supervisor, please. · Is there anyone else who could help me?	acknowledge + but + request

Email	Dear... / I'm writing to complain about... / On (date), I... / I would appreciate it if you could... / I look forward to hearing from you. / Sincerely,	more formal: no contractions needed
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Pronunciation. Polite intonation again: a high start and a gentle fall on requests. "Would it be **POSS**ible to get a **reFUND**?" Linking: "I'm a**FRAID**" /aɪmə'freɪd/; "Would you mind" /wʊdʒə 'maɪnd/. Word stress: **RE**fund (noun) vs re**FUND** (verb); com**PLAINT** vs com**PLAIN**: the final /t/ matters. Phone English: spell letters in groups and use a check word: "S for Sam." Say numbers one by one: "four-four-oh-nine."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Back-chain the opener:** "a problem with my bill" → "there's a problem with my bill" → "I'm afraid there's a problem with my bill" → "I'm sorry to bother you, but I'm afraid there's a problem with my bill." Choral ×3, halves, then individuals.
- 2 Active → passive (no blame):** T: "You charged me twice." → S: "I was charged twice." · "You didn't clean the room." → "The room wasn't cleaned." · "You sent the wrong size." → "I was sent the wrong size." / "The wrong size was sent."
- 3 Climb the ladder:** T holds up a flashcard (jacket) and says "Refund!" → S1: "Can I get a refund?" → S2: "Could I get a refund, please?" → S3: "Would it be possible to get a refund?" → S4: "Would you mind giving me a refund?"
- 4 Staff reply chain:** T (as customer): "My food is cold." → S: "I'm terribly sorry about that. I'll heat it up right away." Everyone must say an apology **and** an action.
- 5 Phone spelling:** learners spell their first name (or a card name) and a 6-digit "account number" to a partner, who writes it and reads it back: "So that's O-S-E-I, four-four-oh-nine-one-eight?"

◆ COMPLAINT CAROUSEL – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Three stations**, labeled on the wall:  COUNTER ·  PHONE ·  DESK. Pairs start at different stations and move clockwise every 6–7 minutes when you ring a bell or clap.
- ◆ **Counter and Phone:** A takes a customer card, B the matching staff card. B's card tells B how helpful to be. Some staff cards say "You can't give a refund. Say: I'm afraid I can't do that." A must stay polite and escalate: "I understand, but could I speak to a manager, please?" B then turns over the card and becomes the manager, who fixes the problem. Swap roles for the next card.
- ◆ **Phone rules:** chairs back to back, no gestures. The caller must give a name (spell it) and a number, and must end by asking for a **reference number** or the **staff member's name**, and by confirming: "So someone is coming on Saturday at ten."
- ◆ **Desk:** the pair writes one complaint email together (5–6 lines) from an email task card, using the Workbook Ex 5 frame. Then they swap emails with another pair at the desk and write a 2-line reply as the company: apology + action.

- ◆ Keep it realistic but **light**: fictional names, fictional numbers. Nobody needs to use their real address or account.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CAROUSEL

SAY: *What are the three parts of a complaint? (Soft opener, the problem, a polite request.) · At the phone station, can you see your partner? (No, we sit back to back.) · Staff card says "I can't." What does the customer say? ("I understand, but I'd like to speak to a manager, please.") · Do you shout? (No!) · What do you ask for at the end of a phone call? (A reference number or a name.) · When do you move? (When the teacher claps.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use the picture cards (remote, jacket, sink, bill) as the "situation" instead of the text cards. Give a 3-line **complaint strip**: 🧸 "Excuse me, I'm sorry to bother you." · 🔍 "This ___ doesn't work." · 🙏 "Could you help me, please?" plus one escalation line: "Could I speak to a manager, please?" Pair with a supportive partner who plays staff. At the desk station, the learner **dictates** and the partner writes, or the learner copies the frame and fills 2 gaps. Target: one complete 3-part complaint, in person and on the phone.

STRETCH

Use the top of the ladder (*Would it be possible...? · I'd appreciate it if...*) and give details: dates, amounts, what you've already done ("I've already called twice"). Negotiate: when staff offer a weak solution (a coupon), politely ask for a better one ("That's kind, but I'd really prefer a refund."). Write the email in full formal style, including a clear deadline: "I would appreciate a reply by Friday, May 9."

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "The sink is leaking since Monday" / "I wait since two hours": Spanish *desde hace*, French *depuis*, German *seit* + present. Recast with the present perfect (continuous): "It's **been leaking since** Monday." · "I've **been waiting for** two hours." (1.2 recycle).
- ◆ "I want that you give me a refund": Spanish *quiero que me dé*, French *je veux que*, Portuguese. Teach *I'd like you to...* or, better, the polite ladder. "I want..." in English sounds like a demand. In some languages (e.g. Russian, Arabic, German) a direct request is neutral, so learners don't hear the problem. Explain it without judgment.
- ◆ "Would you mind to check?" (many L1s): *mind* + **-ing**. Link to 6.2 verb patterns.
- ◆ "Do a complaint" / "complain for": Spanish *hacer una queja / quejarse de*, Arabic. It's **make** a complaint; **complain about** something, **complain to** a person.

- ◆ **Letters on the phone:** Spanish b/v, Arabic p/b, Japanese and Korean l/r, and the vowels A / E / I (Spanish and Italian speakers say A as /a/, E as /e/, I as /i/). Teach the English letter names A /eɪ/, E /i:/, I /aɪ/, G /dʒi:/, J /dʒeɪ/, and a check word: "B as in Boy."
- ◆ **Final consonants** (Vietnamese, Cantonese, Thai, some Spanish speakers): "complain" vs "complaint," "charge" vs "charged." In a complaint, "I was **charged**" without /d/ sounds like the present. Drill the endings.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_20.html. Listen to the hotel complaint with 🎧 and read the guest's lines aloud, then the receptionist's. Do the three exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 7.2: Ex 5 (a complaint email, 6–8 lines), "My new words" and the journal. Optional: find a real job posting and bring it to C22.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I'm afraid this kettle is faulty. Would it be possible to replace it? · Q2 **C** I'm terribly sorry about that — I'll sort it out right away. · Q3 (new) **B** I understand, but I'd like to speak to a manager, please. Ex 1 (7.2-A): kitchen sink · leaking since Monday · a bucket · Saturday at 10 a.m. · R-257. (7.2-B): charged twice · \$86 · the agent couldn't give refunds · refund in 5–7 days · an email to confirm.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use work vocabulary: *apply for, position / role, colleague, deadline, responsibilities, skills, strengths, weaknesses, experience*
- ◆ describe their work with the present perfect: *I've been working as a... for three years / since 2021. · I've worked in two warehouses.*
- ◆ use *I'm responsible for / My job involves / I have experience in / I'm good at + noun or -ing*
- ◆ answer "Tell me about yourself" with **Present → Past → Future**, and a "Tell me about a time..." question with a **STAR** story (Situation, Task, Action, Result)
- ◆ take part in a mock interview panel as candidate, interviewer and observer, and give kind, useful feedback with a checklist

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.3 (New words, Grammar box, STAR box, Exercises 1–6, dialogue, Interview planner)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Job flashcards · **candidate profile cards** (side table) · **interviewer question cards** (1 set per trio) · **observer checklists** (3 per learner) · job postings (learners' own + 3–4 printed)
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.3-A (Samuel's interview) and 7.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: my experience. *I've been working* as a cook **for** three years / **since** 2021. · *I've worked* in two restaurants. · *I'm responsible for* **training**... · *I'm good at* **solving**... · *I have experience* **in** customer service. (preposition + **-ing** / noun)

Center: Tell me about yourself = NOW (*I'm currently...*) → BEFORE (*I've...* / *Before that, I...*) → NEXT (*Now I'm looking for...* which is why I applied for this position.)

Right: STAR ★ **Situation** (when, where) · **Task** (what I had to do) · **Action** (what I did: past simple verbs!) · **Result** (what happened + what I learned). Fillers: "That's a good question." · "Let me think for a moment."

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: fix the blunt complaint	5	S-S (teams)	Review C21. Two teams. Write 4 blunt lines on the board ("Fix my heater!" · "You charged me twice!" · "Get me your boss!" · "Send it faster!"). Teams race to

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			make each one polite; one point per correct polite version. Accept any correct ladder step.
Lead-in: jobs and experience	6	T-S → S-S	Slide 14: job pictures. "What does this person do? What are they responsible for?" Then tell a short, true story about your first job ("I've been teaching for... Before that, I worked in a café. I was responsible for..."). Pairs: "What jobs have you done? Paid, unpaid, at home, volunteering, all count." Real or a candidate profile card.
Describing experience	11	T-S → S	Slide 15. Work vocabulary (CCQs on <i>colleague</i> , <i>deadline</i> , <i>position</i>). Present perfect for experience: <i>for</i> / <i>since</i> , simple vs continuous (1.1–1.2 recycle, quickly). Preposition + -ing (6.2 recycle). Drill steps 1–3.
Interview questions + STAR	11	T-S → S-S	Slides 16–17. The six classic questions and what the interviewer really wants to know. Present → Past → Future for "Tell me about yourself." STAR for "Tell me about a time when..." (label a model answer S / T / A / R together). The "weakness" trick: small + improving. Fillers for thinking time. Drill steps 4–5.
Listening: Samuel's interview	8	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 7.3-A twice (a learner can read the interviewer). First listen: "Does Samuel get nervous? Which filler does he use?" Second listen: the questions, including the four STAR parts of his snowstorm story.
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (complete the answers), Ex 3 (preposition or -ing), Ex 4 (match question and answer) and Ex 5 (put a STAR story in order). Check in pairs.
Prepare: my answers	8	S (+ T support)	Workbook Ex 6 / Interview planner. Each learner chooses a job: the posting they brought, a printed one, or the job on a candidate profile card. They write notes (not full sentences) for Present → Past → Future, one strength + example, one STAR story, one weakness + improving, one question for the interviewer. Walk around and help with ideas. Say: "Volunteering, caregiving and family businesses are real experience."

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer: mock interview panels	22	S-S (trios) → T-S	Slide 18. Trios: interviewer (question cards), candidate , observer (checklist). Each interview: 5 minutes, then 1–2 minutes of observer feedback ("One thing that was great... One tip..."). Rotate roles three times so everyone does each role once. ICQs first. If you have a guest interviewer, they join one trio per round.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content: "Who told a great STAR story? What was the Result?" Great language: 2–3 strong answers you heard. Delayed correction: "I have 5 years working here." · "I'm responsible of the team." · "I'm good in to organize." · "I work as nurse." Pairs fix them.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.3 and Marco's interview 🎧. Set the homework (below). Mention real-world next steps: your program's career services, résumé help and job fairs. Learners tick "I can...".
Total	90		5 + 6 + 11 + 11 + 8 + 9 + 8 + 22 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: present perfect for experience. It links your past work to *now*. The interviewer wants to know what you bring today.

SAY: "I've been working as a cook for three years." Did I start in the past? (Yes, three years ago.) Am I still a cook? (Yes.) · "I worked as a cook in 2019." Am I a cook now? (We don't know. Maybe not.) · "I've been working here since 2021." Is 2021 a length of time or a start point? (A start point, so since.)

SAY: "A colleague" — is it my boss? (Not usually. A person I work with.) · "The deadline is Friday." Can I finish on Saturday? (No! Friday is the last day.) · "I applied for the position." Is a position a place? (No, a job.)

Meaning: STAR. Interviewers often say "Tell me about a time when..." They want a short true story that **proves** a skill.

SAY: In STAR, what is A? (Action: what I did.) Do we say "we" or "I" in the Action? (Mostly "I." The interviewer is hiring you!) What tense is the story? (The past simple: I called, I planned, I finished.) Does the story need a Result? (Yes, a good end, and maybe what I learned.)

Form.

How long (still true)	I've been working as a... for + time / since + start · I've had this job for two years.	for three years · since 2021 · since I moved here
Experience (up to now)	I've worked in three restaurants. · I've trained six new colleagues.	no finished time word
Preposition + -ing / noun	responsible for · experience in · good at · involves (+ -ing)	I'm responsible for training new staff. · I'm good at solving problems.
apply	apply for a job / position · apply to a company	I applied for the driver position.
STAR story	S: Last year, when I was working at... · T: I had to... · A: I (past simple)... · R: In the end,... / I learned...	past continuous (5.2) for the background, past simple for the actions

Pronunciation. Word stress: ex**PER**ience · re**SPON**sible · responsi**BIL**ity · **COL**league · po**SIT**ion · **INT**erview · **DEAD**line. Contractions sound confident: "I've been" /aɪv biːn/ (don't drop the /v/: "I been working" ✗). Past endings in STAR stories: *called* /d/, *fixed* /t/, *planned* /d/, *delivered* /d/, *started* /ɪd/. Speak slowly, and pause after each STAR part. A pause sounds confident, not nervous.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 for / since quick-fire:** T: "three years" → S: "for three years." · "2021" → "since 2021." · "last March" → "since last March." · "six months" → "for six months." · "I was 18" → "since I was 18."
- 2 Build the sentence (back-chain):** "for three years" → "as a cook for three years" → "I've been working as a cook for three years." Choral, then each learner with their own job (or card job).
- 3 Preposition + -ing:** T: "responsible for... train" → S: "I'm responsible for training new staff." · "good at... organize" → "I'm good at organizing." · "experience in... sales" → "I have experience in sales." · "My job involves... deal with customers" → "My job involves dealing with customers."
- 4 STAR relay (groups of 4):** T gives a skill ("working under pressure"). S1 says the Situation, S2 the Task, S3 the Action, S4 the Result. Then the group says the whole story together. Do it twice with different skills.
- 5 Filler + answer:** T fires a hard question ("What's your biggest weakness?"). S must start with a filler ("That's a good question. Let me think...") and then give one sentence. Fast, fun, 6–8 learners.

◆ MOCK INTERVIEW PANELS – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Trios** (a group of four works: two observers). Each trio gets one set of interviewer question cards. Every learner has 3 observer checklists.
- ◆ **Interviewer:** welcomes the candidate ("Thanks for coming in."), asks 5–6 questions from the cards, including one "Tell me about a time..." card, and closes ("Thank you. We'll be in touch."). Encourage a

real follow-up question: "Can you tell me more about that?"

- ◆ **Candidate:** greets and thanks, answers from their notes (not reading full sentences), uses a filler if they need time, tells one STAR story, and asks one question at the end. Candidates using a **profile card** answer as that person. Nobody has to explain why.
- ◆ **Observer:** ticks the checklist and writes **one great thing + one tip**, then gives this feedback kindly in 1–2 minutes. Tips must be specific ("Add a Result to your story."), not general ("Speak better.").
- ◆ **Ground rules for interviewers:** use only the question cards. No questions about age, family, religion, home country or immigration status. Real interviewers should not ask most of these either. If a learner wants to practice answering one, see the stretch box.
- ◆ Rotate roles every 7 minutes (5 interview + 2 feedback). If time is short, run two rounds and let the third role be homework with a family member or friend.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PANELS

SAY: *How many roles are there? (Three: interviewer, candidate, observer.) · Does the candidate read full sentences? (No, just look at notes.) · What does the observer write? (One great thing and one tip.) · Which question needs a STAR story? ("Tell me about a time...") · What does the candidate do at the end? (Ask a question.) · Can you use a profile card? (Yes.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **fill-in answer card**: "I'm a _____. I've been working as a _____ for _____ years. I'm good at _____ing. Now I'm looking for a job as a _____." Use the job flashcards as prompts (nurse, cook, cleaner, driver, mechanic). The interviewer reads only 3 question cards (Tell me about yourself / What are your strengths? / Do you have any questions?). The STAR story can be spoken with 4 pictures or icons the learner draws (☔ → 📦 → 📞 → ✅). Target: Present → Past → Future in 3 sentences + one question at the end.

STRETCH

Answer the harder cards: "Tell me about a time you disagreed with a colleague" (use 7.1 language in the story!) and "Why did you leave your last job?" (stay positive, no blame). Practice a polite redirect for an inappropriate question: "I'm not sure how that relates to the job, but I can tell you that I'm available for all the shifts." Use *would like to* and future forms (5.3) for "Where do you see yourself in five years?" Write a 4-line thank-you email after the interview.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I have 5 years working here" / "I work here since 2019" / "since five years":** Spanish *tengo / llevo cinco años*, French *depuis*, German *seit*, Portuguese *há cinco anos*. Recast: "I've **been working** here for five years / **since** 2019."

- ◆ "responsible of" / "experience on" / "good in": Spanish and French *responsable de*, Russian *опыт в* (sometimes "on"). Drill the chunks: responsible **for**, experience **in**, good **at**.
- ◆ "I'm good at to cook" / "responsible for to train" (most L1s): after a preposition, **-ing**. Link to 6.2.
- ◆ "I work as nurse" (Arabic, Chinese, Russian, Korean, Japanese: no articles; Spanish and French: no article with jobs, *soy enfermera*). English needs **a**: "as **a** nurse." Link to 6.1.
- ◆ "My **actual** job" = current job (Spanish *actual*, French *actuel*). Recast: "my **current** job." It's the *actually* false friend from C20 again.
- ◆ **Talking about yourself**: in many cultures (e.g. Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Vietnamese, Filipino, many African cultures) praising yourself feels rude, so learners say "I'm not so good." In US interviews, modesty can sound like a lack of skill. Teach it as a **genre rule**, not a personality change: "In an interview you're informing, not bragging. Give proof with an example." Eye contact and handshakes vary too. They're not required in class, and a warm "Nice to meet you" works everywhere.

WORKFORCE LINK (WIOA AND CAREER-PATHWAY PROGRAMS)

This class is a natural bridge to employment services. Keep the **observer checklists**: they're good evidence of workplace-readiness skills for a learner portfolio. Invite learners to repeat the mock interview with your program's career services staff or job developer. Learners' Interview planners can become the base for a résumé "Summary" line. Remind learners that **transferable skills** count: a parent who manages a family budget "has experience in budgeting." A person who helped at a mosque, church or community kitchen "has experience in food preparation and working in a team."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_21.html. Listen to Marco's interview with 🎧 and answer the interviewer's questions out loud in your own words. Do the three exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 7.3: finish Ex 6 (write your "Tell me about yourself" + one STAR story), "My new words" and the journal. Say your answers out loud three times, or record them on your phone and listen.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I'm responsible for managing the team. · Q2 **C** I'm good at working under pressure — for example... · Q3 (new) **B** since. Samuel (Ex 1): 1 delivery driver, about two years · 2 in a supermarket · 3 he likes being active, he's good at organizing, forklift training · 4 **S**: a snowstorm closed a road · **T**: 15 deliveries before 6 · **A**: called his supervisor, planned a new route with a map app, phoned customers · **R**: delivered every package; two customers wrote nice reviews · 5 getting nervous speaking in meetings; he's been taking an English class and practicing speaking up · 6 what the training looks like for new staff.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C22: MODULE 7 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 19: **speak up** (I see your point, but...) → **stand up for yourself** (I'm afraid there's been a mistake. Would it be possible to...?) → **present yourself** (I've been working as... For example...). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C23 warmer.

Watch for in Module 8: 8.1 (question tags and keeping a conversation going) builds directly on C20's "asking" phrases: *...don't you think?* · *...isn't it?*. 8.3 is a **presentation and panel discussion**: reuse the C20 role cards (chair, timekeeper, observer) and talking tokens, and the C22 observer-checklist idea for peer feedback. Keep the talking tokens in a bag in the classroom.

Final assessment (C26) covers Modules 1–8. From this module, the speaking interview can include: giving and defending an opinion politely, a short complaint role-play (open → problem → request → escalate), and "Tell me about yourself" with the present perfect. The writing section may include a short complaint email.

Module 8 — Fluency & the Final Project

The last three classes of B1 are about sounding natural and keeping talk alive. In C23 learners use **question tags** (with the right intonation) and **interested responses**, **follow-up questions** and **backchanneling** to keep a conversation going. In C24 they build a practical set of **phrasal verbs** for work, home and relationships, and master the **separable / inseparable** rule. In C25 there is no new grammar: each learner gives a **3–4 minute presentation** and takes part in a **panel discussion**. You observe with a checklist that feeds the C26 final speaking assessment.

3 lessons

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

Weeks 12–13

90 min per class

CEFR B1

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- ◆ One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C25 is a task-based class: pre-task → planning → rehearsal → task → report.
- ◆ The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- ◆ Present from [slides/module-8-final-project.html](#). Print [materials/module-8/classroom-materials.html](#) before C23. It holds the flashcards, the intonation arrow cards, the small-talk mingle cards, the "Sort It Out" A/B cards, the **Split or Stick?** sorting game, the phrasal-verb talk cards, the presentation topic cards, the panel role cards, the presentation rubric, the listening scripts and the **teacher observation checklist**.
- ◆ The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home.
- ◆ **Extension, not a first meeting.** Learners know auxiliaries from every question they have ever asked, *Let's...* from A2, and a few phrasal verbs (*get up, turn on, look for*) since A1. The new B1 work is the **tag system** and its intonation, the conversation "tools" as a set, the **separable / inseparable** rule with pronouns, and a long, structured speaking turn.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use some British forms: *memorise, practise, organise, neighbour, rubbish, holiday, film, kettle, move house*, "Did you not sleep well?" and *get on (well) with*. Teach *memorize, practice, organize, neighbor, trash / garbage, vacation, movie, move*, "Didn't you sleep well?" and **get along with** next to *get on with*. *Let's..., shall we?* is the normal tag in American English too. Accept British forms when learners use them.

- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Keep it going → say it naturally → stand up and speak. In C23 learners learn the small words that make a conversation two-way: a tag that invites a reply, an "Oh really?", a follow-up question, an "mm-hm." In C24 they learn the everyday verbs that real people use instead of textbook ones (*find out*, not *discover*; *sort it out*, not *resolve it*). In C25 they use **everything** from B1 in one long turn and one real discussion. The end of every class is the same freer skill in a bigger form: talking *with* people, not *at* them.

FLUENCY BEFORE ACCURACY — AND THE DOMINANT SPEAKER

This module is about fluency. During freer stages, **do not interrupt** to correct. Walk around with a notepad and write what you hear (good and not so good, no names). Correct **after** the task, on the board, as a class puzzle. Correct on the spot only when the error blocks meaning or when it is the target of a drill.

Dominant speakers are the biggest risk in C23 and C25: one confident learner can fill a whole conversation or panel. Use structure, not criticism: (1) **talking tokens**, 3 paper slips each, one slip per turn, the turn ends when your slips are gone; (2) give the confident learner a **listening job**: chair, timekeeper, or "follow-up question master" (they may only ask questions); (3) a **visible timer** on the screen for each speaker; (4) a quiet word in private: "You're a great speaker. Today can you help Mei and Tomás speak more? Ask them a question each time." Quiet learners get **thinking time** (10 seconds to note ideas before they speak) and a phrase strip.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: SMALL TALK AND PRESENTATIONS

Small talk can touch painful areas fast: home country, family, why someone moved, work status. The mingle cards use **safe topics** (the weather, food, the weekend, movies, the neighborhood, this class). Never make "Tell us about your country" a required topic. For the C25 presentation, every learner **chooses**: a real topic they care about (a hobby, a skill, a place, a change they want in the neighborhood), or a **topic card** with ready ideas. Nobody explains their choice. In the tag game, "You're from..., aren't you?" is **not** a model sentence: use "You like coffee, don't you?"

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (tags, intonation arrows, conversation phrases, phrasal verbs) once for the board. Cut them before C23. Print one pair of ↗ / ↘ **arrow cards** per learner for the C23 intonation drill (or learners use their hands).
- ◆ For C23: one set of **small-talk mingle cards** for the class and one "Keep it going" strip per learner.
- ◆ For C24: one **Split or Stick?** set (24 verb cards + 3 headers) per group of 3–4, one set of **Sort It Out A/B** cards per pair and one set of **phrasal-verb talk cards** per group.

- ◆ For C25: **presentation topic cards** on a side table, one set of **panel role cards** and **panel question cards** per group of 4, one **presentation rubric** per learner (peer feedback) and the **teacher observation checklist** on a clipboard. A phone or kitchen timer for each group, or one big timer on the screen.
- ◆ **Know your C26 plan.** Read "Looking Ahead" at the end of this chapter and check the kit's B1 final assessment ([assessment/](#)) before C25, so what you tell learners matches it. Order or print certificates (the shared ESL toolkit has a template).
- ◆ **At the end of C24, learners choose their C25 topic** and take the planning frame home. Build this into your C24 timing: C25 goes much better when learners arrive with notes.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
8.1	C23 · wk 12	Question tags: the mirror rule (positive → negative tag, negative → positive), copying the auxiliary or <i>do / does / did</i> , special cases (<i>aren't I?</i> · <i>will you?</i> · <i>shall we?</i>); rising (checking) vs falling (expecting agreement) intonation; interest phrases, echo questions, follow-up questions and backchanneling	keep a 2–3 minute small-talk conversation going with tags, reactions and follow-up questions, and choose rising or falling intonation on purpose
8.2	C24 · wk 12	Phrasal verbs: verb + particle, literal vs idiomatic; a topic toolkit for home, work and relationships (+ travel); separable vs inseparable ; a pronoun object goes in the middle (<i>turn it off</i>); <i>look forward to</i> + -ing	use 10+ everyday phrasal verbs about their own life, with pronouns in the right place
8.3	C25 · wk 13	Review project: Presentation & Panel Discussion . Structure (introduction → 2–3 points → conclusion), signposting, panel language (chairing, agreeing, disagreeing politely, asking and answering audience questions), the whole B1 toolkit	give a 3–4 minute presentation from notes, then take part in a panel discussion as chair, speaker or audience
—	C26 · wk 13	Final assessment + celebration (see the kit's B1 final assessment)	show what they can do in a friendly speaking assessment, then celebrate the end of B1

8.1 · C23

Question Tags & Keeping a Conversation Going

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ form question tags with the **mirror rule**: positive statement → negative tag (*You're coming, aren't you?*), negative statement → positive tag (*She doesn't smoke, does she?*)
- ◆ copy the auxiliary, *be* or modal into the tag, or use *do / does / did* when there is none (*You live here, don't you?* · *They arrived late, didn't they?*)
- ◆ use the special cases: *I'm late, aren't I?* · *Close the door, will you?* · *Let's start, shall we?*
- ◆ choose the intonation on purpose: **falling** ↘ = "I expect you to agree" · **rising** ↗ = "I'm really checking"
- ◆ keep a conversation going with **interest phrases** (*Oh really?* · *You're kidding!*), **echo questions** (*Did you?* · *Has she?*), **follow-up questions** (*What was it like?*) and **backchanneling** (*mm-hm, right, uh-huh, no way!*)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.1 (New phrases, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, small-talk mingle)
- ◆ Slides 3–9 · Tag flashcards + ↗ / ↘ **arrow cards** (1 pair per learner) · **Small-talk mingle cards** (1 per learner) + "Keep it going" strips · talking tokens (3 paper slips per learner)
- ◆ Listening scripts 8.1-A (two conversations: flat and warm), 8.1-B (↗ or ↘?) and 8.1-C (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left — the mirror: + You're tired, **aren't** you? · — He **isn't** ready, is he? · no helper? → **do / does / did**: She **works** late, **doesn't** she? · They **went** home, **didn't** they?

Center — special cases: I'm late, **aren't** I? · Pass the salt, **will** you? · Come in, **won't** you? · Let's go, **shall** we?

Right — two voices: ↘ "Nice day, isn't it?" = I'm sure. Agree with me! · ↗ "You haven't seen my keys, have you?" = I don't know. Tell me!

Bottom — keep it going: REACT (Oh really? / Did you?) → ASK (What was it like?) → SHARE (I... too!) · 🗣️ mm-hm · right · uh-huh · no way!

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: tell me about yourself	8	S-S	Review C22 (7.3, work & interviews). Pairs: A is the interviewer, B answers "Tell me about yourself" in 1 minute with <i>Present</i> → <i>Past</i> → <i>Future</i> (<i>I'm responsible for...</i> · <i>I've been working as...</i> · <i>I'd like to...</i>). Swap.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Real work, past work, a dream job or an identity card: all fine. Two volunteers share one strong sentence.
Lead-in: flat or warm?	6	T-S	Read Script 8.1-A : the same small talk twice. Version 1 is flat (statements, no reactions). Version 2 is warm (tags, "Oh really?", a follow-up question). "Which conversation is friendlier? Why?" Elicit: little questions at the end, reactions, more questions. Write two tags from version 2 on the board. "Today: the tools that keep a conversation alive."
Grammar: the mirror rule	14	T-S	Slides 3–5. Meaning (invite a reply), form (flip the polarity, copy the helper verb, pronoun subject), <i>do / does / did</i> , then the special cases. CCQs and drill (see notes). Learners copy the "two questions to ask yourself" into the workbook grammar box.
Intonation drill: ↗ or ↘?	12	T-S → S-S	Slide 6. Say one tag both ways and let learners hear the difference. Then Script 8.1-B : learners hold up ↗ (checking) or ↘ (expecting agreement). Then the situation drill: you give a context, learners say the tag with the right voice. Then pairs: A says a tag either way, B answers the way it was meant ("Yes, it is! Lovely." / "Hmm, let me check...").
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (add the tag), Ex 2 (listen: ↗ or ↘, using Script 8.1-B items 1–6 again) and Ex 4 (fix the tag) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on.
Keeping it going	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 7–8. Present the three tools: React (interest phrase or echo question) → Ask (follow-up question) → Share (a little about you). Add backchanneling : the small sounds that say "I'm listening" (<i>mm-hm, uh-huh, right, yeah, really?, no way!</i>). Read the Priya and Tom dialogue in two halves of the room. Workbook Ex 3 (echo responses) and Ex 5 (react + follow-up) in pairs.
Freer: small-talk mingle	20	S-S (mingle) → T-S	Slide 9. Each learner takes a small-talk card (a place and a starter tag) and 3 talking tokens. Stand up and find a partner. Open with the card's tag (falling voice), keep the chat going for 2 minutes with React

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			→ Ask → Share. Bell → thank your partner ("Nice talking to you!") and swap cards → new partner. 5–6 rounds. In round 4, add the guess & check twist: before you start, guess one thing about your partner and check it with a rising tag ("You like spicy food, don't you? ↗"). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T–S	Delayed error correction: 4 sentences heard (no names), e.g. "You like pizza, isn't it?" · "She has left, has she?" · "I'm right, amn't I?" · "Let's go, will we?" Learners fix them. Praise one great follow-up question and one warm reaction you heard.
Homework set-up	5	T–S	Show online lesson 8.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 14 + 12 + 10 + 10 + 20 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Do Ex 2 as homework (the online lesson has  audio), and keep the "keeping it going" stage to the dialogue plus Ex 5. **Never cut the mingle below 15 minutes.** Tags only become natural when learners use them in real, repeated conversations.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning. A tag turns a statement into an invitation to reply. It checks something, asks for agreement, or simply keeps the other person in the conversation.

SAY: "It's cold today, isn't it?" Am I giving information only, or inviting you to answer? (Inviting.) What answer do I expect? ("Yes, it is!") Is it a real question? (Not really. I'm making conversation.)

SAY: "She doesn't eat meat, does she?" Is the first part positive or negative? (Negative.) So the tag is...? (Positive: does she.) Why does? (No helper verb in "eat," and it's present, she → does.)

SAY: "You haven't seen my keys, have you? ↗" Do I know the answer? (No.) Am I really asking? (Yes.)
"Lovely weather, isn't it? ↘" Do I know the answer? (Yes, I think so.) Am I really asking? (No. I want you to agree.)

SAY: How do you answer "You don't drive, do you?" if you don't drive? ("No, I don't.") Answer the tag or the fact? (The fact.)

Form. Two questions every time: (1) Is my statement positive or negative? → flip it. (2) Which verb do I copy? → the helper (*be, have, will, can, should...*), or *do / does / did* if there is none. The subject becomes a pronoun (*Tom* → *he*, *the kids* → *they*).

+ statement → – tag	You are tired, aren't you? · They have left, haven't they?	She'll be fine, won't she?
– statement → + tag	He isn't ready, is he? · We can't park here, can we?	They haven't paid, have they?
No helper verb	present → do / does · past → did	You live here, don't you? · He saw it, didn't he?
Special cases	<i>I am</i> → aren't I? · imperative → will you? / won't you? · <i>Let's</i> → shall we?	I'm next, aren't I? · Sit down, won't you? · Let's start, shall we?
Keep it going	React (Oh really? / echo: Did you?) → Ask (What was it like?) → Share	"I went to Chicago." — "Did you? How was it?"

Pronunciation. Tags are short and unstressed at the start, with the movement on the tag itself: "It's a **LOVE**ly day, ↘ **ISN'T** it?" A **falling** tag starts high on the auxiliary and drops. A **rising** tag starts low and goes up, like a real yes/no question. Teach the hand signal: hand slides down = sure; hand goes up = checking.

Contractions link: *isn't it* /'ɪzənɪt/, *didn't you* /'dɪdəntʃu/ ("didn't-choo"), *won't you* /'wɒntʃu/. Echo questions are usually **rising** and warm ("Did you? ↗"). Backchannel sounds are short and low ("mm-hm"); a surprised "No way!" jumps up high.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Tag ping-pong** (you say the statement, learners give only the tag): "You're tired..." → "aren't you?" · "She works late..." → "doesn't she?" · "They went home..." → "didn't they?" · "He can't swim..." → "can he?" · "I'm next..." → "aren't I?" · "Let's go..." → "shall we?" Choral, then individuals, then faster.
- 2 Back-chain** a falling tag: "isn't it?" → "a beautiful day, isn't it?" → "It's a beautiful day, isn't it? ↘" Choral ×3, then half the room, then 4–5 individuals. Then the same with a rising tag: "You haven't seen my keys, have you? ↗"
- 3 Same words, two meanings:** "You're coming to the party, aren't you?" First ↘ (you're sure), then ↗ (you're checking). Learners copy both and hold up the right arrow.
- 4 Situation drill:** T: "You're sure. The coffee here is great." → S: "The coffee's great here, isn't it? ↘" · T: "You're not sure. Is the store open on Sunday?" → S: "The store's open on Sunday, isn't it? ↗" (or "...isn't open..., is it? ↗")
- 5 Echo chain:** T: "I went to Chicago." → S1: "Did you? How was it?" → S1 to S2: "I've started a new job." → S2: "Have you? Do you like it?" → around the room.

◆ SMALL-TALK MINGLE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Model first with a strong learner. Read your card: "At the bus stop. It's raining." → "Terrible weather, isn't it? ↘" Your partner answers ("It really is!"), and you keep going: React → Ask → Share. Show one token going on the table every time you take a turn.
- ◆ **Rules:** 2 minutes per conversation. Open with a falling tag. Use at least **one echo question** and **one follow-up question** each. Listeners backchannel (*mm-hm, right, really?*). When your tokens are gone, you can only ask questions, not tell.
- ◆ Bell → "Nice talking to you!" → swap cards with your partner → find a new partner. Aim for 5–6 conversations.
- ◆ **Round 4 twist, guess & check:** before you start, guess one small, safe thing about your new partner (likes coffee, can cook, has seen a certain movie, walked to class today). Check it with a **rising** tag: "You walked here today, didn't you? ↗" Your partner answers the fact.
- ◆ Anyone can say "Let's talk about something else, shall we?" if a topic feels too personal. Teach this sentence and say it is a good, polite way to change the topic.
- ◆ You walk around and listen for tags, intonation and follow-up questions (write examples for feedback, no names). **Don't correct during the mingle.**

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MINGLE

SAY: *How do you start? (Read my card and say the tag.) Voice up or down at the start? (Down: I expect you to agree.) How long is one conversation? (Two minutes.) What must you use? (One echo question and one follow-up question.) What does the listener do? (Backchannel: mm-hm, really?) No tokens left: can you still talk? (Only ask questions.) Don't like a topic? ("Let's talk about something else, shall we?")*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on the six most common tags: *isn't it?* · *aren't you?* · *don't you?* · *didn't you?* · *can you?* · *shall we?*. Give learners the tag flashcards to hold up instead of writing. In the mingle, use the "Keep it going" strip with pictures (😊 react · ❓ ask · 🗨️ share) and 4 ready phrases: *Oh really?* · *Did you?* · *What was it like?* · *Me too!*
Target: open with one tag and use one echo + one follow-up question.

STRETCH

Use tags with *there* and indefinite pronouns (*There's a problem, isn't there?* · *Somebody called, didn't they?*). In the mingle, keep each chat going for 3 minutes and use a **negative** statement + positive tag at least once (*You don't work on Sundays, do you?*). Early finishers write a 10-line conversation (the online project) with 6 tags, marking ↗ or ↘ on each.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **One tag for everything:** "..., isn't it?" / "..., no?" / "..., right?" (Spanish *¿no?*, *¿verdad?*; French *n'est-ce pas?*; German *nicht wahr?*; Portuguese *não é?*; Russian *да?*; Chinese 吗 / 对不对; Hindi/Urdu *na?*; Tagalog *'di ba?*). "You like pizza, isn't it?" is the classic error (also frequent in South Asian and West African Englishes). Tell learners that **"right?"** is a correct, informal American alternative, but practice the full tag system today.
- ◆ **Same polarity:** "She has left, has she?" In English this is not a checking tag; it can sound surprised or even sarcastic. Point to the mirror on the board.
- ◆ **Answering yes / no to a negative question:** Japanese, Korean, and many Chinese, Arabic and Vietnamese speakers answer the *question* ("You don't drive, do you?" — "Yes." = "Yes, you're right, I don't"). English answers the *fact*: "No, I don't." Practice this; the mix-up causes real misunderstandings.
- ◆ **Flat intonation:** learners from tonal or syllable-timed languages (Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai, Spanish, French) may say every tag flat, which can sound bored or cold. Exaggerate the fall and the rise with your hand; let learners exaggerate too.
- ◆ **Backchanneling differs by culture:** Japanese *aizuchi* (*hai, ee, sō desu ne*) are very frequent; English speakers may think a Japanese listener agrees when they only mean "I'm listening." Some cultures listen silently to show respect; in English, silence can seem like no interest. Say both are fine at home; in English, a few "mm-hm"s help.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_22.html. Listen to the model sentences and the Priya and Tom conversation with 🎧 and repeat them, copying the falling tags. Do the online exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 8.1: finish Ex 5, "My new words" and the journal (three things you know about a friend → three tags you could say to them, with ↗ or ↘). Real-life task: react with an echo and one follow-up question in a real conversation this week.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B does she · Q2 B with a rising voice · Q3 (new) B aren't I. Script 8.1-B (Ex 2): 1 ↘ · 2 ↗ · 3 ↘ · 4 ↗ · 5 ↘ · 6 ↗.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain what a phrasal verb is (verb + particle = one meaning) and tell a **literal** one (*sit down*) from an **idiomatic** one (*give up*, *look after*)
- ◆ use a topic toolkit of about 24 everyday phrasal verbs for **home**, **work** and **relationships** (plus the travel set from the online lesson)
- ◆ sort phrasal verbs into **separable** (*turn on the TV/turn the TV on*), **inseparable** (*look after the kids*) and **no object** (*get up*, *get together*)
- ◆ put a pronoun object **in the middle** of a separable verb: *turn it off*, never *turn off it*
- ◆ talk about their own day, work and relationships using 10+ phrasal verbs

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, speaking task) and the 8.3 **presentation planning frame** (set as homework at the end of class)
- ◆ Slides 10–13 · Phrasal-verb flashcards · **Split or Stick?** game (1 set of 24 cards + 3 header cards per group of 3–4) · **Sort It Out** A/B cards (1 set per pair) · **phrasal-verb talk cards** (1 set per group) · presentation topic cards (to preview)
- ◆ Listening scripts 8.2-A (Leo and Nadia) and 8.2-B (pronoun dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: verb + particle = one meaning · get + up · look + after · find + out · LITERAL: sit down, come in · IDIOMATIC: give up (= stop trying), look after (= take care of)

Center — three columns: ✂ **SPLIT** (separable): turn on the light = turn the light on → turn **it** on · 📎 **STICK** (inseparable): look after the baby → look after **her** · 🚫 **NO OBJECT:** get up, get together, set off

Right — topic toolkit: 🏠 HOME · 🧳 WORK · ❤️ RELATIONSHIPS (flashcards stuck under each heading as you teach them)

Bottom: look forward to + **-ing**: I'm looking forward to seeing you.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: keep it going	8	S-S	Review C23. Pairs, 2-minute chats on "last weekend" and "this class." Rule: open with a tag, answer with an echo + a follow-up question. Then 2–3 volunteers read one tag from their journal and the class says ↗ or ↘.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Lead-in: Leo's bad morning	10	T-S → S-S	Read Script 8.2-A (Leo and Nadia). Gist: "Why is Leo tired?" (He woke up at five and set off early for the airport.) Then slide 10: "How many two-part verbs did you hear?" Pairs list them from the dialogue in Workbook Ex 1 (12). Explain verb + particle, literal vs idiomatic, and "real people say <i>find out</i> , not <i>discover</i> ."
Topic toolkit	12	T-S	Slide 11. Teach the verbs in three topic groups with flashcards and mime: 🏠 home, 💼 work, ❤️ relationships. For each verb: meaning (CCQ), a model sentence about you , choral repetition. Stick each card under its heading on the board. Don't mention separable / inseparable yet.
Form: split or stick?	10	T-S	Slide 12. Show "Turn on the light. / Turn the light on." (both OK) and "Look after the baby. / Look the baby after. ❌". Then the key rule: a pronoun goes in the middle of a separable verb: "Turn it on." ✅ "Turn on it." ❌ CCQs and drill (below). Add <i>look forward to</i> + -ing.
Game: Split or Stick?	15	S-S (groups)	Slide 13. Groups of 3–4 sort the 24 verb cards under three headers: ✂️ SPLIT · 🔒 STICK · 🚫 NO OBJECT. To place a card, a player must say it with a pronoun ("Put it away." → SPLIT; "Look after them." → STICK) or, for no-object verbs, in a short sentence. Check against the answer key (on the board). Round 2: the pronoun race (you call a verb + noun, teams race to say it with a pronoun). Rules on the card sheet. ICQs first.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 (complete the particle), Ex 3 (replace the formal verb) and Ex 4 (fix the pronoun) alone, then check in pairs. Early finishers start Ex 5.
Freer: Sort It Out + talk cards	15	S-S → groups	(1) Pairs, Sort It Out A/B cards (5 min): A reads a small problem at home or at work ("The TV is too loud."); B offers help with a phrasal verb + pronoun ("I'll turn it down."). Swap. (2) Groups of 3, talk cards (10 min): take a card ("Who do you get along with at work or in class? Why?"), answer for 1 minute using at least 2 phrasal verbs, the group reacts with an echo + a follow-up question (recycling C23).
Feedback	5	T-S	Board: 4 sentences heard (no names), e.g. "I'll pick up them later." · "Can you look my cat after?" · "I look forward to see

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			you." · "I get up the bus at 8." Learners fix them. Praise the best "Sort It Out" answer.
Homework & C25 set-up	7	T-S	Online lesson 8.2 + workbook journal. Then C25 set-up : show slide 14 and the presentation topic cards. "Next class, you give a 3–4 minute talk and join a panel. Choose your topic tonight." Learners write their topic at the top of the planning frame (Workbook 8.3) and take it home to fill with key words.
Total	90		8 + 10 + 12 + 10 + 15 + 8 + 15 + 5 + 7

IF YOU RUN LONG

Cut the talk cards to 5 minutes (keep Sort It Out) and set Ex 3 as homework. **Never cut the C25 set-up.** Learners who choose a topic and write a few key words at home give much better presentations.

◆ THE TOPIC TOOLKIT (WHAT TO TEACH)

 Home & daily life	wake up · get up · turn on / off (the TV, the lamp) · turn up / down (the volume) · put away (clothes, dishes) · throw away (old food) · clean up (the kitchen) · look for (my keys)
 Work	fill out (a form; UK <i>fill in</i>) · call back (a customer) · find out (the price) · sort out (a problem) · deal with (a complaint) · put off (a meeting = postpone) · hand in (a report) · carry on (= continue)
 Relationships	get along with (UK <i>get on with</i>) · look after (the kids) · catch up with (an old friend) · run into (= meet by chance) · count on (= trust, rely on) · get together (= meet socially) · bring up (children = raise) · look forward to (+ noun / -ing)
 Travel (online)	set off · check in · get on / off (a bus, train, plane) · give up (= stop trying; quit a habit)

Teach about 8 per group in class; the online lesson adds the travel set. **Don't** give a long alphabetical list. Every verb goes with a sentence the learner can picture: "I look after my neighbor's cat on weekends."

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning. The particle changes the meaning of the verb. Some are literal (the meaning is in the words); many are idiomatic (learn them like new words).

SAY: "He gave up smoking." Is it about giving something to someone? (No.) Does he smoke now? (No.) So give up means...? (Stop.) · "I ran into my teacher at the supermarket." Did I plan to meet her? (No.) Did I run? (No! By chance.)

SAY: "Can you look after my cat?" Is it about looking with your eyes? (No.) What do I need? (Someone to take care of it: food, water.) · "We put off the meeting." Is the meeting today? (No, later.) Is it canceled? (No, only later.)

SAY: "I get along with my coworkers." Do we fight? (No.) Do we like each other? (Yes.) · "I'm looking forward to the weekend." Am I happy or worried? (Happy.) Is it past or future? (Future.)

Form. Learn each verb with its type. With a noun object, separable verbs work both ways. With a **pronoun**, they must split.

 Separable	verb + particle + noun or verb + noun + particle	Turn on the TV. = Turn the TV on. → Turn it on. (never "turn on it")
 Inseparable	verb + particle + object (always together)	I look after the kids. → I look after them. (never "look them after")
 No object	verb + particle (nothing after it)	I get up at 7. · Let's get together on Friday. · Carry on!
Three-part	verb + 2 particles + object (inseparable)	I get along with her. · I'm looking forward to it. · Let's catch up with them.
+ -ing	<i>look forward to</i> + noun / -ing (<i>to</i> is a preposition here)	I'm looking forward to seeing you. (not "to see")

Pronunciation. In a phrasal verb the **particle** usually carries the stress: "I get **UP** at seven." "Turn it **OFF**." "She looks **AFter** her brother." (with *look after* the stress is on **af**-). With a pronoun in the middle, the pronoun is weak and linked: "turn it off" → /tɜːnɪdɒf/ ("tur-ni-DOFF", with the American flap **t**), "pick them up" → "pick-em-UP". Linking makes the pronoun almost disappear; that is why learners don't hear it and leave it at the end.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Mime and say:** you mime (yawn and stretch; press a switch; hand in a paper; hug), learners say the verb: "wake up / turn on / hand in / get along with."
- 2 Noun → pronoun substitution** (the key drill): T: "Turn off the TV." → S: "Turn it off." · "Pick up the kids." → "Pick them up." · "Fill out the form." → "Fill it out." · "Look after the baby." → "Look after her." (no change in order!) · "Call back the customer." → "Call him / her back."
- 3 Formal → everyday:** T: "discover" → S: "find out" · "postpone" → "put off" · "continue" → "carry on" · "raise children" → "bring up" · "meet by chance" → "run into" · "solve" → "sort out".
- 4 I'll do it!** (recycles A2 *I'll*): T: "The music's too loud." → S: "I'll turn it down." · "There are clothes on the floor." → "I'll put them away." · "The customer called." → "I'll call her back."

- 5 **look forward to:** T: "the weekend" → S: "I'm looking forward to the weekend." T: "see my friends" → S: "I'm looking forward to **seeing** my friends."

◆ SPLIT OR STICK? – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3–4. Each group gets the three header cards (✂ SPLIT · 🔗 STICK · 🚫 NO OBJECT) and the 24 verb cards face down. Each verb card has a small example object on it (*turn off + the TV*).
- ◆ Players take turns: turn over a card, **say it with a pronoun** ("Turn it off!"), and put it under a header. The group must agree. If they disagree, they test it: "Does 'look them after' sound right?" A wrong card goes back to the bottom of the pile.
- ◆ When all cards are placed, show the answer (slide 13 / the key on the materials sheet). One point per correct card. Two-way cards: *wake up* is NO OBJECT (*I woke up*) **and** SPLIT (*wake him up*); accept either with a correct sentence.
- ◆ **Round 2 — pronoun race** (5 min): you call a verb + noun ("Throw away the old milk!"). Teams race to say it with a pronoun ("Throw it away!") and hold up the card. First correct team gets a point. Include 2–3 inseparable ones as traps ("Look after the kids!" → "Look after them!").

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GAME AND THE TALK CARDS

SAY: *Split or Stick: What do you say before you place a card? (The verb with a pronoun: "it" or "them.") Three places: what are they? (Split, stick, no object.) If the group disagrees? (Test it: does it sound right?) · Talk cards: How long do you talk? (One minute.) How many phrasal verbs? (At least two.) What does the group do? (React, echo, and ask a follow-up question.) Too personal? (Take a new card.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with 10 verbs only: *wake up, get up, turn on / off, put away, look for, fill out, call back, look after, get along with, get together*, using the picture flashcards and mime. In the sorting game, play in a mixed group and be the "tester" (say it out loud) while a partner places the card. Target: 6 phrasal verbs in spoken sentences about your day and 2 correct pronoun sentences (*turn it on, put them away*).

STRETCH

Learn a second meaning: *take off* (a plane / your coat), *pick up* (lift / collect someone / learn a language easily), *bring up* (raise children / mention a topic). Use three-part verbs (*run out of, come up with, get along with*). Early finishers write the online project: "A day in my life" with 10+ phrasal verbs from 3 groups, marked S or I.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Avoiding phrasal verbs:** speakers of Romance languages (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian) often choose the Latin one-word verb (*discover, continue, postpone, extinguish*). It is correct, but sounds

formal. Praise it, then offer the everyday form.

- ◆ **Pronoun at the end** ("turn on it," "pick up them"): all learners, especially Spanish, French, Arabic, Chinese and Russian speakers, whose languages don't split verbs. German and Dutch speakers are used to split verbs (*Mach das Licht an*) and often find this easier.
- ◆ **Splitting an inseparable verb** ("look the baby after") after learning the split rule: overgeneralization. Keep the three columns on the board.
- ◆ **"look forward to see you"** (all learners: *to* looks like an infinitive). Board: *look forward to* + noun / -ing.
- ◆ **Missing or wrong particle** ("get the bus," "get up the bus," "wait me"): prepositions don't map across languages. Teach each verb as a chunk with its particle.
- ◆ **Hearing the particle**: Vietnamese, Chinese and Thai speakers may drop final consonants, so *pick it up* becomes "pi-i-u." Drill the linking slowly, then at speed.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_23.html. Listen to the model sentences and the Leo and Nadia dialogue with 🎧 and say them; do the exercises and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 8.2: finish Ex 5, "My new words" and the journal (5 phrasal verbs you'll really use, each in a true sentence, marked S or I). **For C25**: choose your topic and fill the planning frame (Workbook 8.3) with key words, not full sentences.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** Turn it off, please. · Q2 **B** look after · Q3 (new) **B** seeing. Leo and Nadia (Ex 1): woke up · get back (to sleep) · set off · check in · turn on · sort out · look after · get along / get on with · look forward to · come up · deal with · find out (12).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- understand the main points of a short talk and a panel discussion, and notice the signposting
- plan a presentation in three parts (introduction → 2–3 points → conclusion) with a **planning frame** of key words
- give a **3–4 minute presentation** from notes, with signposting and at least four different B1 structures
- take part in a **panel discussion** as **chair**, **speaker** or **audience**: open and close, give and defend a view, agree and disagree politely, ask and answer questions
- give a classmate kind, specific feedback with the rubric (one star, one wish)

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 8.3 (B1 toolkit, Exercises 1–5, **planning frame**, panel roles, presentation rubric self-check, final B1 journal)
- Slides 14–18 · **Presentation topic cards** (side table) · **Panel role cards** (chair · speaker · audience) + **panel question cards** (1 set per group of 4) · **Presentation rubric** (1 per learner, for peer feedback) · **Teacher observation checklist** (C25 → C26) on a clipboard · a timer per group
- Listening scripts 8.3-A (Maya's talk and the panel) and 8.3-B (the teacher's model presentation, about 3 minutes)
- Learners' own planning frames (started at home after C24)

BOARD PLAN

Left — MY TALK (3–4 min): 1 INTRO: Today I'd like to talk about... because... · 2 BODY: First of all... · Another point is... · For example... · Finally... · 3 CONCLUSION: To sum up... · Thank you for listening. Any questions?

Center — THE PANEL:  CHAIR: Welcome to our panel. · Let's start with... · What's your view on that? · One more question? · To wrap up... ·  SPEAKERS: In my opinion... · That's a good point, but... ·  AUDIENCE: I have a question for... · You said that... Could you explain...?

Right — B1 toolkit: had + p.p. · If I had..., I'd... · She told me that... · It was built... · must / might · used to · a / the · -ing / to · too / enough · isn't it? · sort it out

Corner: Your topic = your choice, or a topic card. · Communication > perfection · C26 = final class 

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: pronoun race + tags	6	T-S → S-S	Review C24 and C23. Fast pronoun race ("Fill out the form!" → "Fill it out!"). Then pairs: "You chose your topic, didn't you?" — each learner tells a partner their topic in one sentence; the partner reacts with an echo + one follow-up question.
Pre-task 1: listen to a model	10	S → S-S	Read Script 8.3-A (or play the online dialogue with ). Listen 1, gist: "What is Maya's topic? Do the others agree?" Listen 2: Workbook Ex 1 (five questions + tick the signposting you hear). Pairs check. Slide 15: point out the chair's language (<i>Maya, over to you · Let's open it up · Sam, what do you think?</i>).
Pre-task 2: the language of talks and panels	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 14 and 16. Signposting (quick drill, below) and panel language (chair · speaker · audience). Workbook Ex 4 (put the talk in order) and Ex 5 (soften the disagreement) in pairs. Ex 2 and Ex 3 (mixed B1 review) are homework unless your class is fast.
Planning: the frame	12	S	Read Script 8.3-B (your model talk, about 3 minutes) once, and ask: "Where did my introduction end? How many points? Which signposts?" Learners finish their planning frame (key words only, not full sentences) and tick the B1 structures they will use (4+). Learners without a topic take a topic card . You circulate, help with ideas and fix one sentence per learner.
Rehearsal	8	S-S	Pairs. A gives the talk from the frame while B times it and listens; B gives one star (something good) and one wish (one thing to improve) using the rubric words. Swap. Learners adjust their frame (too short? add an example; too long? cut a point).
TASK A: presentations	18	S-S (groups of 4)	Slide 17. New groups of 4 (3–5 is fine). Each learner presents for 3–4 minutes ; a timekeeper shows "1 minute left." Listeners write one audience question per talk and fill a peer rubric for one speaker (assign who listens for whom). About 4

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			minutes per talk + changeover. You observe with the checklist , moving between groups.
TASK B: panel discussion	14	Groups → fishbowl	Slide 17. Two groups join. Group 1 sits as the panel (1 chair + 3 speakers); Group 2 is the audience . The chair takes a panel question card that links the speakers' topics, opens, invites each speaker for about 1 minute, then takes audience questions and closes (7 min). Swap: Group 2 becomes the panel (7 min). Role cards on the table. ICQs first.
Report & language focus	5	T-S	Two volunteers give their conclusion to the whole class. Applause! Board 3–4 errors from the talks (no names) and 2–3 excellent sentences; fix and praise together. Fluency first: praise communication before correcting form.
Looking ahead & homework	7	T-S	Slide 18: preview C26 (see "Looking Ahead" below): what the final assessment looks like, and the celebration. Homework: the online final-project lesson, record your talk on a phone, the final B1 journal. Learners tick the 8.3 "I can..." list and fill the rubric self-check.
Total	90		6 + 10 + 10 + 12 + 8 + 18 + 14 + 5 + 7

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect planning, rehearsal, the presentations and the panel. Cut in this order: (1) shorten the warmer to 3 minutes; (2) do Ex 4 and Ex 5 as homework (keep the slide language); (3) make the panel 5 minutes per group. With a large class, run TASK A in groups of 3. **Never cut Looking Ahead.** Learners must leave knowing exactly what C26 looks like.

WHY 3–4 MINUTES IN CLASS, BUT 1–2 MINUTES ONLINE?

The online lesson (8.3) asks self-study learners for a 1–2 minute talk, because they work alone. In class you have listeners, a rehearsal partner and a planning frame, so the target is a **3–4 minute** talk: two or three points, each with an example. If a learner can only do 2 minutes with confidence, that is a success; note it on the checklist and don't push. The panel adds the interaction the online lesson can only imagine.

No new grammar. The job today is **structure** (signposting) and **interaction** (panel language), while reaching for the B1 structures learners already know. Keep CCQs fast.

SAY: "To sum up..." Beginning, middle or end? (End.) · "Another point is..." Is it my first point? (No, the second or third.) · "For example..." Am I giving a new point or making a point clearer? (Clearer.)

SAY: "I see your point, but I'm not sure I agree." Do I agree? (No, not completely.) Am I rude? (No: I say something positive first.) · "No, you're wrong." Is this OK in a panel? (No, too direct.)

SAY: (Chair) "Ana, what's your view on that?" Why does the chair say this? (To bring Ana in: maybe she hasn't spoken.) · "We have time for one more question." Is the panel starting or ending? (Ending soon.)

Introduction	Today I'd like to talk about... · I'm going to tell you about... · I chose this topic because...	+ why it matters
Body	First of all... · To begin with... · Another point is... · What's more... · For example / For instance... · Finally...	2–3 points, each + an example
Conclusion	To sum up... · In conclusion... · So, to finish... · Thank you for listening. Does anyone have a question?	repeat the main idea
 Chair	Welcome to our panel. Today's question is... · Let's start with... · What do you think, ...? · Does anyone in the audience have a question? · One more question. · To wrap up... Let's thank our speakers.	opens, invites, times, closes
 Speakers	In my opinion... · If you ask me... · That's a really good point. · I see what you mean, but... · I'm not sure I agree, to be honest. · Yes, however...	acknowledge first, then your view
 Audience	I have a question for... · You said that... Could you explain...? · What would happen if...? · Do you think...?	short, one question

Pronunciation for presenting. Pause after each signpost ("First of all... [pause] it's healthy."). Stress the key word in each point. Slow down: a calm pace sounds more confident, and speed hides good English. Look up from the notes at the end of each sentence. In the panel, the polite "I see your **POINT**, but..." has a fall-rise on *point*; a flat, fast "No" sounds rude even with polite words.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT (QUICK, CHORAL → INDIVIDUAL)

- 1 Signpost chain:** T shows a topic ("cooking at home"). S1: "Today I'd like to talk about cooking at home." S2: "First of all, it's cheaper." S3: "Another point is that it's healthier." S4: "For example, ..." S5: "To sum up, ..." New topic, new chain.

- 2 **Soften it:** T (blunt): "No, that's wrong." → S: "I see your point, but I'm not sure I agree." · T: "Bad idea." → S: "That's an interesting idea, but I think it might be difficult."
- 3 **Chair in action:** T: "(bring in Omar)" → S: "Omar, what's your view on that?" · T: "(time is almost up)" → S: "We have time for one more question." · T: "(end)" → S: "To wrap up, let's thank our speakers."

◆ THE TASK – PRESENTATIONS AND THE PANEL

Topic choices (say them out loud): (1) a topic you really care about: a hobby, a skill, a place you love, a change you'd like to see in the neighborhood or at work, a useful habit, a piece of technology; (2) a **topic card** with three ready points; (3) the topic of your online capstone. Nobody has to talk about their home country, family or personal history, and nobody explains their choice.

TASK A (groups of 4): speaker stands or sits, glances at key words (reading full sentences is not allowed), speaks 3–4 minutes. The timekeeper (the next speaker) shows 1 finger at 3 minutes. Listeners write one audience question for the panel. Each learner fills the peer rubric for the speaker on their left (star + wish only, no numbers for peers).

TASK B (fishbowl panel): two groups join. Panel group sits in a row facing the other group. Roles: **Chair** (1), **Speakers** (the other 3; each gives a 1-minute position linked to their talk), **Audience** (the other group: each person asks one question to a named speaker). The chair's card has the order: welcome → question card → each speaker 1 min → audience questions → "one more question" → wrap up. 7 minutes, then swap. Choose as chair a learner who talks a lot (they must now invite others) or a confident learner who presented well.

SAY: *ICQs: How long is your talk? (Three to four minutes.) Can you read a full script? (No, only key words.) What do listeners write? (One question and a star and a wish.) In the panel, who opens and closes? (The chair.) How long does each speaker talk in the panel? (About one minute.) Audience: how many questions each? (One.) Disagree with a person or an idea? (An idea, politely: "I see your point, but...")*

Small or uneven classes: with 6–7 learners, run one group of presentations (in two rounds) and one panel with the rest of the class as audience. With 5 or fewer, you are the chair and everyone is a speaker. A learner who cannot stay for the whole class presents first.

◆ THE RUBRIC AND THE OBSERVATION CHECKLIST → C26

The presentation rubric (classroom materials, set H, and the self-check in Workbook 8.3) has five criteria: **1** structure & signposting · **2** range of B1 language · **3** fluency & delivery · **4** pronunciation & clarity · **5** interaction in the panel. Three levels: ★★★ strong · ★★ getting there · ★ not yet. Peers give only a star and a wish. Learners self-assess at home. **You** can use the full rubric for your notes, but **don't grade C25**: it's practice. Tell learners so.

The observation checklist (set I) has one row per learner and 10 can-do items. Three marks: ✓ did it clearly · ~ did it with help, or errors that affect meaning · ○ not yet / not observed. You won't see every learner do everything; listen to each learner for at least one full talk and part of the panel. After class, use it to:

- ◆ **Plan each C26 speaking assessment.** The B1 final speaking assessment is an individual interview (about 8 minutes): warm-up, a short story, a **1-minute talk** from a topic card, a **discussion** where you gently push back, and a complaint or job-interview role-play. Learners may reuse their C25 topic for the talk. For learners with ○ on items 1–3, start with the part they did best.
- ◆ **Choose the discussion prompt.** Note which Module 7 discussion topic (or which C25 panel question) suits each pair.
- ◆ **Plan the C26 warm-up:** the two items with the most ~ / ○ across the class become the 10-minute review before the assessment starts.
- ◆ **Spot who needs reassurance:** anyone who stopped early gets a quiet word at the end of C25: "Next class is friendly. It's like today, but shorter. I'll help you."

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

The planning frame can be three boxes of pictures or symbols (one per part) with 3–4 key words each. Offer a topic card with ready points and pictures. Target: a 2-minute talk with *Today I'd like to talk about... · First... · Another point... · To sum up...*, and one question or one polite agree / disagree in the panel. Give the audience role with a question already written on a card. Rehearse with a supportive partner.

STRETCH

A full 4 minutes with three points, each with an example, and 6+ B1 structures (a second conditional, reported speech, the passive, a past perfect, a question tag, a phrasal verb). Take the chair role and bring every speaker in by name. In the panel, answer a hard question with "That's a great question. I think..." and a reason. Write the talk up as a 200-word article at home.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Reading a script word for word:** learners from education systems that value memorized, written speeches (many East Asian, Middle Eastern and Eastern European schools) may write the whole talk. Allow it at home for confidence, but in class the frame has **key words only**. Collect scripts at the door if needed, kindly.
- ◆ **Very direct disagreement** ("No, this is not true," German, Dutch, Russian, Hebrew) or **no disagreement at all** (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai, Filipino speakers may agree to be polite). Teach both groups the English middle: acknowledge, then "but...".
- ◆ **Missing articles** in topics and points (Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean): "I want to talk about importance of sport." Accept in fluency; board it in feedback (*the importance of...*).
- ◆ **Rising intonation on every sentence** in a presentation sounds unsure. Model falling intonation at the end of each point: confident and finished.

- ◆ "I will talk about..." as the opener (Spanish, French, Portuguese): correct, but *Today I'd like to talk about...* sounds more natural. Praise, then offer.
- ◆ "Discuss about" ("Today we discuss about..."): Spanish *discutir sobre*, Arabic, Hindi and others. English: *discuss something / talk about something*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b1/lesson_24.html. Listen to Maya's talk and the panel with 🎧 and repeat Maya's lines. Record your presentation on your phone (or give it to someone at home) and listen back: note one strength and one thing to improve. Workbook 8.3: Ex 2 and Ex 3 (if not done in class), the rubric self-check and the final B1 journal. Bring the workbook and your planning frame to C26.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B To sum up... · Q2 B I see your point, but I'm not sure I agree. · Q3 (new) B Ana, what's your view on that? Maya (Ex 1): 1 it's healthy, it saves money, and streets would be cleaner and quieter · 2 her expensive bus pass · 3 that cycling is not always safe · 4 if cities built more bike lanes · 5 some people live far away from work. Signposting heard: Today I'd like to talk about · First of all · Another point is · Finally · To sum up · Thank you for listening.

CLOSING THE MODULE AND THE COURSE

END OF C25: MODULE 8 AND B1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18: isn't it? ↘ / Oh really? What was it like? → sort it out / look after them → my talk, our panel. Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook and look back at the "I can..." lists from Module 1. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you, for the C26 warm-up.

The C26 final assessment covers the whole B1 course. From this module it checks: question tags (form and intonation), interested responses and follow-up questions, phrasal verbs with pronoun objects, signposting a short talk, and polite agreeing and disagreeing in a discussion.

WHAT TO TELL LEARNERS AT THE END OF C25 (SLIDE 18)

C26 has two parts. First, a friendly **final speaking assessment**: a one-to-one interview of about 8 minutes — warm-up questions, a short story, a **1-minute talk** on a topic card (the C25 topic is fine), a **discussion** where you gently disagree so the learner defends a view (just like the panel), and a short complaint or job-interview role-play. With more than 8 learners, start interviews in C25 (see the kit's final assessment). There are also short listening, reading and writing tasks in the kit's B1 final assessment. Then a **celebration**: certificates, a look back at what everyone can do now, and the next step, the B2 course, **Confident English**.

Say it simply: "Next class is our last class. You talk with a partner and with me, like today, but shorter. You can use the same topic. No surprises: it's everything we practiced. Then we celebrate!"

Reduce anxiety: show B1 lesson 1.1 on screen and ask: "Week 1: could you talk for three minutes and then run a discussion?" Let them hear how far they've come. Remind them that the online lessons stay open for review, and that the recording of their talk is the best practice for the long turn.

Celebration planning: if learners want to bring food to share in C26, great. Ask everyone to label their dish with its main ingredients (allergies, halal, vegetarian). Nobody should feel they have to bring anything. Invite 2–3 volunteers to give a 1-minute "graduation speech" with the C25 signposts ("Today I'd like to say thank you...").

TEACHER REFLECTION (AFTER C25)

Look at your checklist and answer three questions: Which two can-dos need a C26 warm-up? Which learners need a quiet word of encouragement? Which topic will each learner use for the 1-minute talk, and which role-play (complaint or job interview) suits each learner best? Write your answers on the back of the checklist.